

The Prop Firm Option

The prop-firm programmes worth trading under each firm's rules and the plan's compliance policies, optimised setting by setting and derived step by step: how much one person can expect per month, and the mathematics behind every number.

\$70,128 expected per month in the first year, one person, recommended plan

Expected values under a model of fair prices, for a trader with no predictive skill, under each firm's written rules as read on 4 October 2026. Firms may refuse payouts or apply behavioural rules at their discretion (Chapters 29 and 31). Not investment advice. Do not share or sell this plan: several firms close traders who run the same marketed strategy together.

Expected cash per month, one person

\$70,128

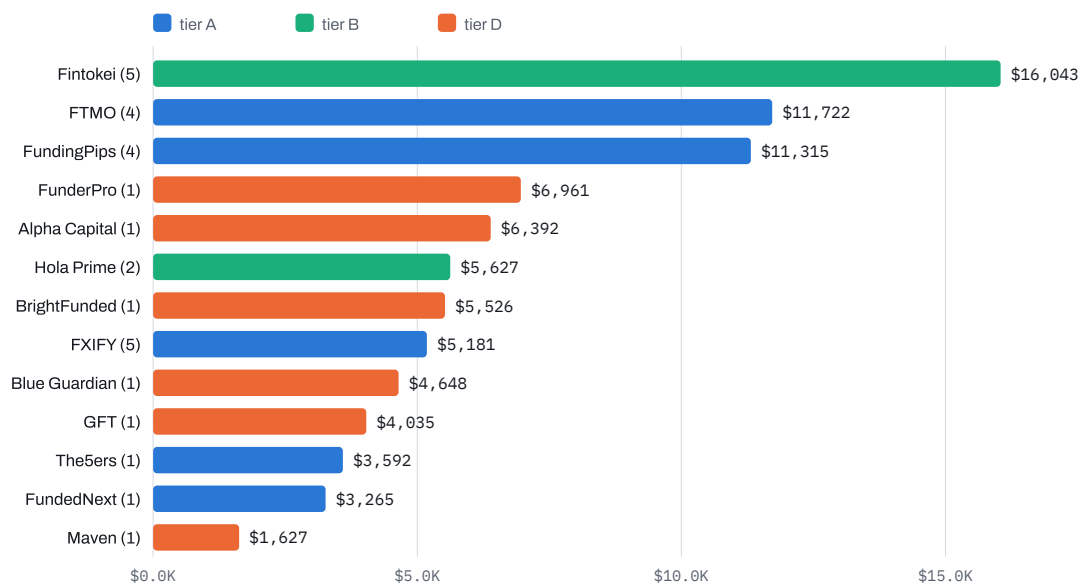
a month in the first year, $\pm$ \$2,427 (95%)

That is the expected cash, after the fees modelled (evaluation fees, activation and monthly fees, refunds and credits as each firm's rules give them; not taxes or payment costs), that one person receives per month in the *first year* of the recommended plan: 28 accounts at 13 prop firms, each traded with zero predictive skill under every rule of its firm that the model contains and the plan's own policies (flat every evening, no trade and no day above 40% of a target, accounts closed before they are traded down to the floor). In 90% of simulated first years the total lies between \$92,691 and \$1,781,617 (median \$777,284).

\$79,208 Months 2–12 average (first year)	\$82,062 Long-run rate: months 13–36 of 36-month lives ($\pm$ \$2,038)	\$169,478 Value still to come at month 12 from accounts then open	\$85,934 Sum of the accounts' long-run rates (Part II)
\$47,758 If payouts are refused 2% / 5% / 15% by tier (Chapter 29)	\$32,157 If refused 5% / 10% / 30%	\$43,877 If every trading cost is twice the assumption	\$28,754 First year with only \$20,000 of starting cash
\$27,659 Tier A firms only (15 accounts)	\$45,827 Tiers A and B (22 accounts)	\$81,260 Every firm at its full allowance (35 accounts)	\$76,950 Recommended + futures (53 accounts)

Why it is lower than version 6's \$138,412

Version 6 was reviewed in detail, and the review was right on almost every point (Appendix A). The largest changes are to the strategy itself, not to arithmetic. **First**, the plan no longer uses bold play: several firms forbid passing a phase with one or a few trades, so no trade and no day may make more than 40% of a target, and every phase and payout takes at least three winning days. **Second**, every position is closed before the daily resets, because several firms measure the daily limit on equity. **Third**, rule inputs were corrected (FundingPips, GFT, FundedNext, Maven, The5ers, FunderPro's funded margin limit, which version 6's FunderPro setting broke, and others). **Fourth**, the engine now closes an account near its floor instead of trading it in micro size, sizes risk net of cost, and checks margin against the current balance. **Fifth**, every figure is re-measured on paths no earlier stage used, with dependence-aware intervals. These changes interact, so the new figure is a new measurement, not version 6's minus a list.



Long-run value per month by firm in the recommended plan (number of accounts in brackets): each account's renewal–reward value on fresh paths. Colour: reliability tier (Chapter 29).

Where it comes from

Programme	Tier	Market	Accounts	Risk / k / m / X	EV/month per account (95%)	EV/month
FTMO 2-Step	A	Nasdaq	4 × 100K	1.5% / 8 / 0.75 / 20%	\$2,930 $\pm$ \$294	\$11,722
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (95%)	A	USDJPY	4 × 100K	1.75% / 8 / 1 / 15%	\$2,829 $\pm$ \$236	\$11,315
The5ers HS Classic	A	Nasdaq	1 × 100K	1.75% / 7 / 1 / 30%	\$3,592 $\pm$ \$214	\$3,592
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	A	Nasdaq	1 × 100K	1.75% / 6 / 1.07 / 30%	\$2,877 $\pm$ \$228	\$2,877
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	A	Nasdaq	1 × 50K	1.75% / 6 / 1.07 / 30%	\$1,310 $\pm$ \$116	\$1,310
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	A	Nasdaq	1 × 25K	1.75% / 6 / 1.07 / 30%	\$643 $\pm$ \$58	\$643

Programme	Tier	Market	Accounts	Risk / k / m / X	EV/month per account (95%)	EV/month
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	A	Nasdaq	1 × 10K	1.75% / 6 / 1.07 / 30%	\$246 ± \$23	\$246
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	A	Nasdaq	1 × 5K	1.75% / 6 / 1.07 / 30%	\$105 ± \$12	\$105
FundedNext Stellar	A	EURUSD	1 × 200K	1.75% / 6 / 1 / 20%	\$3,265 ± \$416	\$3,265
Fintohei ProTrader	B	Nasdaq	5 × 100K	1.75% / 10 / 1 / 30%	\$3,209 ± \$339	\$16,043
Hola Prime 2-Step Prime	B	gold	2 × 100K	1.75% / 10 / 1.03 / 20%	\$2,813 ± \$245	\$5,627
Alpha Capital Pro 10%	D	Nasdaq	1 × 200K	1.75% / 6 / 1 / 20%	\$6,392 ± \$385	\$6,392
FunderPro Classic	D	Nasdaq	1 × 200K	1.75% / 8 / 1.07 / 20%	\$6,961 ± \$506	\$6,961
GFT Standard	D	Nasdaq	1 × 200K	1.75% / 3 / 1.07 / 10%	\$4,035 ± \$221	\$4,035
BrightFunded Classic	D	Nasdaq	1 × 200K	1.75% / 6 / 1 / 20%	\$5,526 ± \$509	\$5,526
Blue Guardian 2-Step	D	Nasdaq	1 × 200K	1.75% / 4 / 1.07 / 15%	\$4,648 ± \$382	\$4,648
Maven 2-Step	D	Nasdaq	1 × 100K	1.75% / 4 / 1.25 / 10%	\$1,627 ± \$88	\$1,627
28 accounts at 13 firms						\$85,934

Risk / k / m / X: risk per trade and payout target as a share of the account, reward-to-risk, stop in hourly standard deviations. Per-account values are long-run rates from sixteen fresh paths; their sum (\$85,934) is a different quantity from the first-year average (\$70,128), see 8.5.

What the number means, and what it does not

- It is an **expected value under a model**: the average over many possible years if prices are fair random walks with the measured volatility and costs. The ± is the simulation's precision, not a range for real income.
- It assumes **zero skill**: the value comes from the contract (a capped loss, a share of gains), not from predicting prices.
- It assumes the firms **pay as their rules say** and do not judge the plan's trading to break their behavioural rules (Chapter 31.2). The refusal scenarios above price random refusals only.
- It assumes every slot is **refilled at once**, which needs cash for fees; with a finite budget the first year is lower (Chapter 28.7).
- It is **per person**: every firm limits what one person may hold. Accounts in anyone else's name are not allowed and are not in the plan.

How it was found

- Part I derives every formula and says which model it is exact for; the exact chain of 5.5 implements the plan's actual rule near the floor.
- Every programme's settings (risk, k , stop, payout target, market) were searched over 10,941 grid settings and 401 refined ones (28 million simulated attempts), then re-measured on sixteen fresh paths each.
- The engine was checked against the chain with the daily rules switched off (Chapter 11), and the rules' own effect measured with them on.
- The accounts were run together, one person at a time, each simulated life on its own new paths: 8,400 first years, 800 three-year lives, and the budget and stress scenarios.

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Notation and conventions

Symbol	Meaning
S	account size
F	fee per attempt
A, A_1, A_2	profit target of a phase
B	maximum loss of a phase (distance to the floor)
b	safety buffer above the floor (\$100 per \$100K)
d	daily loss limit
D	funded allowance
α	profit split
R	fee refund
X_1, X	funded payout target: first, later
L, l	risk per trade: the plan's, and the one actually used
k	reward-to-risk setting
w	net win of a trade, after caps and costs
c, ρ	round-trip cost of a trade; per dollar of risk, $\rho = \kappa / (m\sigma)$
σ	hourly standard deviation of the log price
m	stop distance in hourly standard deviations
N	notional of a position, $l / (m\sigma)$
κ	round-trip cost as a fraction of the notional
λ	leverage (1: λ)
p	win probability of one bracket
P, P_1, P_2	pass probability
q_1, q	probability that a funded cycle reaches its payout target
X_{end}	balance at which an attempt or account ends
V, C, T	value of an attempt, funded cash, duration
K	expected total cost of a phase or cycle
EV/month	$30.44 \mathbb{E}[V] / \mathbb{E}[T]$ in days, a long-run rate

Money is in US dollars. A 100K account is \$100,000 of simulated capital. $\pm$ is a 95% Monte Carlo interval under the model. "Fresh paths" are synthetic price paths that played no part in choosing the setting they measure. "Engine" is the rule-by-rule simulation; "chain" the exact trade-level equations; "Brownian" the continuous approximation. Tiers A, B, D are the firms' reliability classes (Chapter 29).

The mathematics, from zero

Every result in this document follows from a handful of facts about fair games. This part derives each of them, says exactly which model each formula is exact for, and works the numbers of the plan through at every step. Where a formula is an approximation it is labelled as one, and the engine (the rule-by-rule simulation) supplies the figure that is used.

What is being bought

A proprietary trading firm ("prop firm") sells an *evaluation*. You pay a fee, you trade a simulated account under written rules, and if you meet the profit targets without breaking a loss limit, the firm gives you a *funded* account. On the funded account you keep a share of every profit you withdraw, and the firm absorbs every loss. You never owe the firm money beyond the fee.

That last sentence is the whole opportunity. Your downside is capped at the fee, and your upside is a share of profits that, as Chapter 7 shows, have a positive expected size even when every trade is a coin flip. The contract is an *option*: you pay a premium (the fee) for the right to keep part of the gains of a game whose losses fall on someone else.

1.1 The parts of the contract

Symbol	Meaning	FTMO 2-Step 100K, as an example
S	account size (simulated money)	\$100,000
F	fee for one attempt	€540 = \$607.82 at 1.1256
A_1, A_2	profit targets of phase 1 and phase 2	\$10,000 and \$5,000
B	maximum loss: the floor sits B below the starting balance and never moves ("static")	\$10,000
d	daily loss limit, measured from a reference level set at each day's reset	\$5,000
D	maximum loss on the funded account (the "allowance")	\$10,000
α	your share ("split") of every profit withdrawn	80%
R	fee refund, paid with the first payout	\$607.82
—	minimum trading days, payout cycle, other rules	4 days per phase; payouts every 14 days

1.2 The value of one attempt

Call the cash an attempt brings you V . It is the fee (always paid), plus, if both phases are passed, whatever the funded account pays out (the refund included):

VALUE OF ONE ATTEMPT

$$V = -F + \mathbf{1}\{\text{pass}\} \cdot C, \quad \mathbb{E}[V] = -F + \Pr(\text{pass}) \cdot \mathbb{E}[C \mid \text{pass}]$$

Here $\mathbf{1}\{\text{pass}\}$ is 1 if both phases are passed and 0 otherwise, and C is the total cash from the funded account. Where a firm returns part of the fee as non-cash credit when a phase is passed (The5ers), that credit is a third term, counted separately from cash (Chapter 14).

1.3 The whole argument in five lines, in an idealised model

Before the details, the result in its simplest form: no trading costs, every phase ending exactly at its target or its floor, and payouts of a fixed cycle target X from a static allowance. Chapter 5 proves that a fair game reaches $+A$ before $-B$ with probability $B/(A+B)$ in that model; Chapter 7 proves that a funded account then withdraws on average exactly D before it is lost, and reaches its first payout with probability $q = D/(D+X)$. The refund comes only with that first payout, so it is weighted by q :

FTMO 2-STEP, ZERO COST, ZERO SKILL, IDEALISED

$$\Pr(\text{pass}) = \frac{B}{A_1 + B} \cdot \frac{B}{A_2 + B} = \frac{10,000}{20,000} \cdot \frac{10,000}{15,000} = \frac{1}{3}$$

$$\mathbb{E}[V] = -F + \Pr(\text{pass})(\alpha D + q R) = -632 + \frac{1}{3} \left(8,000 + \frac{10,000}{10,000+X} 632 \right)$$

At the version 6 fee of \$632 this is \$2,140.00 with a cycle of $X = \$10,000$ and \$2,087.33 with $X = \$30,000$; version 6 printed \$2,245, which counts the refund on every pass and is only the limit as $X \rightarrow 0$. At the correct fee of \$607.82 and $X = \$10,000$ it is $-607.82 + \frac{1}{3}(8,000 + 303.91) = \$2,160.15$.

Everything else in this document refines this number: trading costs lower it; the plan's policies (flat every evening, at most 40% of a target from one trade or one day, an attempt closed before it reaches the floor in micro size) change both the value and the time; and the settings are then chosen to make the most of it per month and per person. The sign is already visible here; its size needs the full engine.

1.4 Why the firm still makes money, and what that implies

The firm's revenue is the fees of everyone, and most traders are not zero-skill traders with a plan built around the contract: they over-trade, break rules, abandon accounts and stop after one failure. A plan that treats the contract as a mathematical object and repeats it many times is the case the firm's pricing does not cover. Firms know this, and their terms contain behavioural rules (against "gambling", "all-in" trading, one-trade target attainment, account rolling) that are written broadly and applied at their discretion. The plan is built to meet every rule that can be stated as a condition on trades, and Chapter 31 lists the behavioural rules that cannot, firm by firm, as conditions under which the figures here apply.

The probability toolkit

Seven ideas carry the analysis. Each is stated with the conditions it needs.

2.1 Expected value and linearity

A random quantity X that takes values $x_1, x_2, \dots$ with probabilities $p_1, p_2, \dots$ has expected value $\mathbb{E}[X] = \sum_i p_i x_i$. For any random quantities, dependent or not,

$$\mathbb{E}[X + Y] = \mathbb{E}[X] + \mathbb{E}[Y], \quad \mathbb{E}[cX] = c \mathbb{E}[X].$$

Linearity says that the expected cash of many accounts *over one horizon, under one policy* is the sum of their expected cash over that horizon, however strongly they move together. It does not say that a first year's average equals a long-run rate (they are different quantities, Chapter 8.5), and it does not make correlation irrelevant: correlation leaves the sum of the means alone and changes everything else (the spread, the cash needed for fees, the chance of many failures at once).

2.2 Variance

$\text{Var}(X) = \mathbb{E}[(X - \mathbb{E}X)^2] = \mathbb{E}[X^2] - (\mathbb{E}X)^2$. For independent X, Y variances add; for dependent ones a term $2 \text{Cov}(X, Y)$ is added. Variance enters the time a fair game takes (Chapter 8) and the confidence intervals of every simulated figure.

2.3 Fair games and martingales

A sequence of balances $X_0, X_1, \dots$ is a *martingale* if $\mathbb{E}[X_{n+1} \mid X_0, \dots, X_n] = X_n$. "Zero skill" means this for the balance before costs: the price is a martingale, the balance is a sum of positions times price changes, and no rule for direction, size or timing that uses only the past can change that. With costs the expected next balance is lower by the cost: a *supermartingale*.

2.4 Stopping times and the optional stopping theorem

A *stopping time* τ is a rule for when to stop that uses only information available at the time. The *optional stopping theorem*: if X is a martingale, τ is almost surely finite, and the stopped process $X_{n \wedge \tau}$ is bounded (or, more generally, uniformly integrable), then

$$\mathbb{E}[X_\tau] = X_0.$$

Each use below states why the condition holds. For one phase it holds because the balance stays between the floor and the target plus one win. For a funded account whose profits are withdrawn the balance plus everything withdrawn is *not* bounded, so Chapter 7 applies the theorem to one payout cycle at a time, where it is.

2.5 Wald's identity

If each step adds an amount with mean μ and τ is a stopping time with $\mathbb{E}[\tau] < \infty$, then $\mathbb{E}[X_\tau - X_0] = \mu \mathbb{E}[\tau]$. With costs, every trade's mean is minus its own cost (4.3), so the identity becomes $\mathbb{E}[X_\tau - X_0] = -\mathbb{E}[\text{total cost}]$, which holds even when the cost varies from trade to trade.

2.6 Brownian motion

The continuous-time limit of a fair random walk is Brownian motion W_t : it starts at 0, has independent increments, and $W_{t+h} - W_t$ is normal with mean 0 and variance h . A process $X_t = \mu t + \sigma W_t$ has three martingales that carry the approximations of Chapters 5 and 8:

$$X_t - \mu t, \quad (X_t - \mu t)^2 - \sigma^2 t, \quad \exp\left(-\frac{2\mu}{\sigma^2} X_t\right).$$

The third follows from Itô's formula: $de^{\lambda X} = e^{\lambda X}(\lambda\mu + \frac{1}{2}\lambda^2\sigma^2)dt + (\dots)dW$, whose dt term vanishes for $\lambda = -2\mu/\sigma^2$. These formulas are exact for Brownian motion; applied to a sum of bracket trades, which jump, they are approximations (5.2).

2.7 The reflection principle

For a Brownian path from a to b over a time with variance v , the chance that it rose above $y \geq \max(a, b)$ in between is

$$\Pr(\max \geq y \mid a \rightarrow b) = \exp\left(-\frac{2(y-a)(y-b)}{v}\right).$$

This gives the *marginal* distribution of the maximum of a bridge (and, by symmetry, of the minimum). It does not by itself say which of a high and a low level was touched first. Chapter 3.3 describes how the simulation orders the two, and Chapter 11 measures what is left of the error.

The price model

3.1 Hourly volatility

Over one hour the log price changes by a random amount with standard deviation σ , the *hourly volatility*, measured on two years of real hourly bars (Yahoo Finance, 2024–26, only hours that follow another trading hour):

Market	Price, 2 Oct 2026	Hourly σ	Daily σ	Round-trip cost κ	κ/σ	Entry hours used (UTC)
Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100)	31,070.00	0.2737%	1.31%	0.0064%	0.023	01–18
USDJPY	157.83	0.1193%	0.58%	0.0051%	0.043	00–18
EURUSD	1.126	0.0853%	0.42%	0.0062%	0.073	07–18
gold (XAUUSD)	4,176.80	0.2838%	1.36%	0.0108%	0.038	01–18
micro Nasdaq futures (MNQ)	31,070.00	0.2737%	1.31%	0.0027%	0.010	01–18

σ : standard deviation of hourly log returns on 2024–26 data (sigma_v32.json); daily = hourly $\times \sqrt{23}$ (indices, gold) or $\sqrt{24}$ (currencies). κ : spread + commission + slippage allowance as a fraction of the notional, per round trip (calibrate.py). κ/σ is the cost of one hourly standard deviation of movement. Entry hours: the market's hours, cut at 19:00 UTC by the daily flat (no entry from 19:00, everything closed at 20:00).

Over h hours the standard deviation grows like $\sigma\sqrt{h}$: the Nasdaq moves about 1.31% in a 23-hour trading day. Every stop in the plan is a multiple of σ , so the same rules fit every market.

3.2 Zero drift, stated precisely

The model gives the *price* no expected change: $\mathbb{E}[P_{t+h} | P_t] = P_t$. That is the zero-skill assumption. For the price itself to be a martingale, the log price must drift down by $\sigma^2/2$ per hour (about 0.0004% for the Nasdaq): $\log P_{t+h} - \log P_t$ is normal with mean $-\sigma^2 h/2$ and variance $\sigma^2 h$. Version 6 said the log price had mean zero; the construction in 3.3 always included the correction, and the statement is now made about the price. The Nasdaq's real long-run rise (about 0.0025% per hour, a hundredth of σ) is left out: the plan is long and short equally often, so it would neither help nor hurt.

3.3 Synthetic paths

- Each hour is split into 12 sub-steps of normal increments of the log price with variance $\sigma^2/12$ and mean $-\sigma^2/24$.
- Within each sub-step, the highest and the lowest point are drawn from the exact marginal distributions of a Brownian bridge between the sub-step's end points (2.7):

$$\max = \frac{1}{2} \left(a + b + \sqrt{(b-a)^2 - 2v \ln U} \right), \quad U \sim \text{Uniform}(0, 1),$$

and the minimum is the mirror image with an independent draw.

- When a stop and a target both fall inside one hourly bar, the engine replays that hour's twelve sub-steps in time order and takes the level the path touched first. The order is therefore exact unless both levels fall inside the *same* five-minute sub-step; only then does it fall back to the trade's overall fair chance, which is not the right conditional probability. Chapter 11 measures the remaining effect at 12 and at 60 sub-steps.
- Markets that close at weekends are closed in the path from Friday to Sunday, but the price keeps moving underneath, so Monday can open with a gap. Under the plan's daily flat (6.5) no position is open then.
- Every path is fixed by its seed. Each stage of the work uses its own seeds, never reused: the grid search paths 101–104, the refinement 111–114, the final value of every chosen setting 121–136 (sixteen independent paths), the sensitivities 141–144, the checks 401–444, and the portfolio simulation one new path per simulated life (seeds 100,000 and up). Gold, USDJPY and EURUSD use their own paths (seed + 50, + 60, + 70), independent of the Nasdaq; Chapter 28 measures what a correlation of 0.3 between all four markets changes.

3.4 What the model leaves out

Real prices have volatility that changes (calm and wild months), fat tails, jumps at news, and spreads that widen at the daily break and around releases. The plan's stops are at least 0.35 hourly standard deviations so that average costs are a fair description, and the cost stress tests of Chapter 31 double every cost. The synthetic model is the right tool for the question asked (what is the contract worth to a trader with no edge), not a forecast of any particular year.

The bracket trade

Every trade in the plan is a *bracket*: one position with a stop-loss and a take-profit attached the moment it opens, never moved, and closed at the latest at 20:00 UTC the same day.

4.1 Set-up

Open a long position at price e with notional N dollars (a short is the mirror image), stop a fraction s below the entry and target a fraction u above. The plan fixes three things and derives the rest:

- the **risk** l : what a stopped trade loses before costs. Normally $l = L$ (1–1.75% of the account, searched in Chapter 9), but never more than the room left, net of the trade's own cost (5.4);
- the **stop distance** $s = m\sigma$: m hourly standard deviations;
- the **win** w the trade nets after costs if it reaches its target: $w = \min(kl, \text{distance to the target, caps})$, where k is the reward-to-risk setting and the caps are the plan's 40% concentration policy (6.7) and any firm cap.

POSITION AND TARGET

$$N = \frac{l}{s}, \quad Nu - c = w \Rightarrow u = \frac{s(w + c)}{l}.$$

A win pays $+w$ and a loss costs $-(l + c)$, where $c = \kappa N$ is the round-trip cost (spread, commission, slippage allowance) of this position.

4.2 The win probability

The price is a martingale and the trade ends at the first touch of the stop or the target. If nothing else can end it and fills are exact, the exit price is bounded, so optional stopping (2.4) gives $pe(1 + u) + (1 - p)e(1 - s) = e$, i.e. $p = s/(s + u)$:

WIN PROBABILITY OF A ZERO-SKILL BRACKET (FIXED COST, EXACT FILLS)

$$p = \frac{l}{l + w + c} = \frac{1}{1 + w/l + c/l}.$$

4.3 The mean and the variance of one trade

With outcomes $+w$ (probability p) and $-(l + c)$:

$$\mathbb{E}[\text{pnl}] = pw - (1 - p)(l + c) = \frac{lw - (w + c)(l + c)}{l + w + c} = -c,$$

$$\text{Var}(\text{pnl}) = p(w + c)^2 + (1 - p)l^2 = l(w + c).$$

These hold for the binary trade of 4.2 with a cost known at entry. Two things in the plan make some outcomes non-binary. A trade still open at 20:00 UTC is closed at that hour's price, somewhere between stop and target; the price is still a martingale and the closing time a bounded stopping time, so the mean is still $-c$, but the variance is smaller and the distribution has three parts. And a price that gaps through a level fills at the gap. The engine simulates both; the chain of Chapter 5 uses the binary trade.

4.4 What a trade costs

The round-trip cost is a fraction κ of the notional, so per dollar of risk

$$\rho \equiv \frac{c}{l} = \frac{\kappa N}{l} = \frac{\kappa}{m\sigma}.$$

Market	ρ at $m = 0.35$	0.5	0.75	1.0	1.25	at cost $\times 2$, $m = 0.5$	$m = 1.0$
Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100)	6.68%	4.68%	3.12%	2.34%	1.87%	9.35%	4.68%
USDJPY	12.21%	8.55%	5.70%	4.27%	3.42%	17.10%	8.55%
EURUSD	20.78%	14.55%	9.70%	7.27%	5.82%	29.09%	14.55%
gold (XAUUSD)	10.87%	7.61%	5.07%	3.81%	3.04%	15.22%	7.61%

The round-trip cost in units of the risk, $\rho = c/l = \kappa/(m\sigma)$, for stops of m hourly standard deviations. The plan holds nothing through a daily reset, so there is no financing to add (version 6 paid up to 16% of the risk per night held at a tight Nasdaq stop).

Version 6 held winning trades through nights and paid overnight financing φN per rollover, a cost that is random (it depends on how long the trade lasts) and was not in the formulas. Version 7 holds no position through a daily reset (6.5), so there is no financing to add, and ρ is the whole cost.

4.5 The plan's trade on the Nasdaq, worked through

The plan's FTMO setting is risk $L = \$1,500$ (1.50% of \$100,000), a stop of $m = 0.75$ hourly standard deviations, $k = 8$ and a payout target of \$20,000. The first trade of phase 1 aims at $w = \min(kL, A, 0.4A) = \min(\$12,000, \$10,000, \$4,000) = \$4,000$. With the Nasdaq at 31,070:

Stop distance: $s = m\sigma = 0.75 \times 0.2737\% = 0.2053\%$ of the price, i.e. 63.8 index points.

Notional: $N = l/s = \$730,758$, i.e. \$23.52 per index point. If one lot is worth \$1 per point (read the contract specification), 23.52 lots, rounded down.

Cost: $c = \kappa N = 0.0064\% \times \$730,758 = \$46.77$, so $\rho = c/l = 3.12\%$.

Target: $u = s(w + c)/l = 0.2053\% \times 4,046.77/1,500 = 0.5538\%$, i.e. 172.1 points from the entry.

Win probability: $p = l/(l + w + c) = 1,500/(1,500 + 4,000 + 46.77) = 0.2704$.

Mean $-c = -\$46.77$; check: $p w - (1 - p)(l + c) = -46.77$. Variance $l(w + c) = 6,070,153$, standard deviation \$2,464.

Margin at 1:50: $N/50 = \$14,615 = 14.6\%$ of the starting balance; the engine re-checks it against the current balance at every entry (10.2).

Duration (8.1, approximate): $m^2(w + c)/l = 1.52$ hours of open market on average; losers 1.20 h, winners 2.38 h. A trade still open at 20:00 UTC is closed there.

On the funded account (payout target \$20,000) a full win is $\min(k L, 0.4X) = \$8,000$: take-profit 342 points away, $p = 0.1571$, winners 7.4 hours of open market on average, so some are cut by the daily flat and some wait for the next day's cap.

4.6 Ways a simulation can flatter a trade

1. **Skipping the entry bar.** Checking levels only from the next hour ignores stop-outs inside the entry hour. (Measured in version 4: +0.14 R per trade, all fake.)
2. **Sampling prices too rarely.** A few prices an hour miss touches in between, and the nearer level (the stop) is missed more often. The bridge extremes of 3.3 remove it.
3. **Ties inside one bar.** When one bar's range contains both levels, the bar alone does not say which came first. Version 5 used the fair chance; version 6 replays the sub-steps (3.3). The remaining tie inside one five-minute step is measured in Chapter 11 at 12 and 60 sub-steps.
4. **Gaps.** A price that opens beyond the stop fills at the open. Under the daily flat there is no overnight or weekend position to gap.
5. **A rounding error at the target.** A win sized to close the gap to the target lands a few billionths of a dollar short in floating point; version 6's exact comparison then placed a pointless extra trade (risking \$1,500 to make \$1). Version 7 compares with a one-cent tolerance.

Reaching a target before a floor

A phase is passed when the balance gains A before it loses B : the gambler's ruin. This chapter solves it in an idealised model, then exactly for the plan's actual rule.

5.1 The idealised model: $P = B/(A + B)$

Let X_n be the balance after n trades, a martingale with $X_0 = 0$, and τ the first time it reaches $+A$ or $-B$. If every trade is sized so the balance lands exactly on one of the two, X_τ is $+A$ with probability P and $-B$ otherwise, and optional stopping gives

$$0 = \mathbb{E}[X_\tau] = P A - (1 - P) B \Rightarrow P = \frac{B}{A + B}.$$

The exact-landing assumption is what this formula needs, and Section 5.4 shows that the plan's rule does not land exactly on the floor (it stops a little above it). The formula is the benchmark; 5.5 gives the exact value for the actual rule.

5.2 With costs, approximately: the Brownian formula

Treat the balance as a Brownian motion with drift $-c$ and variance $v = l(w + c)$ per trade. By 2.6, $e^{\theta X}$ with $\theta = 2c/v$ is a martingale, and optional stopping gives

PASS PROBABILITY WITH COSTS (BROWNIAN APPROXIMATION)

$$P \approx \frac{e^{\theta B} - 1}{e^{\theta(A+B)} - 1}, \quad \theta = \frac{2c}{v} = \frac{2\rho}{l(w/l + \rho)}, \quad P \approx \frac{B}{A + B} \left(1 - \frac{cA}{v}\right).$$

This is accurate when each trade is small next to A and B and its size does not change. The plan's trades are capped (40% of the target), shrink near the floor and the daily limit, and jump: the exact chain of 5.5 is used instead, and the Brownian value is shown only for comparison.

5.3 How many trades, approximately

With a constant trade, $(X_n)^2 - nv$ is a martingale before costs, so $\mathbb{E}[\tau] = \mathbb{E}[X_\tau^2]/v = AB/v$ in the idealised model. With trades that change size the relevant quantity is the accumulated variance $\sum_n v(X_n)$, not v times the count; the chain computes the expected count exactly.

5.4 The plan's rule near the floor

Version 6's written rule (risk = the room above the floor less a \$100 buffer; wait for tomorrow when that is below \$150) could leave an account a few dollars above its static floor with no trade ever allowed, and its engine did something different again (it traded micro positions of the remaining room). Version 7 has one rule, the same in the text, the engine and the chain. At a balance x (relative to the start), with floor $-B$, buffer b (\$100 per \$100K) and the cost per dollar of risk ρ :

RISK OF THE NEXT TRADE, AND WHEN THE ATTEMPT ENDS

$$\text{room}(x) = \frac{x + B - b}{1 + \rho}, \quad l(x) = \min(L, \text{room}(x), \text{today's room}, \text{margin room}),$$

the attempt ends at x (a failure) if $\text{room}(x) < l_{\min} = \max(0.1 L, \text{one futures contract})$.

A stopped trade then loses $l(1 + \rho) \leq x + B - b$, so the balance never reaches the floor through a stop: every failure is an *abandonment* at a balance between $-B + b$ and $-B + b + l_{\min}(1 + \rho)$. In practice: the account is no longer traded, the replacement is bought, and the old account lapses. Nothing in any firm's rules obliges a trader to trade an account down to its floor. (When only today's room is too small, the account waits for tomorrow; today's room resets, the static room does not.)

5.5 The exact chain

The balance after each trade is a Markov chain on $[-B + b, A]$. At x the next trade has risk $l(x)$ as above, win $w(x) = \max(\min(k l(x), A - x, \text{cap}), \$1)$, cost $c(x) = \rho l(x)$ and win chance $p(x) = l/(l + w + c)$, and moves to $x + w$ or $x - l - c$. Four functions solve the same recursion with different end values:

ONE STEP OF THE EXACT CHAIN

$$\begin{aligned} V(x) &= p V(x + w) + (1 - p) V(x - l - c), & V &= 1 \text{ at } A, 0 \text{ where the attempt ends,} \\ N(x) &= 1 + p N(x + w) + (1 - p) N(x - l - c), & K(x) &= c(x) + p K(x + w) + (1 - p) K(x - l - c), \\ T(x) &= p T(x + w) + (1 - p) T(x - l - c), & T &= \text{the balance where the attempt ends.} \end{aligned}$$

V is the pass probability, N the expected number of trades, K the expected total cost and T the expected final balance. They are solved by value iteration on a grid of about 8,000 points (analytic_v7.py). Because every trade's mean is exactly minus its own cost (4.3) and the stopped balance is bounded, optional stopping gives the general accounting identity, which the solver checks:

$$P A + (1 - P) \mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -K(0) \implies P = \frac{\mathbb{E}[-X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] - K(0)}{A + \mathbb{E}[-X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}]}.$$

The textbook form $P = (B - K)/(A + B)$ is the special case where every failure ends exactly at $-B$. Under the plan's rule a failure ends about b above the floor, so $\mathbb{E}[-X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}]$ is a little less than B and the textbook form overstates P slightly (0.25% to 0.37% (percentage points) over the chosen programmes).

FTMO phase 1 ($A = B = \$10,000$, buffer \$100) at the plan's setting (risk \$1,500, $k = 8$, $m = 0.75$, $\rho = 3.12\%$). No win can exceed $0.4A = \$4,000$, so no single win ends the phase from the start; the first trades along the all-loss path:

Trade j on the all-loss path	Balance x_j	Risk l_j	Cost c_j	Win w_j	p_j	A win ends the phase?
1	\$0	\$1,500	\$46.77	\$4,000	0.2704	no
2	-\$1,547	\$1,500	\$46.77	\$4,000	0.2704	no
3	-\$3,094	\$1,500	\$46.77	\$4,000	0.2704	no
4	-\$4,640	\$1,500	\$46.77	\$4,000	0.2704	no
5	-\$6,187	\$1,500	\$46.77	\$4,000	0.2704	no
6	-\$7,734	\$1,500	\$46.77	\$4,000	0.2704	no
7	-\$9,281	\$601	\$18.73	\$4,000	0.1300	no

Chain (5.5): $P_1 = 0.4585$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 16.80$, $K(0) = \$774$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$9,896$.

Identity: $P_1 A + (1 - P_1) \mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = 0.4585 \times 10,000 + 0.5415 \times (-9,896) = -773.83 = -K(0)$ (gap +0.0000).

Textbook form $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.4613$, 0.28 percentage points above the exact value, because a failure ends about \$100 above the floor, not on it.

Brownian approximation (5.2) with a constant full-size trade: $P_1 \approx 0.4616$.

Phase 2 ($A = \$5,000$, wins capped at \$2,000): $P_2 = 0.6111$, 17.16 trades, $K = \$793$. Both: $P = 0.2802$ (chain).

The engine (with the daily limit, the daily flat, minimum days, the per-day concentration cap and weekends), on sixteen fresh paths: $P = 0.2765 \pm 0.0057$. With those rules switched off (11.2) it gives 0.2793 ± 0.0095 , against the chain's 0.2802.

5.6 Bold play, and why the plan does not use it

Each trade costs c on average, so a phase's pass probability falls with its expected total cost (5.5). The way to pay the least cost is to need the fewest trades: stake enough to reach the target in one win. This is *bold play*, which Dubins and Savage (1965) proved optimal for reaching a goal in a fair or slightly unfavourable game. Version 6's search found it: left free, every programme moved to k of 20–30 and payout cycles of 25–30% of the account, so that a single trade could pass a phase or fill a payout.

Version 7 gives that up, deliberately. Several firms forbid exactly this behaviour: Fintokei forbids reaching a target "in one or a few identical trades", The5ers bans "one-trade target attainment" permanently, Alpha forbids "all or nothing" trading, FundingPips' Profit Concentration Policy reacts to one trade idea above 60% of a target, and FundedNext, Hola Prime, FTMO and FXIFY reserve the right to treat concentrated outcomes as gambling. The plan therefore caps every trade and every day at 40% of the current target (6.7), so that every phase and every payout takes at least three winning days. Under that cap one win can never end a phase, the product formula for bold play (the chance of passing as a sequence of all-or-nothing trades) never applies, and the chain of 5.5 is the exact value.

For reference, the bold product formula, $P = \sum_j p_j \prod_{i < j} (1 - p_i)$ with $x_{j+1} = x_j - l_j - c_j$, is exact only if *every* possible win ends the phase, i.e. $k l(x_j) \geq A - x_j$ at every state on the all-loss path; $kL \geq A + B$ is not enough, because $l(x)$ shrinks near the floor. Version 6's tables printed wins of $A - x_j$ even where $k l(x_j)$ was smaller; those rows described trades the plan would not place.

k	Phase 1 trades, 40% cap	P , 40% cap	Attempt value, 40% cap	Phase 1 trades, no cap	P , no cap	Attempt value, no cap
1.5	29.2	0.2623	+\$802	29.2	0.2649	+\$815
2	22.2	0.2724	+\$1,015	22.2	0.2799	+\$1,060
3	16.9	0.2800	+\$1,241	15.3	0.2955	+\$1,343
4	16.8	0.2801	+\$1,338	11.7	0.3035	+\$1,501
6	16.8	0.2801	+\$1,413	8.4	0.3108	+\$1,662
8	16.8	0.2802	+\$1,414	6.6	0.3145	+\$1,748
12	16.8	0.2802	+\$1,414	5.2	0.3166	+\$1,816
20	16.8	0.2802	+\$1,415	5.2	0.3168	+\$1,865
30	16.8	0.2802	+\$1,415	5.1	0.3170	+\$1,868

Exact chain, FTMO 2-Step 100K at the plan's stop $m = 0.75$, risk \$1,500 and payout target \$20,000. Without the cap the value keeps rising with k toward bold play; with it, k beyond the cap changes nothing.

In the engine, at the plan's setting: \$2,930 $\pm$ \$294 a month with the 40% policy, \$3,661 $\pm$ \$805 with a 60% cap and \$4,345 $\pm$ \$763 with no cap at the same k (paths 141–144). Version 6's uncapped FTMO setting ($k = 20$, $m = 0.5$, $X = 30\%$) was worth \$5,463 a month in its own final run.

The evaluation in full

6.1 Two phases

Always, $\Pr(\text{pass both}) = P_1 \cdot \Pr(\text{pass 2} \mid \text{passed 1})$. In the simulation's model the second phase starts on a fresh account and its trades are independent of the first's, so the conditional probability equals the unconditional P_2 and the product $P_1 P_2$ holds. On real markets a volatile month that carries from one phase into the next could link them; zero edge alone does not rule that out, and the product is a model statement, not a theorem about markets. The engine simulates the two phases in sequence on one path, so whatever its path carries over is included.

Version 6 also said that putting the larger target first saves time and cost. It does not in general: with the Brownian trade count of 5.3 and targets A, C over a common B , the expected number of trades is $AB/v + \frac{B}{A+B} \cdot CB/v$, which for $A = 10,000, C = 5,000, B = 10,000$ and $v = 1,500^2 \times 5$ is 11.11 trades, against 10.37 with the targets reversed. The claim is withdrawn.

6.2 The daily loss limit

Most firms add a floor that is reset every day: the account may not fall more than d below a reference level fixed at the reset. Firms fix that level differently:

Firm	Reference fixed at the reset	Reset	Limit
FTMO	balance	00:00 Prague (22:00/23:00 UTC)	5% of the initial balance
FundingPips	higher of balance and equity	00:00 Prague	4% of the initial balance
The5ers	higher of balance and equity	00:00 broker time	5%
FXIFY	higher of balance and equity	17:00 New York	4%
FundedNext	balance or equity at the reset	00:00 broker time	5%
Fintokei	equity	00:00 UTC	5% of the start-of-day equity
Hola Prime	previous day's closing balance	00:00 broker time	5%
Alpha Capital	balance	00:00 broker time	5%
GFT	higher of balance and equity	17:00 New York (21:00/22:00 UTC)	5%
FunderPro	balance	00:00 broker time	5%
BrightFunded	original balance	23:30–23:59 Prague	5%
Blue Guardian	higher of balance and equity	17:00 New York	4%
Maven	higher of balance and equity	00:00 UTC	4%

As published (4 October 2026). Every reset falls between 20:00 and 00:00 UTC, while the plan holds no position, so balance and equity are equal whenever a reference is fixed.

With an open position at the reset, an equity-based or higher-of reference rises with the open profit, and a smooth reversal can then break the day's limit with no gap at all (the review's example: a Fintokei account at \$110,000 of equity at midnight has a floor of \$104,500 for the day). Version 6's claim that only a gap could break the limit was wrong for those firms. Version 7 is flat at every reset (6.5), so equity equals balance whenever any firm fixes its reference, and every rule in the table reduces to a fixed dollar amount for the day (for Fintokei, 5% of the start-of-day balance, which the engine applies as such). Within the day, every trade's risk plus its cost fits the room left (5.4); after two or three losses the account waits for the next day.

6.3 Minimum trading days: the joint condition

FTMO (4), FundedNext (5), BrightFunded (5), FXIFY Classic (4) and Alpha (3) require days with at least one trade. A phase is passed when the target is met *and* the days are complete at the same time. If the target is reached first, the plan stops trading the strategy and places one minimal trade (smallest lot, held at least 2 minutes) on each remaining weekday. Each costs a few cents to a few dollars; to make sure they cannot take the balance back under the target, the target the engine trades to is the firm's target plus \$20 per \$100K. Filler days are weekdays (five in seven calendar days). This is not done where the rule counts *profitable* days (6.4).

6.4 Profitable-day rules

The5ers, Fintokei, Maven, Blue Guardian, GFT (whose days count only with +0.5%) and FundingPips' 95% option require days with at least +0.5% profit. While such days are missing, the plan trades normally until the day's profit reaches

$$g_{\text{today}} = \max\left(0.55\% S, \frac{\text{distance left to the target}}{\text{profitable days still needed}}\right)$$

and then stops for the day; every trade is a full fair bracket whose take-profit is capped at what is left of today's target. Stopping at a daily target is a stopping time, so in a cost-free fair game the pass probability is unchanged; with costs, every extra trade costs c , so these rules lower the value as well as stretching the time. Version 6 said they change "only time"; that holds only without costs and is withdrawn. The engine measures their effect in every programme's chapter.

6.5 The daily flat, weekends and news

The plan opens no position from 19:00 UTC and closes every position at the 20:00 UTC open, every weekday. Every daily reset in the plan falls between 20:00 and 00:00 UTC (FTMO and BrightFunded near midnight Prague time, GFT and Blue Guardian at 5 pm New York, Fintokei and Maven at 00:00 UTC), so the account is flat at each of them. This also removes overnight financing, overnight and weekend gaps, and the widened spreads of the daily break. The cost is time: a trade still open at 20:00 is closed between its stop and its target (a fair outcome) and the next one waits until the next day's open.

News. Restricted news windows differ by firm (Maven: no opening or closing within 2 minutes of a red-folder release, in evaluations too; FundingPips: profits from 5 minutes before to 5 minutes after may be deducted; FTMO funded: no new orders within 2 minutes; FundedNext: 40% of news profit counted on funded accounts). A bracket opened earlier can still reach its stop or target inside a window. The plan closes positions before any release that a firm restricts for the account's stage and market (US, euro-area and Japanese releases alike) and opens nothing until the window has passed. The engine has no news calendar; Chapter 28 runs a bounding test in which every account is flat from 12:00 to 14:00 UTC (and 08:00 to 09:00 on EURUSD) every weekday.

6.6 Review time

Firms take one to three working days to check a passed phase and issue the next account. The engine adds one day after phase 1 and the firm's stated time after phase 2.

6.7 The concentration policy

On every account the plan caps the win of every trade at 40% of the current target (the phase target in an evaluation, the payout target on a funded account), and stops for the day once the day's profit reaches 40% of that target. Three consequences follow:

- every phase and every payout needs at least three winning days, so no outcome rests on one trade or one day;
- FundingPips' Profit Concentration Policy (60% of a phase target from one trade idea) can never trigger, and FXIFY's 25%, Hola Prime's 40% and Maven's 20% rules are met by their own tighter caps;
- the effective reward-to-risk is capped: in phase 2 of a 5% target on 100K a win is at most \$2,000, so at 1.5% risk at most 1.33 : 1. The search (Chapter 9) therefore covers smaller k and the risk per trade.

Chapter 9 measures what the policy costs against the uncapped strategy of version 6, programme by programme.

What a funded account pays

On the funded account the plan trades each *payout cycle* to a profit target X above the starting balance, stops, requests the payout on the first allowed day, and withdraws everything above the start. The balance is back at the start, the static floor is still D below it, and the next cycle begins. If a payout date comes before the target, the plan withdraws whatever profit there is (where the firm's rules allow) and starts a new cycle; the cycle formulas below describe the simpler policy of paying only at the target, and the engine simulates the plan's. The account ends when it is abandoned near the floor under the rule of 5.4 (or, at a few firms, after a fixed number of payouts).

7.1 The withdrawal identity, with its conditions

Take one cycle. Its balance (relative to the start) is a stopped sum of trades, bounded between $-D$ and X plus one win, so optional stopping applies to it: if cycle i ends with balance Z_i (either its target X_i , withdrawn, or the abandonment level) after costs K_i , then $\mathbb{E}[Z_i] = -\mathbb{E}[K_i]$. The account's total withdrawal is $W = \sum_i X_i \mathbf{1}\{\text{cycle } i \text{ paid}\}$ and it ends with balance X_{end} in its last cycle. Adding the cycles (the number of cycles has finite mean because each fails with a probability bounded away from zero):

THE WITHDRAWAL IDENTITY, GENERAL FORM

$$\mathbb{E}[W] = -\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{total funded cost}].$$

Only when the account always ends exactly at the floor ($X_{\text{end}} = -D$) does this become $\mathbb{E}[W] = D - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}]$, the form version 6 stated for every policy. It changes when the account can end elsewhere: abandonment a little above the floor (version 7's rule: $\mathbb{E}[-X_{\text{end}}]$ slightly below D), a daily-limit breach part-way down, profit forfeited (GFT's day cap, Maven's rolling cap), a closure after a fixed number of payouts (Apex), or a floor that moves (Topstep, Apex). Version 6 asserted the static identity for the trailing futures accounts; that was wrong, and those chapters now report only what the engine measures. Version 6's proof also appealed to boundedness of the balance plus withdrawals, which is not bounded; the cycle-by-cycle argument above is the correct one.

7.2 Cycle by cycle

Each cycle is a fresh run of the chain of 5.5 from 0 to its target X_i before the abandonment level, with success chance q_i . Cycles continue until one fails, so cycle j is paid with probability $\prod_{i \leq j} q_i$. With a first cycle X_1 and later ones X (chances q_1, q):

FUNDED CASH, CYCLE FORM

$$\mathbb{E}[C] = \alpha \left(X_1 q_1 + X \frac{q_1 q}{1 - q} \right) + R \cdot q_1 q^{r-1},$$

where the refund R comes with the r -th payout ($r = 1$ at most firms; FundingPips Standard and Blue Guardian 4, Maven 3); a refund in r equal parts with the first r payouts (Hola Prime) contributes $\frac{R}{r} \sum_{j=1}^r q_1 q^{j-1}$. With *two* special first cycles (GFT: the first two payouts are capped, so the first two cycles have target X_a and chance q_a , later ones X_b, q_b):

TWO SPECIAL FIRST CYCLES (GFT)

$$\mathbb{E}[\text{paid cycles}] = q_a + q_a^2 + \frac{q_a^2 q_b}{1 - q_b} = q_a + \frac{q_a^2}{1 - q_b}, \quad \mathbb{E}[W] = X_a (q_a + q_a^2) + X_b \frac{q_a^2 q_b}{1 - q_b}.$$

(Version 6 printed $q_1/(1 - q)$ for GFT, the one-special-cycle formula; its number came from the correct one.) In the zero-cost idealised model $q = D/(X + D)$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{paid cycles}] = D/X$ and $\mathbb{E}[W] = D$, which is where the zero-cost example of 1.3 takes q from.

7.3 What the cycle target changes

In the idealised zero-cost model, nothing about the average. With costs, at fixed l and k , the expected number of funded trades grows with X : by 5.3 it is about XD/v per cycle times $(X + D)/X$ expected cycles, i.e. $D(X + D)/v$. So a larger cycle means *more* trades and more cost over the account's life, and more time between payouts; a smaller one means more payout requests and more waiting for payout dates. Version 6 said larger cycles mean fewer trades and less cost; that contradicted this formula and is withdrawn. With caps, daily targets and payout calendars the balance between the two effects is found by search (Chapter 9), and the measured effect of X is shown in each programme's chapter.

7.4 Funded rules and what they change

- **Best-day and largest-trade rules.** If no day may exceed a share β of a payout's profit, each day's take-profit is capped at βX less what the day has made (FXIFY 25%, Hola Prime 40%; the plan's own 40% everywhere). Maven requires the largest winning *trade* to be at most 20% of the payout's profit, so each win is capped at $0.2X$ and a payout is requested only when the rule holds.
- **Profitable days per cycle** (FundingPips 95%: 3; Hola Prime: 3; GFT: 4): the daily profit target of 6.4, applied per cycle.
- **Payout calendars.** The first payout is allowed 14 to 30 days after the account opens, then every 10 to 30 days. A cycle that reaches its target early waits, flat.
- **Payout caps** (GFT: the first two payouts at most 6% or \$10,000): the first two cycles aim at the cap.
- **Daily profit caps** (GFT: \$3,000 a day at every size, excess deducted): the take-profit is capped at what is left of the day's cap.
- **Rolling caps** (Maven: \$10,000 per trader per rolling 30 days, excess voided): the plan requests a payout only when the window has room for all of it, and otherwise waits.

Without costs, rules that only cap or delay wins leave the average withdrawal unchanged; with costs, each extra trade costs c , and rules that forfeit profit (day caps, rolling caps) change it directly. The engine includes all of them.

7.5 The plan's funded account, worked through

FTMO's funded account at the plan's setting: allowance $D = \$10,000$ (static), payout target $X = \$20,000$, wins capped at $0.4X = \$8,000$, split 80%, refund $R = \$607.82$ with the first payout.

One cycle is the chain of 5.5 from 0 to X : $q = 0.3053$, with 16.8 trades per cycle on average.

$\mathbb{E}[\text{paid cycles}] = q/(1 - q) = 0.4394$; $\mathbb{E}[W] = X q/(1 - q) = \$8,788$.

General identity (7.1): $-\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}] = 9,894 - 1,106 = \$8,788$ (gap +0.00); the static form $D - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}] = \$8,894$ is too high by the \$106 above the floor at which an account is closed.

$\mathbb{E}[C] = \alpha \mathbb{E}[W] + R q = 0.8 \times 8,788 + 607.82 \times 0.3053 = \$7,216$ (chain).

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
0	0.6947	\$0
1	0.2121	\$16,608
2	0.0647	\$32,608
3	0.0198	\$48,608
4	0.0060	\$64,608

Chain values. The cash of a funded account is lumpy: many pay nothing, a few pay several cycles.

The engine, on fresh paths, pays \$7,543 per funded account (the chain with the daily rules switched off in the engine: $\$6,970 \pm \561).

Time, and value per month

8.1 How long one trade lasts, approximately

For a driftless *arithmetic* Brownian motion with variance σ^2 per hour, $Z_t^2 - \sigma^2 t$ is a martingale, and stopping at $+d_t$ or $-d_s$ gives $\mathbb{E}[\tau] = d_s d_t / \sigma^2$. For the bracket, $d_s = m\sigma$ and $d_t = m\sigma(w + c)/l$:

EXPECTED DURATION OF A BRACKET (HOURS OF OPEN MARKET), APPROXIMATION

$$\mathbb{E}[\tau] \approx m^2 \frac{w+c}{l}, \quad \mathbb{E}[\tau \mid \text{win}] \approx \frac{m^2}{3} \left(\left(\frac{w+c}{l} \right)^2 + 2 \frac{w+c}{l} \right), \quad \mathbb{E}[\tau \mid \text{loss}] \approx \frac{m^2}{3} \left(1 + 2 \frac{w+c}{l} \right).$$

The synthetic price is geometric: its log has drift $-\sigma^2/2$ per hour, and the barriers sit at log distances $-\ln(1-s)$ and $\ln(1+u)$, not s and u . For the plan's brackets (s and u a fraction of a percent to a few percent) the difference is of the order of s and u themselves, a fraction of a percent of the duration. The daily flat also cuts long trades at 20:00 UTC. So these formulas are used only to explain orders of magnitude; every duration reported in Part II is measured by the engine.

8.2 How long a phase lasts

In the idealised model the number of trades is AB/v (5.3) with $v = l(w+c)$, and each lasts about $m^2(w+c)/l$ hours, so the market time is about $(A/l)(B/l)m^2$ hours, independent of k . For FTMO phase 1 at $m = 0.75$ and $l = \$1,500$: $6.67^2 \times 0.56 \approx 25$ hours of open market. The calendar is set by the rules instead: minimum and profitable days, the concentration policy's three winning days, the daily flat, weekends, reviews and payout dates.

8.3 Value per month: the renewal–reward theorem

The plan runs *slots*: one account position at a firm, refilled with a new evaluation as soon as an attempt ends. A slot completes attempts with values V_i and durations T_i , independent and identically distributed in the model, and

RENEWAL-REWARD THEOREM

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \frac{\sum_{i=1}^n V_i}{\sum_{i=1}^n T_i} = \frac{\mathbb{E}[V]}{\mathbb{E}[T]}, \quad \text{EV per month} = 30.44 \times \frac{\mathbb{E}[V]}{\mathbb{E}[T \text{ in days}]}.$$

This is a *long-run rate*: the average over many attempts, the ratio of expectations (not the expectation of ratios). It is the objective each programme's settings are chosen for.

8.4 How precise a simulated figure is

With n independent attempts the ratio estimate $\hat{r} = \bar{V}/\bar{T}$ has, by the delta method, standard error $\text{sd}(V_i - \hat{r}T_i)/(\sqrt{n}\bar{T})$. Attempts that start at random times on the *same* synthetic path share its history, so they are not fully independent. Version 7's final figures therefore use 16 independent paths per programme (1,500 attempts on each) and treat each path as a cluster:

CLUSTER-ROBUST INTERVAL FOR A RATIO

$$\widehat{\text{Var}}(\hat{r}) = \frac{G}{G-1} \frac{\sum_{g=1}^G (V_g - \hat{r}T_g)^2}{(\sum_g T_g)^2},$$

where V_g, T_g are the totals on path g . With only G clusters the multiplier for a 95% interval is the Student t quantile with $G-1$ degrees of freedom, not 1.96: 2.13 for 16 paths, 3.18 for 4. Every "±" for a programme is the larger of that cluster interval and 1.96 attempt-level standard errors. The checks of Chapter 11 use 24 independent paths per programme for the same reason: with thousands of attempts on one path, the same stretch of price history is traded dozens of times, and an attempt-level interval would be several times too narrow. Portfolio lives each run on their own new path, so they are independent and the ordinary standard error applies. These are Monte Carlo intervals *under the model*: they say how well the model's expectation is estimated, not how much a real year can differ from it, and they carry no allowance for wrong rules, wrong costs or a wrong model.

8.5 A first year is not the long-run rate

A new portfolio pays every fee in its first weeks and receives its first payouts a month or more later; at the end of any finite horizon some accounts are part-way through and hold value not yet paid. So the first year's average cash, the average of later months, and the long-run renewal rate are three different quantities, and nothing requires them to be equal. Version 6 said linearity made its first-year figure and its sum of long-run rates "agree"; that was wrong. Chapter 28 reports them separately: the first-year average from 12-month lives, and the long-run monthly rate and the value of the accounts still open at month 12 from 36-month lives.

8.6 The plan's attempt, timed

Engine, sixteen fresh paths: an attempt lasts $\mathbb{E}[T] = 15.35$ days on average, from the purchase to the failed phase or the closed funded account.

So one slot buys $30.44/15.35 = 1.98$ evaluations a month and pays $1.98 \times \$607.82 = \$1,205$ a month in fees before refunds.

Value of an attempt: $\mathbb{E}[V] = \$1,478$; pass rate 27.7%; cash per funded account \$7,543.

Renewal-reward (8.3): $30.44 \times 1,478/15.35 = \$2,930$ per month, $\pm \$294$ (95%, cluster-robust over 16 paths; attempt-level $\pm \$170$).

Where the time goes (paths 141–144): an attempt that fails in the evaluation lasts 9.2 days on average; one that passes spends 18.1 days in the evaluation and 13.2 days funded, with 0.54 payouts on average; 36.1 trades per attempt.

Optimising the settings

Four numbers define how the plan trades a programme: the risk per trade L , the reward-to-risk k , the stop m and the funded payout target X ; a fifth choice is the market. This chapter explains what each does, how they were searched, and what the search can and cannot claim.

9.1 What each setting does

Setting	Value of an attempt	Time of an attempt	Range searched
Risk L	with the 40% cap on a win, a larger L means a smaller effective reward:risk	market time $\propto 1/L^2$	1.0%, 1.5%, 1.75% of the account (every firm's 2% rule stays out of reach after costs); FTMO at most 1.5%, its own guidance
Reward:risk k	fewer trades, less cost, until the 40% cap binds	little in theory (8.2)	1.5 to 12
Stop m	cost per trade $\rho = \kappa/(m\sigma)$	market time $\propto m^2$	from the leverage floor (Chapter 10) or 0.35, whichever is larger, to 1.25
Payout target X	more funded trades and cost with larger X (7.3)	payout waiting against cycle length	4% to 30% of the account, within each firm's payout rules
Market	cost per unit of movement κ/σ	trading hours	those the firm's leverage and copy rules allow

9.2 The search

- Grid.** For every programme and every market it may trade, every combination of L , m (up to four stops from the leverage floor up), $k \in \{1.5, 2, 3, 4, 6, 8, 12\}$ and five or six payout targets: 10,941 settings, each 2,000 attempts on four paths (101–104): 21.9 million simulated attempts.
- Refine.** For each programme and market, the fourteen best grid settings, plus k half-way to its neighbours around the best and a larger payout target where the best sat on the edge, re-run for 16,000 attempts on four *different* paths (111–114): 401 settings, 6.4 million attempts.
- Choose.** The highest refined value per month with a stop of at least 0.35 hourly moves and a payout target of at most 30% of the account.
- Report.** The chosen setting is run a third time on sixteen fresh paths (121–136), 24,000 attempts in all, with the cluster-robust interval of 8.4. Every figure reported for a programme comes from this run, so none is inflated by having been picked as the best of many noisy estimates. The inflation is visible: the chosen settings average 6% less on the fresh paths than on the paths that chose them. (The grid and the refinement ran before the last two engine corrections, N9 and N10 of Appendix A, which concern payout requests under consistency rules; the fresh-path value of every chosen setting, and every figure after it, comes from the final engine.)

What the search establishes. The best setting found in this grid, for these programmes and these markets, under the model. It is not a proof of a global optimum over every possible rule, product, size or market; Part II lists what was searched for each programme and what was left out.

9.3 What the search found

The policy moves the optimum. Under the 40% cap no win can end a phase, so the version 6 corner (k of 20–30, one trade per phase) is gone. The chosen settings use risk 1.50% (2), 1.75% (22), k from 3 to 10, stops from 0.75 to 1.25 and payout targets from 10% to 30% of the account.

Why the risk goes to its upper limit. With wins capped at 40% of the target, a larger risk mainly makes the account move faster (market time $\propto 1/L^2$, 8.2) at almost the same pass probability, so value per month rises with L ; 1.75% is the plan's ceiling, set by the firms' 2% rules, not by the search, and FTMO is held to its own recommended 1.5% (10.5).

Why the payout target goes to its upper limit. A larger target means fewer payout dates to wait for and, under the 40% cap, larger wins per trade; the cost of more funded trades (7.3) is smaller than the time saved. 30% is the plan's ceiling (one payout of more than 30% of the account invites review).

9.4 Every programme

Programme, market	Chosen $L / k / m / X$	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt	Version 6 (uncapped policy)
Alpha Capital Pro 10%, Nasdaq	1.75% / 6 / 1 / 20%	\$3,199 $\pm$ \$192	28.9%	15.6	\$6,372
Blue Guardian 2-Step, Nasdaq	1.75% / 4 / 1.07 / 15%	\$2,328 $\pm$ \$191	28.9%	15.7	\$2,810
BrightFunded Classic, Nasdaq	1.75% / 6 / 1 / 20%	\$2,766 $\pm$ \$254	29.6%	18.0	\$4,183
FTMO 2-Step, Nasdaq	1.5% / 8 / 0.75 / 20%	\$2,930 $\pm$ \$294	27.7%	15.4	\$5,463
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days), Nasdaq	1.75% / 6 / 1.07 / 30%	\$2,877 $\pm$ \$228	29.6%	23.0	\$4,046
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days), USDJPY	1.75% / 6 / 1.25 / 30%	\$2,277 $\pm$ \$262	27.3%	22.4	\$3,570
FXIFY Classic (80%), Nasdaq	1.5% / 6 / 1 / 30%	\$2,113 $\pm$ \$259	28.9%	22.6	\$3,280
FXIFY Classic (80%), USDJPY	1.75% / 10 / 1.25 / 30%	\$1,621 $\pm$ \$190	27.0%	21.6	\$3,253
Fintokei ProTrader, Nasdaq	1.75% / 10 / 1 / 30%	\$3,209 $\pm$ \$339	30.2%	16.3	\$4,072
FundedNext Stellar, gold	1.75% / 8 / 1.03 / 20%	\$2,761 $\pm$ \$214	30.1%	17.5	\$4,187
FundedNext Stellar, EURUSD	1.75% / 6 / 1 / 20%	\$1,590 $\pm$ \$209	24.0%	16.5	\$3,804
FunderPro Classic, Nasdaq	1.75% / 8 / 1.07 / 20%	\$3,406 $\pm$ \$255	29.4%	16.1	\$7,734
FunderPro Classic, USDJPY	1.75% / 6 / 1.25 / 30%	\$2,467 $\pm$ \$240	27.2%	15.9	–

Programme, market	Chosen L / k / m / X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt	Version 6 (uncapped policy)
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (95%), USDJPY	1.75% / 8 / 1 / 15%	\$2,829 ± \$236	26.3%	22.7	\$4,055
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (80%), USDJPY	1.75% / 8 / 1 / 30%	\$2,399 ± \$188	26.5%	21.1	–
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (95%), EURUSD	1.75% / 7 / 1 / 15%	\$1,703 ± \$207	21.2%	21.1	–
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (80%), EURUSD	1.75% / 4 / 1 / 15%	\$1,380 ± \$180	21.2%	20.8	–
GFT Standard, Nasdaq	1.75% / 3 / 1.07 / 10%	\$2,534 ± \$118	29.1%	20.0	\$3,953
GFT Standard, USDJPY	1.75% / 3 / 1.25 / 15%	\$2,034 ± \$124	27.2%	19.1	–
Hola Prime 2-Step Prime, gold	1.75% / 10 / 1.03 / 20%	\$2,813 ± \$245	29.8%	16.2	\$4,578
Hola Prime 2-Step Prime, EURUSD	1.75% / 7 / 1.25 / 20%	\$1,247 ± \$226	25.4%	17.7	\$3,922
Maven 2-Step, Nasdaq	1.75% / 4 / 1.25 / 10%	\$1,627 ± \$88	27.1%	18.7	\$2,341
The5ers HS Classic, Nasdaq	1.75% / 7 / 1 / 30%	\$3,592 ± \$214	32.4%	16.7	\$4,775
The5ers HS, Nasdaq	1.75% / 6 / 1 / 20%	\$3,290 ± \$279	29.1%	16.0	\$4,482

One 100K account, sixteen fresh paths (121–136), 24,000 attempts each; 95% interval: the larger of the attempt-level and the cluster-robust interval (Student t, 15 degrees of freedom). L: risk per trade; X: payout target, both as a share of the account. Shaded: in the recommended plan. Version 6: its chosen setting's value under version 6's rules and engine (no concentration cap, overnight holding, uncorrected rule inputs); not comparable as a measure of the same thing.

Position size, leverage and margin

10.1 From risk to lots

The stop distance in price points is $m\sigma \times \text{price}$. If one lot gains or loses V dollars per point (the firm's contract specification), then

LOTS FOR A GIVEN RISK

$$\text{lots} = \frac{l}{m\sigma \text{ price } V}, \quad \text{notional} = \frac{l}{m\sigma}.$$

Lots are rounded *down* to the lot step, so the realised risk is never above l . Micro Nasdaq futures trade in whole contracts of \$2 per point: the engine rounds the number of contracts down and never trades fewer than one, and a futures account whose room is below one contract's stop is closed (5.4).

10.2 Leverage and margin, at every entry

A position of notional N needs margin N/λ at leverage $1:\lambda$. The plan keeps margin at most 60% of the *current* balance at every entry (version 6 checked it on the starting balance only):

MARGIN CONDITION AT ENTRY, AND THE SMALLEST STOP AT THE START

$$\frac{l}{m\sigma\lambda} \leq 0.6(S+x) \iff l \leq 0.6\lambda m\sigma(S+x), \quad m_{\min} = \frac{L/S}{0.6\lambda\sigma}.$$

The engine applies the first form to every trade, lowering the risk when the balance has fallen; the search starts its stops at $m_{\min}$. Where a firm's leverage differs between evaluation and funded accounts (GFT: 1:20 then 1:10 on indices), the funded leverage sets $m_{\min}$. FunderPro's funded accounts have a rule of their own: at most 20% of the *starting* balance as margin per asset class. At 1:30 on the Nasdaq and 1.5% risk that needs $m \geq 0.913$; version 6's FunderPro setting ($m = 0.35$) used about 52% and broke it.

Programme	Market	Leverage: evaluation / funded	Risk	$m_{\min}$	Plan's m	Notional per 100K	Funded margin / start balance
Alpha Capital Pro 10%	Nasdaq	1:20 / 1:20	1.75%	0.533	1	\$639,413	32%
Blue Guardian 2-Step	Nasdaq	1:10 / 1:10	1.75%	1.066	1.07	\$597,582	60%
BrightFunded Classic	Nasdaq	1:20 / 1:20	1.75%	0.533	1	\$639,413	32%
FTMO 2-Step	Nasdaq	1:50 / 1:50	1.50%	0.183	0.75	\$730,758	15%
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	Nasdaq	1:10 / 1:10	1.75%	1.066	1.07	\$597,582	60%
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	USDJPY	1:30 / 1:30	1.75%	0.815	1.25	\$1,173,426	39%
FXIFY Classic (80%)	Nasdaq	1:10 / 1:10	1.50%	0.913	1	\$548,068	55%
FXIFY Classic (80%)	USDJPY	1:30 / 1:30	1.75%	0.815	1.25	\$1,173,426	39%
Fintokei ProTrader	Nasdaq	1:50 / 1:50	1.75%	0.213	1	\$639,413	13%
FundedNext Stellar	EURUSD	1:100 / 1:100	1.75%	0.342	1	\$2,052,760	21%
FundedNext Stellar	gold	1:10 / 1:10	1.75%	1.028	1.03	\$598,598	60%
FunderPro Classic	Nasdaq	1:30 / 1:30 (20% cap)	1.75%	1.066	1.07	\$597,582	20%
FunderPro Classic	USDJPY	1:100 / 1:100 (20% cap)	1.75%	0.733	1.25	\$1,173,426	12%
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (80%)	USDJPY	1:100 / 1:100	1.75%	0.244	1	\$1,466,782	15%
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (80%)	EURUSD	1:100 / 1:100	1.75%	0.342	1	\$2,052,760	21%
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (95%)	USDJPY	1:100 / 1:100	1.75%	0.244	1	\$1,466,782	15%
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (95%)	EURUSD	1:100 / 1:100	1.75%	0.342	1	\$2,052,760	21%
GFT Standard	Nasdaq	1:20 / 1:10	1.75%	1.066	1.07	\$597,582	60%
GFT Standard	USDJPY	1:100 / 1:50	1.75%	0.489	1.25	\$1,173,426	23%
Hola Prime 2-Step Prime	gold	1:10 / 1:10	1.75%	1.028	1.03	\$598,598	60%
Hola Prime 2-Step Prime	EURUSD	1:50 / 1:50	1.75%	0.684	1.25	\$1,642,208	33%
Maven 2-Step	Nasdaq	1:20 / 1:20	1.75%	0.533	1.25	\$511,530	26%
The5ers HS	Nasdaq	1:25 / 1:25	1.75%	0.426	1	\$639,413	26%
The5ers HS Classic	Nasdaq	1:25 / 1:25	1.75%	0.426	1	\$639,413	26%

Leverage as published on 4 October 2026 (optimize_v7.LEV). $m_{\min}$: the smallest stop whose margin fits 60% of the starting balance at both leverages (FunderPro funded: 20%). At every entry the engine also requires margin at most 60% of the current balance, lowering the risk if needed.

10.3 Which market each account trades

- **Nasdaq 100** (US100 CFD, or micro Nasdaq futures): every firm that allows the position and the same trades as your own accounts elsewhere.
- **USDJPY**: FundingPips (leverage), and any firm whose Nasdaq stop the leverage pushes too wide, where the search found it better.
- **Markets of their own** for the firms that forbid copying from other firms' accounts or into funded accounts: FundedNext and Hola Prime each trade a market (EURUSD, gold) that no other account trades.

Inside each group every account takes the same direction (Chapter 28), so no two accounts are ever on opposite sides of one market.

10.4 The ten-minute rule

FundingPips groups positions on one market in one direction, including one opened within 10 minutes of closing a losing one, into one "trade idea" limited to 2%. The plan waits at least 10 minutes after any losing trade before the next trade in the same direction, at every firm. In the engine the next entry is always at a later hour's open, which already satisfies this.

10.5 Risk per trade

Version 6 fixed the risk at 1.5% and argued from time alone. Under the 40% cap a larger risk lowers the effective reward:risk of a capped win, so the risk now matters for value too, and it is searched (1.0%, 1.5%, 1.75%). The upper end is 1.75% because Alpha forbids risking or losing 2% or more on a trade, FundingPips closes a trade idea at 2%, Hola Prime and FunderPro cap funded risk at 2%, and Blue Guardian's shield and GFT's Goat Guard act at a 2% open loss: 1.75% plus cost stays below all of them. FTMO publishes a recommendation of 1–1.5% of the initial balance per trade and says larger risk can trigger its risk monitoring; it is not a written rule, but the plan treats it as one and caps FTMO at 1.5%.

Risk per trade	EV per month (95%)	Value of an attempt	Pass rate	Days per attempt
1.00%	\$2,291 ± \$495	\$1,344	27.8%	17.9
1.25%	\$2,610 ± \$848	\$1,367	27.4%	15.9
1.50%	\$2,630 ± \$629	\$1,308	27.1%	15.1
1.75%	\$3,063 ± \$532	\$1,500	28.4%	14.9
2.00%	\$2,880 ± \$607	\$1,396	28.0%	14.8

FTMO 2-Step 100K at the plan's $k = 8$, $m = 0.75$, payout target 20K, paths 141–144, 12,000 attempts per row, same random numbers in every row. 2% is shown for reference only.

Checking the engine against the formulas

The engine and the chain were written separately. The chain leaves out daily limits, minimum and profitable days, the per-day part of the concentration policy, payout dates (it pays only at the payout target, while the plan withdraws whatever profit there is on each payout date), the daily flat and weekend closes; the engine includes them. One effect exists only in the engine and only if positions are held over a weekend: a gap through the floor is absorbed by the firm, a gap through the target is kept. The plan is flat at weekends, so it does not arise; the verification stays flat at weekends too. Agreement where both apply is supporting evidence that each implements its model as described. It is not proof that either is right: two programs can agree because they share a wrong rule input or a wrong assumption. Where they differ, the difference should come from what the chain leaves out, and the third column of 11.2 measures exactly that, by running the engine with those rules switched off.

11.1 Basic checks

Check	Theory	Engine
Win rate of brackets with costs, 1 : 1, 1 : 2, 1 : 3, 1 : 6, stop $m = 1$ (80,000 trades each)	49.4% / 33.1% / 24.9% / 14.2%	49.7% / 33.0% / 24.7% / 14.4%
The same at a tight stop $m = 0.35$	48.4% / 32.6% / 24.6% / 14.2%	48.6% / 32.7% / 24.5% / 14.4%
Average result per trade in units of risk, 1 : 3, $m = 1$ (theory $-\rho$)	-0.0234	-0.0357 $\pm$ 0.0147
Tie test: win rate of cost-free brackets at $m = 0.35$, 12 sub-steps per hour, $k = 1, 3, 6$ (80,000 each)	50.00% / 25.00% / 14.29%	49.85% / 24.85% / 14.18%
The same with 60 sub-steps per hour	50.00% / 25.00% / 14.29%	49.83% / 25.77% / 14.28%
FTMO phase 1, no costs, no daily rules, $k = 3$: pass rate (chain, with the plan's floor rule)	49.73%	49.90% $\pm$ 0.85%
FTMO funded account, no costs, no daily rules: average withdrawn before the split (chain)	\$9,900	\$9,997 $\pm$ \$366
200K account against two 100K accounts, same seeds, 1,500 attempts (FTMO, Fintokei, The5ers, GFT)	exactly 2 $\times$ where every rule scales	FTMO, Fintokei: largest difference \$0.00; The5ers, GFT: not exact
Accounting identity of 5.5, largest gap over every chosen programme's phases and cycles	0	\$0.0000
FTMO with the plan's direction rule against a coin flip	equal	per trade -0.0025 / +0.0020 R (± 0.014)

The tie test. At the tightest stop the plan allows (0.35 hourly moves), win rates differ from $1/(1+k)$ by -0.15 points at 12 sub-steps and -0.17 at 60 ($k = 1$; ± 0.35), -0.15 points at 12 sub-steps and +0.76 at 60 ($k = 3$; ± 0.30), -0.10 points at 12 sub-steps and -0.01 at 60 ($k = 6$; ± 0.24). Because one of these six cells was 2.5 intervals from theory, the test was repeated on six new paths per cell (120,000 brackets each) for $k = 2, 3, 4$: $k = 2$ at 12 sub-steps +0.32 points ($z = +2.3$), $k = 2$ at 60 sub-steps -0.01 points ($z = -0.1$), $k = 3$ at 12 sub-steps +0.29 points ($z = +2.3$), $k = 3$ at 60 sub-steps +0.02 points ($z = +0.2$), $k = 4$ at 12 sub-steps -0.01 points ($z = -0.1$), $k = 4$ at 60 sub-steps +0.15 points ($z = +1.3$). The repeated cell is on theory, and the deviations at 12 sub-steps go both ways and average close to zero. So the remaining tie rule (only inside one five-minute step) does not bias the plan's trades by more than about a quarter of a percentage point of win rate. Real hourly data has no sub-steps; no real-history figure is used in version 7.

The scaling test. FTMO and Fintokei, whose every rule is a share of the account: the largest difference between a 200K attempt and twice the matching 100K attempt is \$0.00 over 3,000 pairs, i.e. the scaling is exact path by path. The5ers is not exact, because its \$150 minimum payout is a flat amount: \$1,981 per 100K at 200K against \$2,009 at 100K. GFT is not exact, because its \$3,000 day cap and \$10,000 payout cap are flat amounts: \$1,512 per 100K at 200K against \$1,802 at 100K.

The direction rule. Per trade (cost-free 1 : 3 brackets on the Nasdaq, 60,000 each), the plan's momentum rule averages -0.0025 ± 0.0141 R and a coin flip $+0.0020 \pm 0.0142$ R: no edge either way. Per month (FTMO, 48,000 attempts each on paths 141–144) the momentum rule gives $\$2,013 \pm \800 and the coin flip $\$2,797 \pm \273 . The momentum rule's interval is three times wider because attempts that overlap on one path take the same direction at the same time, so they are strongly correlated; the two agree within it. The plan uses the momentum rule only so that all of one person's accounts take the same side.

11.2 Every chosen programme: chain against engine

Programme	P: chain	P: engine, chain's rules	P: engine, all rules	Funded cash: chain	engine, chain's rules	engine, all rules
FTMO 2-Step, Nasdaq	0.280	0.279 $\pm$ 0.009	0.277	\$7,216	\$6,970 $\pm$ \$561	\$7,543
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (80%), USDJPY	0.259	0.251 $\pm$ 0.009	0.265	\$8,168	\$8,205 $\pm$ \$1,126	\$8,155
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (80%), EURUSD	0.219	0.218 $\pm$ 0.012	0.212	\$6,890	\$6,656 $\pm$ \$566	\$6,803
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (95%), USDJPY	0.259	0.252 $\pm$ 0.010	0.263	\$9,314	\$9,060 $\pm$ \$575	\$9,918
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (95%), EURUSD	0.219	0.217 $\pm$ 0.012	0.212	\$8,193	\$8,028 $\pm$ \$648	\$7,927
FundedNext Stellar, EURUSD	0.246	0.244 $\pm$ 0.013	0.240	\$6,178	\$6,106 $\pm$ \$508	\$5,869
FundedNext Stellar, gold	0.301	0.311 $\pm$ 0.010	0.301	\$7,046	\$6,486 $\pm$ \$652	\$7,098
The5ers HS, Nasdaq	0.292	0.293 $\pm$ 0.011	0.291	\$7,349	\$7,016 $\pm$ \$646	\$7,453
The5ers HS Classic, Nasdaq	0.325	0.318 $\pm$ 0.009	0.324	\$7,399	\$7,621 $\pm$ \$934	\$7,578
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days), Nasdaq	0.295	0.290 $\pm$ 0.010	0.296	\$8,924	\$8,656 $\pm$ \$976	\$9,209
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days), USDJPY	0.275	0.276 $\pm$ 0.009	0.273	\$8,355	\$8,403 $\pm$ \$1,059	\$8,161
FXIFY Classic (80%), Nasdaq	0.292	0.280 $\pm$ 0.008	0.289	\$7,103	\$6,806 $\pm$ \$809	\$7,326

Programme	P: chain	P: engine, chain's rules	P: engine, all rules	Funded cash: chain	engine, chain's rules	engine, all rules
FXIFY Classic (80%), USDJPY	0.275	0.275 ± 0.012	0.270	\$6,712	\$6,970 ± \$1,071	\$6,313
Fintohei ProTrader, Nasdaq	0.304	0.306 ± 0.010	0.302	\$7,441	\$7,113 ± \$825	\$7,519
Hola Prime 2-Step Prime, gold	0.301	0.301 ± 0.008	0.298	\$6,947	\$6,712 ± \$587	\$7,026
Hola Prime 2-Step Prime, EURUSD	0.267	0.265 ± 0.007	0.254	\$6,423	\$6,084 ± \$910	\$5,219
Alpha Capital Pro 10%, Nasdaq	0.292	0.293 ± 0.011	0.289	\$7,242	\$6,912 ± \$639	\$7,373
GFT Standard, Nasdaq	0.294	0.291 ± 0.012	0.291	\$7,153	\$7,011 ± \$417	\$7,519
GFT Standard, USDJPY	0.275	0.271 ± 0.008	0.272	\$6,491	\$6,437 ± \$249	\$6,626
FunderPro Classic, Nasdaq	0.295	0.289 ± 0.009	0.294	\$7,453	\$7,338 ± \$525	\$7,953
FunderPro Classic, USDJPY	0.275	0.282 ± 0.014	0.272	\$7,048	\$7,151 ± \$836	\$6,713
BrightFunded Classic, Nasdaq	0.292	0.291 ± 0.007	0.296	\$7,242	\$6,945 ± \$731	\$7,432
Blue Guardian 2-Step, Nasdaq	0.294	0.290 ± 0.013	0.289	\$6,164	\$6,034 ± \$356	\$6,177
Maven 2-Step, Nasdaq	0.276	0.274 ± 0.010	0.271	\$5,363	\$5,107 ± \$381	\$5,302

Chain: analytic_v7.py. Engine with the chain's rules: the same engine with the daily loss limit, minimum and profitable days and the daily flat switched off, the concentration caps applied per trade, and payouts only at the payout target; it stays flat at weekends, because a position held through a weekend gaps and a gap is not in the chain. 24 independent two-year paths × 500 attempts, intervals cluster-robust over paths (Student t, 23 degrees of freedom). Engine with all rules: the final run. The middle columns test the implementation; the gap between them and the last columns is what the daily rules do.

Implementation. With the chain's rules, the engine's pass rate is within its 95% interval of the chain's in 22 of 24 programmes and its funded cash in 24 of 24; the largest standardised differences are -1.5 and -0.9 intervals. Remaining differences come from what the engine still does that the chain does not (price gaps, path-dependent filler, the flat close of the last cycle), and they go both ways, so neither is 'the conservative one'.

What the daily rules do. Switching the daily rules back on changes the value of an attempt by −\$289 to +\$330 across programmes. These are the effects the formulas of Part I do not contain; every reported figure comes from the engine with every rule on.

Every programme in the plan

One chapter per firm, for the programme and market the plan uses there: the rules as published; exactly what the engine simulates; the search; the chosen setting and its alternatives on fresh paths; one trade in dollars and points; the evaluation and the funded account from the exact chain; value per attempt and per month; sizes and number of accounts; higher costs; and how the plan meets the rules.

FTMO 2-Step Challenge

Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100); plan setting: risk 1.50%, $k = 8$, $m = 0.75$, payout target 20% of the account; **\$2,930 a month per 100K** ($\pm \$294$); in the plan: $4 \times 100K$, \$11,722 a month.

12.1 The rules

Rule	As published (read 4 October 2026)
Fee	€540 for 100K (\$607.82 at 1.1256), €1,080 for 200K (\$1,215.65); refunded with the first reward
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	10% / 5% of the initial balance
Maximum daily loss	5% of the initial balance, measured from the balance at 00:00 CE(S)T
Maximum loss	10% of the initial balance, static
Minimum trading days	4 per phase (a day with at least one position opened)
Funded split and payouts	80% (90% after scaling); first reward 14 days after the first trade, then every 14 days; no minimum
Consistency rule	none on the 2-Step (the 1-Step has a 50% best-day rule)
Leverage	1:50 on indices (Normal account)
News and weekends	funded Standard account: no new orders 2 minutes around restricted news; no weekend holding
Per person	\$400,000 per trader or strategy across all accounts, evaluations included; the same strategy may run on several accounts within the cap
Prohibited	gambling (no plan, all-in), account rolling, opposite positions across accounts or providers, gap trading (opening within 2 hours of a market close to profit from the gap), latency arbitrage
Risk guidance	FTMO recommends risking 1–1.5% of the initial balance per trade; larger risk can trigger risk monitoring (a recommendation, not a written rule)

12.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	\$607.82
Phase 1	target \$10,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$5,000; at least 4 trading days; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$4,000)
Phase 2	target \$5,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$5,000; at least 4 trading days; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$2,000)
Funded account	maximum loss \$10,000, static; daily loss \$5,000; split 80%; \$607.82 of the fee returned with payout number 1; first payout 14 days after funding, then every 14 days; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the payout target
Trading hours	no entry from 19:00 UTC, flat at 20:00 UTC every day; flat at weekends
Margin	leverage 1:50 (evaluation), 1:50 (funded); margin at most 60% of the current balance at entry

12.3 The search

Searched: 504 grid settings (Nasdaq; 2,000 attempts each) and 31 refined settings (16,000 attempts each, paths 111–114). The eight best refined settings on Nasdaq:

	Risk	k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
	1.75%	7	0.75	30%	\$3,165 $\pm$ \$1,441	28.1%	14.5
	1.75%	4	1	30%	\$3,113 $\pm$ \$531	29.4%	15.9
	1.75%	4	1	20%	\$3,080 $\pm$ \$619	29.6%	16.2
	1.75%	10	0.75	30%	\$3,032 $\pm$ \$797	27.9%	14.5
	1.75%	8	0.75	30%	\$3,017 $\pm$ \$979	28.3%	14.6
	1.75%	8	0.75	20%	\$3,014 $\pm$ \$1,129	28.2%	14.9
	1.75%	6	0.75	20%	\$2,996 $\pm$ \$863	28.2%	15.0
	1.75%	6	1	20%	\$2,979 $\pm$ \$1,007	29.3%	16.1

Refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below. Many settings sit within each other's intervals: the ranking near the top is not reliable, the region is.

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
1.5	1.54	1.73	1.90	1.54	1.49	1.39
2	1.76	2.20	2.04	1.93	2.07	2.34

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
3	1.78	2.14	2.32	2.53	2.15	2.13
4	1.91	1.95	2.17	2.50	2.75	2.20
6	2.04	2.51	2.56	2.60	2.66	2.51
8	2.01	2.66	2.47	2.71	2.79	2.88
12	1.87	2.41	2.42	2.68	2.67	2.72

Grid value per month (\$ thousands; 2,000 attempts each on paths 101–104, so $\pm \$0.6$ – $1.2K$) at risk \$1,500 and stop $m = 0.75$, by k (rows) and payout target X (columns). Darker is more. The chosen setting is in the table above it, re-measured on fresh paths.

12.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	Risk / k / m / X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an attempt
Plan	1.5% / 8 / 0.75 / 20%	\$2,930 $\pm$ \$294	27.7%	\$7,543	15.4	+\$1,478

One 100K account; each row's own chosen setting on sixteen fresh paths (121–136), 24,000 attempts, cluster-robust 95% interval. Version 6 reported \$5,463 a month for this programme under its rules and engine.

12.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1,500$; stop $s = m\sigma = 0.75 \times 0.2737\% = 0.2053\%$ of the price; at 31,070.00 that is **63.8 points**.
Notional $N = l/s = \$730,758$; **\$23.52 per point**; lots = this divided by the contract's dollars per point per lot, rounded down.
Cost $c = \kappa N = \$46.77$, $\rho = c/l = 3.12\%$; the risk is sized so that $l(1 + \rho)$ fits the room (5.4).
First trade of phase 1: $w = \min(kl, A_1, \text{caps}) = \$4,000$; take-profit 172.1 points away; $p = l/(l + w + c) = 0.2704$.
Mean $-c$; variance $l(w + c) = 6,070,153$; duration about 1.52 h of open market (losers 1.20 h, winners 2.4 h), cut at 20:00 UTC.
A full funded win \$8,000: take-profit 342 points away, $p = 0.1571$.
Margin at the funded leverage 1:50: $\$14,615 = 14.6\%$ of the starting balance (limit 60%); smallest stop $m_{\min} = 0.183$.

12.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$10,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_1 = 0.4585$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 16.80$, $K = \$774$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$9,896$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.4613$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.5000$.
Rules in play: every win at most \$4,000; 4 trading days (filler trades in the engine).

Daily loss limit \$5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 3 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Phase 2: $A = \$5,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_2 = 0.6111$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 17.16$, $K = \$793$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$9,895$; identity gap -0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.6138$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.6667$.
Rules in play: every win at most \$2,000; 4 trading days (filler trades in the engine).

Daily loss limit \$5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 3 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Both phases: $P = 0.4585 \times 0.6111 = 0.2802$ (chain). Engine with every rule, fresh paths: **0.2765 ± 0.0057** .

12.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$10,000$; payout targets $X_1 = \$20,000$; split 80%; per-trade cap \$8,000.
Cycle success chances: $q_1 = 0.3053$; expected paid cycles 0.4394; expected withdrawn before the split \$8,788.
Identity (7.1): $-\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}] = 9,894 - 1,106 = \$8,788$ (gap +0.00).
Cash (chain): \$7,216 per funded account, of which the refund term \$186.
Engine, fresh paths: **\$7,543** per funded account; 9.9% of attempts reach a payout; median 31 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
0	0.6947	\$0
1	0.2121	\$16,608

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
2	0.0647	\$32,608
3	0.0198	\$48,608
4	0.0060	\$64,608

Chain values.

12.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt: chain $\mathbb{E}[V] = 0.2802 \times 7,216 - 607.82 = \$1,414$; engine \$1,478.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 15.35$ days per attempt, so 1.98 attempts a month per slot and \$1,205 of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (paths 141–144): a failed evaluation lasts 9.2 days on average; a passed one 18.1 days, then 13.2 days funded with 0.54 payouts; 36.1 trades per attempt.

Value per month (8.3): $30.44 \times 1,478 / 15.35 = \$2,930 \pm \$294$ (95%, cluster-robust) per account on sixteen fresh paths.

12.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Fee	Fee per \$100K	EV/month (95%)	EV/month per \$100K
100K	\$607.82	\$608	\$2,930 $\pm$ \$294	\$2,930
200K	\$1,215.65	\$608	\$5,861 $\pm$ \$587	\$2,930

The plan's setting scaled to each size (risk, targets and payout target in proportion; safety margins too), on the same sixteen fresh paths.

Per person: \$400,000 per trader across all accounts, evaluations included. **Copying:** your own accounts, within the cap. **The plan:** $4 \times 100K$, worth \$11,722 a month (4 accounts); at the firm's full allowance: $4 \times 100K$, worth \$11,722 a month (4 accounts).

12.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Value of an attempt	Days per attempt	Pass rate
$\times 1$	\$2,630 $\pm$ \$629	+\$1,308	15.1	27.1%
$\times 1.5$	\$2,410 $\pm$ \$830	+\$1,163	14.7	26.1%
$\times 2$	\$2,075 $\pm$ \$228	+\$965	14.2	23.8%

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost multiplied (spread, commission, slippage), 12,000 attempts on paths 141–144 with the same random numbers in every row. Higher cost lowers the value of an attempt and can also shorten it (more attempts fail sooner), so the value per month need not fall in proportion.

12.11 How the plan meets the rules

- Nasdaq 100 CFD, one position per account, shared direction with every other Nasdaq account
- 1.5% risk (inside FTMO's stated 1–1.5% guidance) with the stop attached at entry
- minimum days filled with one minimal trade per day after the target, where needed
- every account traded the same way; none abandoned or sacrificed (no account rolling)
- flat every day by 20:00 UTC (no entry from 19:00 UTC), so the account is flat through every daily reset and pays no overnight financing; flat at weekends
- concentration policy: no trade and no day makes more than 40% of the current phase or payout target, so every phase and every payout takes at least three winning days
- risk per trade sized so that the stop loss plus the round-trip cost fits the room under the floor and under the day's limit; when that room is below a tenth of the normal risk the account is closed (stopped and replaced), never traded in micro size
- minimum and qualifying days completed with trades held at least 2 minutes

Sources: ftmo.com (trading objectives; FAQ on accounts and the \$400,000 cap; forbidden practices); <https://ftmo.com/en/blog/how-much-should-you-risk-on-one-trade/>; FTMO leverage 1:50 on indices.

FundingPips 2-Step Flex

USDJPY; plan setting: risk 1.75%, $k = 8$, $m = 1$, payout target 15% of the account; **\$2,829 a month per 100K** ($\pm$ \$236); in the plan: $4 \times 100K$, \$11,315 a month.

13.1 The rules

Rule	As published (read 4 October 2026)
Fee	\$499 for 100K (largest size); no registration-fee refund on Flex
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	10% / 8%
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	4% (of the higher of the opening balance and equity) / 12% static
Minimum days	80% option: 1 trading day per phase (accounts from 26 August 2026); 95% option: 3 profitable days (at least +0.5%) per phase
Funded split and payouts	chosen at purchase and locked: 80% with 1 minimum trading day, or 95% with 3 profitable days in every reward cycle; bi-weekly
Risk per trade idea	at most 2% above \$25K; a trade idea is all positions on one market in one direction, including one opened within 10 minutes of closing a loss; a breach closes the account
Profit Concentration Policy	evaluations from 27 June 2026, \$25K and up: if one trade idea makes more than 60% of a phase target, the funded account needs 4 profitable days (+0.5%) before every reward request, permanently
Leverage	1:100 on forex; indices and metals on dynamic leverage falling to 1:5 above 0.5 lots
Weekends and news	overnight and weekend holding allowed on evaluations; on Master accounts only with the Swing add-on; profits from 5 minutes before to 5 minutes after restricted news may be deducted
Per person	\$400,000 across evaluation, funded and Prime accounts
Copying	only between your own FundingPips accounts; no copier services

13.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	\$499
Phase 1	target \$10,000; maximum loss \$12,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$4,000; 3 profitable days of at least \$500; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$4,000)
Phase 2	target \$8,000; maximum loss \$12,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$4,000; 3 profitable days of at least \$500; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$3,200)
Funded account	maximum loss \$12,000, static; daily loss \$4,000; split 95%; no fee refund; first payout 14 days after funding, then every 14 days; 3 profitable days of \$500+ per cycle; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the payout target
Trading hours	no entry from 19:00 UTC, flat at 20:00 UTC every day; flat at weekends
Margin	leverage 1:100 (evaluation), 1:100 (funded); margin at most 60% of the current balance at entry

13.3 The search

Searched: 1008 grid settings (EURUSD, USDJPY; 2,000 attempts each) and 32 refined settings (16,000 attempts each, paths 111–114). The eight best refined settings on USDJPY:

Risk	k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
1.75%	8	1	15%	\$2,980 $\pm$ \$399	26.1%	22.8
1.75%	7	0.75	30%	\$2,977 $\pm$ \$1,110	23.5%	20.1
1.75%	12	1	15%	\$2,895 $\pm$ \$425	25.9%	22.7
1.75%	10	0.75	30%	\$2,891 $\pm$ \$873	24.0%	20.1
1.75%	12	0.75	30%	\$2,826 $\pm$ \$1,183	24.0%	20.0
1.75%	8	0.75	30%	\$2,805 $\pm$ \$975	24.0%	19.9
1.75%	12	1	20%	\$2,803 $\pm$ \$763	26.0%	22.1
1.75%	8	0.75	20%	\$2,770 $\pm$ \$766	24.1%	20.5

Refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below. Many settings sit within each other's intervals: the ranking near the top is not reliable, the region is.

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
1.5	1.55	1.62	1.82	1.48	1.72	1.24
2	1.81	2.13	2.04	1.82	2.16	2.24
3	1.91	2.21	2.49	2.87	2.74	2.62

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
4	1.95	2.19	2.45	2.34	2.65	2.13
6	2.01	1.90	2.18	2.71	3.20	2.92
8	1.83	1.80	2.57	3.05	2.81	2.76
12	1.78	1.82	2.39	3.14	3.05	2.84

Grid value per month (\$ thousands; 2,000 attempts each on paths 101–104, so $\pm \$0.6$ – $1.2K$) at risk \$1,750 and stop $m = 1$, by k (rows) and payout target X (columns). Darker is more. The chosen setting is in the table above it, re-measured on fresh paths.

13.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	Risk / $k / m / X$	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an attempt
Plan	1.75% / 8 / 1 / 15%	\$2,829 $\pm$ \$236	26.3%	\$9,918	22.7	+\$2,113
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (80%), USDJPY	1.75% / 8 / 1 / 30%	\$2,399 $\pm$ \$188	26.5%	\$8,155	21.1	+\$1,661
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (80%), EURUSD	1.75% / 4 / 1 / 15%	\$1,380 $\pm$ \$180	21.2%	\$6,803	20.8	+\$944
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (95%), EURUSD	1.75% / 7 / 1 / 15%	\$1,703 $\pm$ \$207	21.2%	\$7,927	21.1	+\$1,179

One 100K account; each row's own chosen setting on sixteen fresh paths (121–136), 24,000 attempts, cluster-robust 95% interval. Version 6 reported \$4,055 a month for this programme under its rules and engine.

13.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1,750$; stop $s = m\sigma = 1 \times 0.1193\% = 0.1193\%$ of the price; at 157.83 that is **18.8 pips**.
Notional $N = l/s = \$1,466,782$; **\$92.93 per pip**; at \$6.34 per pip per standard lot, **14.67 lots** (round down).
Cost $c = \kappa N = \$74.81$, $\rho = c/l = 4.27\%$; the risk is sized so that $l(1 + \rho)$ fits the room (5.4).
First trade of phase 1: $w = \min(kl, A_1, \text{caps}) = \$3,333$; take-profit 36.7 pips away; $p = l/(l + w + c) = 0.3393$.
Mean $-c$; variance $l(w + c) = 5,964,244$; duration about 1.95 h of open market (losers 1.63 h, winners 2.6 h), cut at 20:00 UTC.
A full funded win \$6,000: take-profit 65 pips away, $p = 0.2236$.
Margin at the funded leverage 1:100: \$14,668 = 14.7% of the starting balance (limit 60%); smallest stop $m_{\min} = 0.244$.

13.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$10,000$, $B = \$12,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_1 = 0.4851$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 17.12$, $K = \$1,265$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$11,880$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.4880$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.5455$.
Rules in play: every win at most \$4,000; 3 profitable days needed: the engine aims at a daily target (6.4), which the chain leaves out.

Daily loss limit \$4,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Phase 2: $A = \$8,000$, $B = \$12,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_2 = 0.5332$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 17.35$, $K = \$1,282$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$11,883$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.5359$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.6000$.
Rules in play: every win at most \$3,200; 3 profitable days needed: the engine aims at a daily target (6.4), which the chain leaves out.

Daily loss limit \$4,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Both phases: $P = 0.4851 \times 0.5332 = 0.2587$ (chain). Engine with every rule, fresh paths: **0.2634 $\pm$ 0.0056**.

13.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$12,000$; payout targets $X_1 = \$15,000$; split 95%; per-trade cap \$6,000.
Cycle success chances: $q_1 = 0.3953$; expected paid cycles 0.6536; expected withdrawn before the split \$9,804.
Identity (7.1): $-\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}] = 11,879 - 2,075 = \$9,804$ (gap +0.00).
Cash (chain): \$9,314 per funded account.
Engine, fresh paths: **\$9,918** per funded account; 12.7% of attempts reach a payout; median 36 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
0	0.6047	\$0
1	0.2390	\$14,250
2	0.0945	\$28,500
3	0.0373	\$42,750
4	0.0148	\$57,000

Chain values.

13.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt: chain $\mathbb{E}[V] = 0.2587 \times 9,314 - 499.00 = \$1,910$; engine \$2,113.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 22.74$ days per attempt, so 1.34 attempts a month per slot and \$668 of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (paths 141–144): a failed evaluation lasts 14.8 days on average; a passed one 23.7 days, then 21.6 days funded with 0.92 payouts; 35.0 trades per attempt.

Value per month (8.3): $30.44 \times 2,113 / 22.74 = \$2,829 \pm \$236$ (95%, cluster-robust) per account on sixteen fresh paths.

13.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Fee	Fee per \$100K	EV/month (95%)	EV/month per \$100K
100K	\$499	\$499	\$2,829 $\pm$ \$236	\$2,829

The plan's setting scaled to each size (risk, targets and payout target in proportion; safety margins too), on the same sixteen fresh paths.

Per person: \$400,000 across evaluation, funded and Prime accounts. **Copying:** your own FundingPips accounts; no copier services. **The plan:** 4 $\times$ 100K, worth \$11,315 a month (4 accounts); at the firm's full allowance: 4 $\times$ 100K, worth \$11,315 a month (4 accounts).

13.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Value of an attempt	Days per attempt	Pass rate
$\times 1$	\$2,671 $\pm$ \$588	+\$1,966	22.4	25.0%
$\times 1.5$	\$2,108 $\pm$ \$630	+\$1,435	20.7	22.2%
$\times 2$	\$1,605 $\pm$ \$503	+\$1,015	19.2	19.3%

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost multiplied (spread, commission, slippage), 12,000 attempts on paths 141–144 with the same random numbers in every row. Higher cost lowers the value of an attempt and can also shorten it (more attempts fail sooner), so the value per month need not fall in proportion.

13.11 How the plan meets the rules

- USDJPY or EURUSD at 1:100 (the Nasdaq would need 1:7 and FundingPips gives 1:5 at that size)
- risk at most 1.75%, below the 2% trade-idea limit; at least 10 minutes after any loss before the next trade in the same direction
- the 40% concentration policy keeps every trade idea under the Profit Concentration Policy's 60%
- 4 $\times$ 100K Flex (the largest Flex size) fills the \$400,000 cap
- own entry on each account; no copier service
- flat every day by 20:00 UTC (no entry from 19:00 UTC), so the account is flat through every daily reset and pays no overnight financing; flat at weekends
- concentration policy: no trade and no day makes more than 40% of the current phase or payout target, so every phase and every payout takes at least three winning days
- risk per trade sized so that the stop loss plus the round-trip cost fits the room under the floor and under the day's limit; when that room is below a tenth of the normal risk the account is closed (stopped and replaced), never traded in micro size
- minimum and qualifying days completed with trades held at least 2 minutes

Sources: <https://help.fundingpips.com/hc/en-us/articles/47835196271249-2-Step-Flex> (2 Step Flex, read 4 Oct 2026); <https://help.fundingpips.com/hc/en-us/articles/48174287980177-Risk-Per-Trade-Idea> (Risk Per Trade Idea; Profit Concentration Policy).

The5ers High Stakes

Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100); plan setting: risk 1.75%, $k = 7$, $m = 1$, payout target 30% of the account; **\$3,592 a month per 100K** ($\pm$ \$214); in the plan: 1 $\times$ 100K, \$3,592 a month.

14.1 The rules

Rule	As published (read 4 October 2026)
Fee	New (10% / 5%): \$491 for 100K; Classic (8% / 5%): \$545; smaller sizes \$19–\$278
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	New 10% / 5%; Classic 8% / 5%
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	5% / 10% static
Profitable days	3 per phase (at least +0.5%); may not be manufactured
Funded split and payouts	80% rising with scaling; first payout 14 days after funding, then every 14 days; \$150 minimum
Fee return	10% of the fee as hub credit (not cash) after phase 1, 20% after phase 2, 70% added to the funded account and paid with the first payout (at least \$150, 14 days after funding); the model keeps the credit apart from cash and spends it on the next The5ers evaluation
Consistency rule	none
Leverage	1:100 forex; 1:25 metals and indices
News	no new orders from 2 minutes before to 2 minutes after high-impact news
Per person	one 50K or 100K High Stakes account, plus up to 1 $\times$ 25K, 3 $\times$ 10K, 3 $\times$ 5K, 3 $\times$ 2.5K
Copying	allowed across your own accounts
Prohibited	one-trade target attainment (permanent ban)

14.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	\$545
Fee credit	non-cash credit of \$54.50 and \$109.00 on passing phase 1 and phase 2, spent on the next evaluation
Phase 1	target \$8,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$5,000; 3 profitable days of at least \$500; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$3,200)
Phase 2	target \$5,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$5,000; 3 profitable days of at least \$500; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$2,000)
Funded account	maximum loss \$10,000, static; daily loss \$5,000; split 80%; \$381.50 of the fee returned with payout number 1; first payout 14 days after funding, then every 14 days; minimum payout \$150; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the payout target
Trading hours	no entry from 19:00 UTC, flat at 20:00 UTC every day; flat at weekends
Margin	leverage 1:25 (evaluation), 1:25 (funded); margin at most 60% of the current balance at entry

14.3 The search

Searched: 504 grid settings (Nasdaq; 2,000 attempts each) and 16 refined settings (16,000 attempts each, paths 111–114). The eight best refined settings on Nasdaq:

Risk	k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
1.75%	7	1	30%	\$3,652 $\pm$ \$1,424	32.6%	16.9
1.75%	6	1	30%	\$3,500 $\pm$ \$1,010	32.1%	16.8
1.75%	12	1	15%	\$3,415 $\pm$ \$641	32.7%	17.9
1.75%	5	1	30%	\$3,415 $\pm$ \$1,074	32.0%	16.7
1.50%	8	1	15%	\$3,406 $\pm$ \$820	32.4%	18.6
1.75%	8	0.75	30%	\$3,388 $\pm$ \$1,360	30.2%	15.4
1.75%	8	0.75	20%	\$3,387 $\pm$ \$1,198	30.5%	15.9
1.75%	12	0.75	20%	\$3,371 $\pm$ \$959	30.6%	16.0

Refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below. Many settings sit within each other's intervals: the ranking near the top is not reliable, the region is.

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
1.5	2.23	2.52	3.01	2.32	2.44	2.65
2	2.43	2.70	2.79	2.74	2.93	3.26

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
3	2.41	2.62	3.12	3.19	3.45	2.84
4	2.44	2.80	2.85	3.03	3.27	2.99
6	2.17	3.03	3.48	3.31	2.96	3.87
8	2.32	3.20	2.95	3.13	3.04	2.78
12	2.32	3.12	2.89	3.34	2.95	2.71

Grid value per month (\$ thousands; 2,000 attempts each on paths 101–104, so $\pm \$0.6$ – $1.2K$) at risk \$1,750 and stop $m = 1$, by k (rows) and payout target X (columns). Darker is more. The chosen setting is in the table above it, re-measured on fresh paths.

14.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	Risk / k / m / X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an attempt
Plan	1.75% / 7 / 1 / 30%	\$3,592 $\pm$ \$214	32.4%	\$7,578	16.7	+\$1,975
The5ers HS, Nasdaq	1.75% / 6 / 1 / 20%	\$3,290 $\pm$ \$279	29.1%	\$7,453	16.0	+\$1,730

One 100K account; each row's own chosen setting on sixteen fresh paths (121–136), 24,000 attempts, cluster-robust 95% interval. Version 6 reported \$4,775 a month for this programme under its rules and engine.

14.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1,750$; stop $s = m\sigma = 1 \times 0.2737\% = 0.2737\%$ of the price; at 31,070.00 that is **85.0 points**.
Notional $N = l/s = \$639,413$; **\$20.58 per point**; lots = this divided by the contract's dollars per point per lot, rounded down.
Cost $c = \kappa N = \$40.92$, $\rho = c/l = 2.34\%$; the risk is sized so that $l(1 + \rho)$ fits the room (5.4).
First trade of phase 1: $w = \min(kl, A_1, \text{caps}) = \$2,667$; take-profit 131.6 points away; $p = l/(l + w + c) = 0.3926$.
Mean $-c$; variance $l(w + c) = 4,738,281$; duration about 1.55 h of open market (losers 1.36 h, winners 1.8 h), cut at 20:00 UTC.
A full funded win \$12,000: take-profit 585 points away, $p = 0.1269$.
Margin at the funded leverage 1:25: **\$25,577** = 25.6% of the starting balance (limit 60%); smallest stop $m_{\min} = 0.426$.

14.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$8,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_1 = 0.5199$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 14.66$, $K = \$589$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$9,889$; identity gap -0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.5228$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.5556$.
Rules in play: every win at most \$3,200; 3 profitable days needed: the engine aims at a daily target (6.4), which the chain leaves out.

Daily loss limit \$5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Phase 2: $A = \$5,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_2 = 0.6242$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 14.81$, $K = \$598$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$9,897$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.6268$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.6667$.
Rules in play: every win at most \$2,000; 3 profitable days needed: the engine aims at a daily target (6.4), which the chain leaves out.

Daily loss limit \$5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Both phases: $P = 0.5199 \times 0.6242 = 0.3245$ (chain). Engine with every rule, fresh paths: **0.3242 $\pm$ 0.0059**.

14.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$10,000$; payout targets $X_1 = \$30,000$; split 80%; per-trade cap \$12,000.
Cycle success chances: $q_1 = 0.2335$; expected paid cycles 0.3046; expected withdrawn before the split \$9,137.
Identity (7.1): $-\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}] = 9,899 - 762 = \$9,137$ (gap +0.00).
Cash (chain): \$7,399 per funded account, of which the refund term \$89.
Engine, fresh paths: **\$7,578** per funded account; 11.0% of attempts reach a payout; median 31 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
0	0.7665	\$0

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
1	0.1790	\$24,382
2	0.0418	\$48,382
3	0.0098	\$72,382
4	0.0023	\$96,382

Chain values.

14.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt: chain $\mathbb{E}[V] = 0.3245 \times 7,399 + 64 - 545.00 = \$1,920$; engine \$1,975.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 16.74$ days per attempt, so 1.82 attempts a month per slot and \$991 of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (paths 141–144): a failed evaluation lasts 9.8 days on average; a passed one 17.5 days, then 13.1 days funded with 0.49 payouts; 33.0 trades per attempt.

Value per month (8.3): $30.44 \times 1,975 / 16.74 = \$3,592 \pm \$214$ (95%, cluster-robust) per account on sixteen fresh paths.

14.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Fee	Fee per \$100K	EV/month (95%)	EV/month per \$100K
100K	\$545	\$545	\$3,592 $\pm$ \$214	\$3,592
25K	\$176	\$704	\$734 $\pm$ \$72	\$2,936
10K	\$69	\$690	\$296 $\pm$ \$27	\$2,955
5K	\$35	\$700	\$147 $\pm$ \$12	\$2,935
2.5K	\$19	\$760	\$72 $\pm$ \$7	\$2,875

The plan's setting scaled to each size (risk, targets and payout target in proportion; safety margins too), on the same sixteen fresh paths.

Per person: one 100K (or 50K) High Stakes account, plus $1 \times 25K$, $3 \times 10K$, $3 \times 5K$, $3 \times 2.5K$. **Copying:** your own accounts. **The plan:** $1 \times 100K$, worth \$3,592 a month (1 account); at the firm's full allowance: $1 \times 100K$; $1 \times 25K$; $3 \times 10K$; $3 \times 5K$; $3 \times 2.5K$, worth \$5,869 a month (11 accounts).

14.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Value of an attempt	Days per attempt	Pass rate
$\times 1$	\$3,360 $\pm$ \$470	+\$1,796	16.3	31.2%
$\times 1.5$	\$3,122 $\pm$ \$387	+\$1,652	16.1	30.0%
$\times 2$	\$2,662 $\pm$ \$551	+\$1,367	15.6	28.7%

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost multiplied (spread, commission, slippage), 12,000 attempts on paths 141–144 with the same random numbers in every row. Higher cost lowers the value of an attempt and can also shorten it (more attempts fail sooner), so the value per month need not fall in proportion.

14.11 How the plan meets the rules

- Nasdaq, shared direction
- daily profit target while profitable days are missing; never tiny trades
- one 100K account; the small accounts are optional
- flat every day by 20:00 UTC (no entry from 19:00 UTC), so the account is flat through every daily reset and pays no overnight financing; flat at weekends
- concentration policy: no trade and no day makes more than 40% of the current phase or payout target, so every phase and every payout takes at least three winning days
- risk per trade sized so that the stop loss plus the round-trip cost fits the room under the floor and under the day's limit; when that room is below a tenth of the normal risk the account is closed (stopped and replaced), never traded in micro size
- minimum and qualifying days completed with trades held at least 2 minutes

Sources: the5ers.com (High Stakes page; payout policy and hub credit FAQ); propfirmbridge.com (High Stakes review, 15 Sep 2026).

FXIFY Two Phase Classic

Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100); plan setting; risk 1.75%, $k = 6$, $m = 1.07$, payout target 30% of the account; **\$2,877 a month per 100K** ($\pm$ \$228); in the plan: $1 \times 100K$; $1 \times 50K$; $1 \times 25K$; $1 \times 10K$; $1 \times 5K$, \$5,181 a month.

15.1 The rules

Rule	As published (read 4 October 2026)
Fee	\$549 for 100K (largest Classic size); refunded with the first payout
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	5% / 10%
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	4% / 10% static
Minimum trading days	4 per phase
Funded split and payouts	80% every 14 days, or 100% every 30 days (chosen at purchase)
Consistency rule (funded)	no day may exceed 25% of the profit of a payout; the benchmark is the account's best day ever and does not reset
Leverage	1:10 on indices; 1:30 forex and metals (1:50 with an add-on)
Per person	one active account of each size, challenge and funded alike (5K, 10K, 15K, 25K, 50K, 100K, 200K, 400K; \$805,000 in all, rule of 25 November 2024); Classic goes up to 100K; Classic prices 5K \$59, 10K \$89, 25K \$199, 50K \$379, 100K \$549
Copying	between your own FXIFY accounts allowed; into FXIFY from external accounts only with approval (30-day statement); third-party copying prohibited
Prohibited	gambling and all-or-nothing ('YOLO') trading

15.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	\$549
Phase 1	target \$5,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$4,000; at least 4 trading days; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$2,000)
Phase 2	target \$10,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$4,000; at least 4 trading days; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$4,000)
Funded account	maximum loss \$10,000, static; daily loss \$4,000; split 100%; \$549.00 of the fee returned with payout number 1; first payout 30 days after funding, then every 30 days; best day at most 25% of a payout's profit; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the payout target
Trading hours	no entry from 19:00 UTC, flat at 20:00 UTC every day; flat at weekends
Margin	leverage 1:10 (evaluation), 1:10 (funded); margin at most 60% of the current balance at entry

15.3 The search

Searched: 840 grid settings (Nasdaq, USDJPY; 2,000 attempts each) and 32 refined settings (16,000 attempts each, paths 111–114). The eight best refined settings on Nasdaq:

Risk	k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
1.75%	6	1.07	30%	\$3,066 $\pm$ \$1,264	29.0%	22.8
1.50%	12	1	30%	\$2,947 $\pm$ \$1,447	29.6%	22.9
1.75%	12	1.25	30%	\$2,915 $\pm$ \$978	30.7%	24.2
1.50%	8	1	30%	\$2,887 $\pm$ \$1,263	29.6%	23.2
1.50%	8	0.92	30%	\$2,773 $\pm$ \$899	28.6%	22.3
1.50%	7	0.92	30%	\$2,746 $\pm$ \$1,224	28.2%	22.0
1.75%	6	1.25	30%	\$2,728 $\pm$ \$959	29.6%	23.8
1.75%	3	1.07	20%	\$2,710 $\pm$ \$395	29.3%	23.6

Refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below. Many settings sit within each other's intervals: the ranking near the top is not reliable, the region is.

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
1, 5	1.79	2.08	1.93	2.12	2.05	2.09
2	1.65	2.08	2.27	2.10	2.30	2.74
3	1.80	2.13	2.31	2.33	2.91	2.64
4	1.74	2.12	2.42	2.47	2.50	2.62
6	1.71	1.78	2.40	2.25	2.33	3.13

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
8	1.62	2.06	2.12	2.70	2.35	2.38
12	1.70	2.00	2.26	2.45	2.40	2.36

Grid value per month (\$ thousands; 2,000 attempts each on paths 101–104, so $\pm \$0.6$ – $1.2K$) at risk \$1,750 and stop $m = 1.07$, by k (rows) and payout target X (columns). Darker is more. The chosen setting is in the table above it, re-measured on fresh paths.

15.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	Risk / k / m / X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an attempt
Plan	1.75% / 6 / 1.07 / 30%	\$2,877 $\pm$ \$228	29.6%	\$9,209	23.0	+\$2,175
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days), USDJPY	1.75% / 6 / 1.25 / 30%	\$2,277 $\pm$ \$262	27.3%	\$8,161	22.4	+\$1,679
FXIFY Classic (80%), Nasdaq	1.5% / 6 / 1 / 30%	\$2,113 $\pm$ \$259	28.9%	\$7,326	22.6	+\$1,570
FXIFY Classic (80%), USDJPY	1.75% / 10 / 1.25 / 30%	\$1,621 $\pm$ \$190	27.0%	\$6,313	21.6	+\$1,152

One 100K account; each row's own chosen setting on sixteen fresh paths (121–136), 24,000 attempts, cluster-robust 95% interval. Version 6 reported \$4,046 a month for this programme under its rules and engine.

15.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1,750$; stop $s = m\sigma = 1.07 \times 0.2737\% = 0.2928\%$ of the price; at 31,070.00 that is **91.0 points**.
Notional $N = l/s = \$597,582$; **\$19.23 per point**; lots = this divided by the contract's dollars per point per lot, rounded down.
Cost $c = \kappa N = \$38.25$, $\rho = c/l = 2.19\%$; the risk is sized so that $l(1 + \rho)$ fits the room (5.4).
First trade of phase 1: $w = \min(kl, A_1, \text{caps}) = \$2,000$; take-profit 106.0 points away; $p = l/(l + w + c) = 0.4620$.
Mean $-c$; variance $l(w + c) = 3,566,929$; duration about 1.33 h of open market (losers 1.27 h, winners 1.4 h), cut at 20:00 UTC.
A full funded win \$10,500: take-profit 548 points away, $p = 0.1424$.
Margin at the funded leverage 1:10: \$59,758 = 59.8% of the starting balance (limit 60%); smallest stop $m_{\min} = 1.066$.

15.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$5,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_1 = 0.6268$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 14.81$, $K = \$559$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$9,895$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.6294$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.6667$.
Rules in play: every win at most \$2,000; 4 trading days (filler trades in the engine).

Daily loss limit \$4,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Phase 2: $A = \$10,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_2 = 0.4699$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 14.53$, $K = \$547$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$9,897$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.4727$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.5000$.
Rules in play: every win at most \$4,000; 4 trading days (filler trades in the engine).

Daily loss limit \$4,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Both phases: $P = 0.6268 \times 0.4699 = 0.2945$ (chain). Engine with every rule, fresh paths: **0.2958 $\pm$ 0.0058**.

15.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$10,000$; payout targets $X_1 = \$30,000$; split 100%; per-trade cap \$7,500.
Cycle success chances: $q_1 = 0.2268$; expected paid cycles 0.2933; expected withdrawn before the split \$8,799.
Identity (7.1): $-\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}] = 9,896 - 1,097 = \$8,799$ (gap +0.00).
Cash (chain): \$8,924 per funded account, of which the refund term \$125.
Engine, fresh paths: **\$9,209** per funded account; 6.8% of attempts reach a payout; median 52 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
0	0.7732	\$0
1	0.1754	\$30,549

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
2	0.0398	\$60,549
3	0.0090	\$90,549
4	0.0020	\$120,549

Chain values.

15.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt: chain $\mathbb{E}[V] = 0.2945 \times 8,924 - 549.00 = \$2,079$; engine \$2,175.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 23.01$ days per attempt, so 1.32 attempts a month per slot and \$726 of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (paths 141–144): a failed evaluation lasts 13.8 days on average; a passed one 20.9 days, then 22.7 days funded with 0.28 payouts; 41.1 trades per attempt.

Value per month (8.3): $30.44 \times 2,175 / 23.01 = \$2,877 \pm \$228$ (95%, cluster-robust) per account on sixteen fresh paths.

15.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Fee	Fee per \$100K	EV/month (95%)	EV/month per \$100K
100K	\$549	\$549	\$2,877 $\pm$ \$228	\$2,877
50K	\$379	\$758	\$1,310 $\pm$ \$116	\$2,620
25K	\$199	\$796	\$643 $\pm$ \$58	\$2,573
10K	\$89	\$890	\$246 $\pm$ \$23	\$2,457
5K	\$59	\$1,180	\$105 $\pm$ \$12	\$2,099

The plan's setting scaled to each size (risk, targets and payout target in proportion; safety margins too), on the same sixteen fresh paths.

Per person: one active account of each size. **Copying:** between your own FXIFY accounts. **The plan:** 1 $\times$ 100K; 1 $\times$ 50K; 1 $\times$ 25K; 1 $\times$ 10K; 1 $\times$ 5K, worth \$5,181 a month (5 accounts); at the firm's full allowance: 1 $\times$ 100K; 1 $\times$ 50K; 1 $\times$ 25K; 1 $\times$ 10K; 1 $\times$ 5K, worth \$5,181 a month (5 accounts).

15.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Value of an attempt	Days per attempt	Pass rate
$\times 1$	\$2,548 $\pm$ \$600	+\$1,870	22.3	28.6%
$\times 1.5$	\$2,162 $\pm$ \$797	+\$1,538	21.7	26.6%
$\times 2$	\$2,127 $\pm$ \$596	+\$1,470	21.0	25.1%

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost multiplied (spread, commission, slippage), 12,000 attempts on paths 141–144 with the same random numbers in every row. Higher cost lowers the value of an attempt and can also shorten it (more attempts fail sooner), so the value per month need not fall in proportion.

15.11 How the plan meets the rules

- Nasdaq with the stop widened to fit 1:10 leverage (USDJPY was searched too)
- each day's take-profit capped at 25% of the cycle target (and 40% per trade), so the best-day rule always holds
- one Classic account of each size: 100K, 50K, 25K, 10K and 5K
- flat every day by 20:00 UTC (no entry from 19:00 UTC), so the account is flat through every daily reset and pays no overnight financing; flat at weekends
- concentration policy: no trade and no day makes more than 40% of the current phase or payout target, so every phase and every payout takes at least three winning days
- risk per trade sized so that the stop loss plus the round-trip cost fits the room under the floor and under the day's limit; when that room is below a tenth of the normal risk the account is closed (stopped and replaced), never traded in micro size
- minimum and qualifying days completed with trades held at least 2 minutes

Sources: cryptoslate.com (FXIFY review, updated 4 Oct 2026: Classic and Pro prices and rules); fxify.com FAQs ("What is the max allocation?"; 2 Phase Pro max allocation; copy trading); search summaries of FXIFY leverage.

FundedNext Stellar 2-Step

EURUSD; plan setting: risk 1.75%, $k = 6$, $m = 1$, payout target 20% of the account; **\$1,590 a month per 100K** ($\pm$ \$209); in the plan: $1 \times 200K$, \$3,265 a month.

16.1 The rules

Rule	As published (read 4 October 2026)
Fee	\$549.99 for 100K; \$1,049.99 for 200K (from August 2026); refunded with the first reward
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	8% / 5%
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	5% / 10%
Minimum trading days	5 per phase
Funded split and payouts	80%; first reward 21 days after the funded account opens, then every 14 days (the 21-day option); 3-day and on-demand options exist with other conditions
15% challenge reward	for accounts bought from 12 January 2026, paid only on Scale-Up eligibility (not counted)
Consistency rule	none on Stellar accounts; profit around high-impact news counts at 40% on funded accounts
Leverage	1:100 forex; 1:10 gold (from January 2026); 1:10 indices (from May 2026)
Per person	\$300,000 funded; evaluations unlimited
Copying	between your own challenge accounts; never into a funded account
Monitored as gambling	one-sided betting (remedy: a 1% risk limit), account rolling, breaching several accounts in a short span, losses exceeding gains (remedies: 40% consistency on on-demand rewards or a lower split)

16.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	\$549.99
Phase 1	target \$8,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$5,000; at least 5 trading days; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$3,200)
Phase 2	target \$5,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$5,000; at least 5 trading days; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$2,000)
Funded account	maximum loss \$10,000, static; daily loss \$5,000; split 80%; \$549.99 of the fee returned with payout number 1; first payout 21 days after funding, then every 14 days; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the payout target
Trading hours	no entry from 19:00 UTC, flat at 20:00 UTC every day; flat at weekends
Margin	leverage 1:100 (evaluation), 1:100 (funded); margin at most 60% of the current balance at entry

16.3 The search

Searched: 882 grid settings (EURUSD, gold; 2,000 attempts each) and 32 refined settings (16,000 attempts each, paths 111–114). The eight best refined settings on EURUSD:

Risk	k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
1.75%	6	1	20%	\$1,667 $\pm$ \$600	24.5%	16.6
1.75%	12	1	15%	\$1,569 $\pm$ \$480	24.5%	16.9
1.75%	4	1	15%	\$1,568 $\pm$ \$357	24.3%	16.8
1.75%	6	1	10%	\$1,545 $\pm$ \$442	24.3%	17.6
1.75%	8	1	15%	\$1,516 $\pm$ \$477	24.5%	16.8
1.75%	12	1	10%	\$1,503 $\pm$ \$321	23.7%	17.6
1.75%	8	1	10%	\$1,494 $\pm$ \$293	23.7%	17.6
1.75%	7	1	30%	\$1,445 $\pm$ \$769	23.5%	16.3

Refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below. Many settings sit within each other's intervals: the ranking near the top is not reliable, the region is.

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
1.5	1.07	0.68	0.75	0.80	0.70	0.40
2	0.94	0.89	1.05	1.02	0.70	0.20
3	1.27	1.23	1.42	1.49	1.32	0.71
4	1.21	1.36	1.24	1.55	1.06	1.31

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
6	1.11	1.23	1.73	1.31	1.50	1.37
8	1.04	1.19	1.50	1.58	1.22	1.76
12	1.05	1.21	1.55	1.63	1.35	1.72

Grid value per month (\$ thousands; 2,000 attempts each on paths 101–104, so $\pm \$0.6$ – $1.2K$) at risk \$1,750 and stop $m = 1$, by k (rows) and payout target X (columns). Darker is more. The chosen setting is in the table above it, re-measured on fresh paths.

16.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	Risk / k / m / X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an attempt
Plan	1.75% / 6 / 1 / 20%	\$1,590 $\pm$ \$209	24.0%	\$5,869	16.5	+\$860
FundedNext Stellar, gold	1.75% / 8 / 1.03 / 20%	\$2,761 $\pm$ \$214	30.1%	\$7,098	17.5	+\$1,586

One 100K account; each row's own chosen setting on sixteen fresh paths (121–136), 24,000 attempts, cluster-robust 95% interval. Version 6 reported \$3,804 a month for this programme under its rules and engine.

16.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1,750$; stop $s = m\sigma = 1 \times 0.0853\% = 0.0853\%$ of the price; at 1.1256 that is **9.6 pips**.
Notional $N = l/s = \$2,052,760$; **\$182.37 per pip**; at \$10.00 per pip per standard lot, **18.24 lots** (round down).
Cost $c = \kappa N = \$127.27$, $\rho = c/l = 7.27\%$; the risk is sized so that $l(1 + \rho)$ fits the room (5.4).
First trade of phase 1: $w = \min(kl, A_1, \text{caps}) = \$3,200$; take-profit 18.2 pips away; $p = l/(l + w + c) = 0.3447$.
Mean $-c$; variance $l(w + c) = 5,822,725$; duration about 1.90 h of open market (losers 1.60 h, winners 2.5 h), cut at 20:00 UTC.
A full funded win \$8,000: take-profit 45 pips away, $p = 0.1772$.
Margin at the funded leverage 1:100: $\$20,528 = 20.5\%$ of the starting balance (limit 60%); smallest stop $m_{\min} = 0.342$.

16.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$8,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_1 = 0.4540$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 14.11$, $K = \$1,764$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$9,883$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.4575$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.5556$.
Rules in play: every win at most \$3,200; 5 trading days (filler trades in the engine).

Daily loss limit \$5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Phase 2: $A = \$5,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_2 = 0.5417$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 14.65$, $K = \$1,828$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$9,897$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.5448$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.6667$.
Rules in play: every win at most \$2,000; 5 trading days (filler trades in the engine).

Daily loss limit \$5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Both phases: $P = 0.4540 \times 0.5417 = 0.2459$ (chain). Engine with every rule, fresh paths: **0.2402 $\pm$ 0.0054**.

16.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$10,000$; payout targets $X_1 = \$20,000$; split 80%; per-trade cap \$8,000.
Cycle success chances: $q_1 = 0.2736$; expected paid cycles 0.3767; expected withdrawn before the split \$7,535.
Identity (7.1): $-\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}] = 9,891 - 2,356 = \$7,535$ (gap +0.00).
Cash (chain): \$6,178 per funded account, of which the refund term \$151.
Engine, fresh paths: **\$5,869** per funded account; 7.1% of attempts reach a payout; median 40 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
0	0.7264	\$0
1	0.1988	\$16,550
2	0.0544	\$32,550

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
3	0.0149	\$48,550
4	0.0041	\$64,550

Chain values.

16.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt: chain $\mathbb{E}[V] = 0.2459 \times 6,178 - 549.99 = \969 ; engine \$860.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 16.47$ days per attempt, so 1.85 attempts a month per slot and \$1,017 of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (paths 141–144): a failed evaluation lasts 10.3 days on average; a passed one 20.0 days, then 16.1 days funded with 0.49 payouts; 29.2 trades per attempt.

Value per month (8.3): $30.44 \times 860 / 16.47 = \$1,590 \pm \$209$ (95%, cluster-robust) per account on sixteen fresh paths.

16.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Fee	Fee per \$100K	EV/month (95%)	EV/month per \$100K
100K	\$549.99	\$550	\$1,590 $\pm$ \$209	\$1,590
200K	\$1,049.99	\$525	\$3,265 $\pm$ \$416	\$1,633

The plan's setting scaled to each size (risk, targets and payout target in proportion; safety margins too), on the same sixteen fresh paths.

Per person: \$300,000 funded; evaluations unlimited. **Copying:** between your own challenge accounts, never into a funded account. **The plan:** 1 $\times$ 200K, worth \$3,265 a month (1 account); at the firm's full allowance: 1 $\times$ 200K, worth \$3,265 a month (1 accounts).

16.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Value of an attempt	Days per attempt	Pass rate
$\times 1$	\$1,630 $\pm$ \$897	+\$865	16.2	22.7%
$\times 1.5$	\$1,012 $\pm$ \$791	+\$494	14.8	19.1%
$\times 2$	\$405 $\pm$ \$370	+\$178	13.4	14.8%

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost multiplied (spread, commission, slippage), 12,000 attempts on paths 141–144 with the same random numbers in every row. Higher cost lowers the value of an attempt and can also shorten it (more attempts fail sooner), so the value per month need not fall in proportion.

16.11 How the plan meets the rules

- its own market (no other account trades it), with its own direction rule: its trades are never copies
- one account at the larger size if it is worth more
- flat around news
- flat every day by 20:00 UTC (no entry from 19:00 UTC), so the account is flat through every daily reset and pays no overnight financing; flat at weekends
- concentration policy: no trade and no day makes more than 40% of the current phase or payout target, so every phase and every payout takes at least three winning days
- risk per trade sized so that the stop loss plus the round-trip cost fits the room under the floor and under the day's limit; when that room is below a tenth of the normal risk the account is closed (stopped and replaced), never traded in micro size
- minimum and qualifying days completed with trades held at least 2 minutes

Sources: <https://help.fundnext.com/en/articles/9430123-is-there-a-minimum-trading-day-and-profit-target-in-the-fundnext-account-of-the-stellar-2-step-model>; help.fundnext.com (copy trading; prohibited strategies).

Fintokei ProTrader

Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100); plan setting: risk 1.75%, $k = 10$, $m = 1$, payout target 30% of the account; **\$3,209 a month per 100K** ($\pm$ \$339); in the plan: $5 \times 100K$, \$16,043 a month.

17.1 The rules

Rule	As published (read 4 October 2026)
Fee	\$549 for 100K; \$1,249 for 200K; \$2,599 for 400K; returned with the first payout as a sign-up bonus
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	8% / 6%
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	5% of the equity at the start of the day (midnight UTC; it rises with open profit at midnight) / 10% static
Minimum days	3 profitable days per phase (the stricter of two published readings)
Maximum risk per trade	3% on open trades (a warning, after which consistency rules can apply)
Funded split and payouts	80%; first request 14 days after the funded account opens, then every 14 days; at least 3% profit; all positions closed at the request
Discretionary consistency rules	if trading is flagged unsustainable: leverage 1:10, daily profit and loss capped at 1%
Leverage	1:100 forex, gold and silver; 1:50 indices
Per person	€500,000 of accounts in total
Copying	your own trades across your own accounts allowed; other people's signals prohibited
Prohibited	reaching a phase target in one or a few identical trades ('all-in'); token trades to complete days

17.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	\$549
Phase 1	target \$8,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$5,000 (5% of start-of-day equity); 3 profitable days of at least \$500; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$3,200)
Phase 2	target \$6,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$5,000 (5% of start-of-day equity); 3 profitable days of at least \$500; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$2,400)
Funded account	maximum loss \$10,000, static; daily loss \$5,000; split 80%; \$549.00 of the fee returned with payout number 1; first payout 14 days after funding, then every 14 days; minimum payout \$3,000; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the payout target
Trading hours	no entry from 19:00 UTC, flat at 20:00 UTC every day; flat at weekends
Margin	leverage 1:50 (evaluation), 1:50 (funded); margin at most 60% of the current balance at entry

17.3 The search

Searched: 504 grid settings (Nasdaq; 2,000 attempts each) and 16 refined settings (16,000 attempts each, paths 111–114). The eight best refined settings on Nasdaq:

Risk	k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
1.75%	10	1	30%	\$3,449 $\pm$ \$1,346	30.5%	16.6
1.75%	16	1	30%	\$3,346 $\pm$ \$1,209	30.3%	16.5
1.75%	12	1	30%	\$3,346 $\pm$ \$1,228	30.3%	16.5
1.75%	6	1	20%	\$3,258 $\pm$ \$772	31.3%	16.8
1.75%	6	1	30%	\$3,227 $\pm$ \$1,323	29.9%	16.3
1.75%	8	1	15%	\$3,208 $\pm$ \$685	30.7%	17.3
1.75%	8	1	20%	\$3,205 $\pm$ \$987	31.0%	16.8
1.75%	8	0.75	20%	\$3,181 $\pm$ \$842	29.3%	15.8

Refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below. Many settings sit within each other's intervals: the ranking near the top is not reliable, the region is.

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
1.5	2.26	2.27	2.36	2.55	1.70	1.61
2	2.12	2.76	2.65	2.65	2.77	2.31
3	2.25	2.52	2.92	3.01	3.00	3.31
4	2.32	2.87	2.81	3.10	2.39	2.49
6	1.96	2.57	2.36	2.81	3.23	3.45

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
8	2.03	3.02	2.77	3.21	3.18	3.12
12	2.00	2.89	2.79	2.84	3.07	3.56

Grid value per month (\$ thousands; 2,000 attempts each on paths 101–104, so $\pm \$0.6$ – $1.2K$) at risk \$1,750 and stop $m = 1$, by k (rows) and payout target X (columns). Darker is more. The chosen setting is in the table above it, re-measured on fresh paths.

17.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	Risk / k / m / X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an attempt
Plan	1.75% / 10 / 1 / 30%	\$3,209 $\pm$ \$339	30.2%	\$7,519	16.3	+\$1,719

One 100K account; each row's own chosen setting on sixteen fresh paths (121–136), 24,000 attempts, cluster-robust 95% interval. Version 6 reported \$4,072 a month for this programme under its rules and engine.

17.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1,750$; stop $s = m\sigma = 1 \times 0.2737\% = 0.2737\%$ of the price; at 31,070.00 that is **85.0 points**.

Notional $N = l/s = \$639,413$; **\$20.58 per point**; lots = this divided by the contract's dollars per point per lot, rounded down.

Cost $c = \kappa N = \$40.92$, $\rho = c/l = 2.34\%$; the risk is sized so that $l(1 + \rho)$ fits the room (5.4).

First trade of phase 1: $w = \min(kl, A_1, \text{caps}) = \$2,667$; take-profit 131.6 points away; $p = l/(l + w + c) = 0.3926$.

Mean $-c$; variance $l(w + c) = 4,738,281$; duration about 1.55 h of open market (losers 1.36 h, winners 1.8 h), cut at 20:00 UTC.

A full funded win \$12,000: take-profit 585 points away, $p = 0.1269$.

Margin at the funded leverage 1:50: \$12,788 = 12.8% of the starting balance (limit 60%); smallest stop $m_{\min} = 0.213$.

17.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$8,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_1 = 0.5199$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 14.66$, $K = \$589$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$9,888$; identity gap -0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.5228$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.5556$.

Rules in play: every win at most \$3,200; 3 profitable days needed: the engine aims at a daily target (6.4), which the chain leaves out.

Daily loss limit \$5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Phase 2: $A = \$6,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_2 = 0.5855$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 14.66$, $K = \$591$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$9,900$; identity gap -0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.5881$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.6250$.

Rules in play: every win at most \$2,400; 3 profitable days needed: the engine aims at a daily target (6.4), which the chain leaves out.

Daily loss limit \$5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Both phases: $P = 0.5199 \times 0.5855 = 0.3044$ (chain). Engine with every rule, fresh paths: **0.3017 $\pm$ 0.0058**.

17.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$10,000$; payout targets $X_1 = \$30,000$; split 80%; per-trade cap \$12,000.

Cycle success chances: $q_1 = 0.2335$; expected paid cycles 0.3047; expected withdrawn before the split \$9,141.

Identity (7.1): $-\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}] = 9,899 - 758 = \$9,141$ (gap +0.00).

Cash (chain): \$7,441 per funded account, of which the refund term \$128.

Engine, fresh paths: **\$7,519** per funded account; 9.9% of attempts reach a payout; median 31 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
0	0.7665	\$0
1	0.1790	\$24,549
2	0.0418	\$48,549
3	0.0098	\$72,549
4	0.0023	\$96,549

17.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt: chain $\mathbb{E}[V] = 0.3044 \times 7,441 - 549.00 = \$1,716$; engine \$1,719.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 16.31$ days per attempt, so 1.87 attempts a month per slot and \$1,025 of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (paths 141–144): a failed evaluation lasts 9.9 days on average; a passed one 17.6 days, then 13.1 days funded with 0.47 payouts; 32.8 trades per attempt.

Value per month (8.3): $30.44 \times 1,719 / 16.31 = \$3,209 \pm \$339$ (95%, cluster-robust) per account on sixteen fresh paths.

17.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Fee	Fee per \$100K	EV/month (95%)	EV/month per \$100K
100K	\$549	\$549	\$3,209 $\pm$ \$339	\$3,209
200K	\$1,249	\$624	\$6,163 $\pm$ \$684	\$3,082

The plan's setting scaled to each size (risk, targets and payout target in proportion; safety margins too), on the same sixteen fresh paths.

Per person: €500,000 of accounts. **Copying:** your own trades across your own accounts. **The plan:** $5 \times 100K$, worth \$16,043 a month (5 accounts); at the firm's full allowance: $5 \times 100K$, worth \$16,043 a month (5 accounts).

17.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Value of an attempt	Days per attempt	Pass rate
$\times 1$	\$3,132 $\pm$ \$998	+\$1,660	16.1	29.8%
$\times 1.5$	\$2,756 $\pm$ \$619	+\$1,434	15.8	28.2%
$\times 2$	\$2,356 $\pm$ \$705	+\$1,177	15.2	26.5%

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost multiplied (spread, commission, slippage), 12,000 attempts on paths 141–144 with the same random numbers in every row. Higher cost lowers the value of an attempt and can also shorten it (more attempts fail sooner), so the value per month need not fall in proportion.

17.11 How the plan meets the rules

- Nasdaq, shared direction; $5 \times 100K$: \$500,000 is about €444,000 at 1.1256, inside the €500,000 cap, and 100K is cheaper per dollar than 200K
- 1.5% risk, half the 3% limit
- every position closed before a payout request
- flat every day by 20:00 UTC (no entry from 19:00 UTC), so the account is flat through every daily reset and pays no overnight financing; flat at weekends
- concentration policy: no trade and no day makes more than 40% of the current phase or payout target, so every phase and every payout takes at least three winning days
- risk per trade sized so that the stop loss plus the round-trip cost fits the room under the floor and under the day's limit; when that room is below a tenth of the normal risk the account is closed (stopped and replaced), never traded in micro size
- minimum and qualifying days completed with trades held at least 2 minutes

Sources: <https://support.fintokey.com/en/articles/6538826-how-are-the-daily-loss-limit-and-maximum-loss-limit-calculated>; <https://support.fintokey.com/en/articles/9464503-what-is-all-in-trading-and-why-is-it-forbidden-to-achieve-profit-target-in-one-trade>; fintokey.com (ProTrader page and terms).

Hola Prime 2-Step Prime

gold (XAUUSD); plan setting: risk 1.75%, $k = 10$, $m = 1.03$, payout target 20% of the account; **\$2,813 a month per 100K** ($\pm$ \$245); in the plan: $2 \times 100\text{K}$, \$5,627 a month.

18.1 The rules

Rule	As published (read 4 October 2026)
Fee	about \$599 for 100K (published \$409–\$599 with the payout option); returned 25% with each of the first four payouts
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	8% / 5% (the 200K size has 4% / 8% limits)
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	5% of the previous day's closing balance / 10% static
Minimum trading days	3 per phase
Funded split and payouts	bi-weekly 80% with 3 profitable days in the cycle; monthly 95% with 7; on-demand 80%
Consistency (funded)	best day at most 40% of the payout's profit
Risk (funded)	stop-loss on every trade; at most 2% risk per trade
Leverage	1:50 forex; 1:10 indices and metals
Per person	\$500,000
Copying	only between your own Hola Prime accounts (funded: one master and one copier); copying from accounts at other prop firms prohibited
Prohibited	one-sided betting, grid trading, excessive margin use, hedging across accounts, profitability materially dependent on concentrated outcomes

18.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	\$599
Phase 1	target \$8,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$5,000; at least 3 trading days; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$3,200)
Phase 2	target \$5,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$5,000; at least 3 trading days; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$2,000)
Funded account	maximum loss \$10,000, static; daily loss \$5,000; split 80%; fee returned in 4 equal parts with the first 4 payouts; first payout 14 days after funding, then every 14 days; best day at most 40% of a payout's profit; 3 profitable days of \$500+ per cycle; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the payout target
Trading hours	no entry from 19:00 UTC, flat at 20:00 UTC every day; flat at weekends
Margin	leverage 1:10 (evaluation), 1:10 (funded); margin at most 60% of the current balance at entry

18.3 The search

Searched: 882 grid settings (EURUSD, gold; 2,000 attempts each) and 32 refined settings (16,000 attempts each, paths 111–114). The eight best refined settings on gold:

Risk	k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
1.75%	10	1.03	20%	\$2,944 $\pm$ \$1,087	30.0%	16.1
1.75%	16	1.03	20%	\$2,910 $\pm$ \$983	30.2%	16.2
1.75%	12	1.03	20%	\$2,906 $\pm$ \$975	30.2%	16.2
1.75%	8	1.03	20%	\$2,874 $\pm$ \$1,046	29.7%	16.1
1.75%	6	1.25	20%	\$2,793 $\pm$ \$535	31.0%	17.3
1.75%	12	1.25	20%	\$2,766 $\pm$ \$398	30.4%	17.3
1.75%	6	1.03	15%	\$2,757 $\pm$ \$848	29.8%	16.8
1.75%	8	1.25	20%	\$2,752 $\pm$ \$442	30.6%	17.4

Refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below. Many settings sit within each other's intervals: the ranking near the top is not reliable, the region is.

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
1.5	1.79	1.97	2.15	2.07	1.74	2.14
2	1.85	2.03	2.34	2.12	1.82	2.09
3	2.03	2.22	2.29	2.76	2.96	2.43

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
4	2.05	2.33	2.23	2.36	2.16	2.72
6	1.89	2.21	2.32	2.92	2.66	2.80
8	2.03	2.63	2.17	3.23	3.04	2.80
12	2.04	2.43	2.08	3.47	3.51	2.64

Grid value per month (\$ thousands; 2,000 attempts each on paths 101–104, so $\pm \$0.6$ – $1.2K$) at risk \$1,750 and stop $m = 1.03$, by k (rows) and payout target X (columns). Darker is more. The chosen setting is in the table above it, re-measured on fresh paths.

18.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	Risk / k / m / X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an attempt
Plan	1.75% / 10 / 1.03 / 20%	\$2,813 $\pm$ \$245	29.8%	\$7,026	16.2	+\$1,496
Hola Prime 2-Step Prime, EURUSD	1.75% / 7 / 1.25 / 20%	\$1,247 $\pm$ \$226	25.4%	\$5,219	17.7	+\$727

One 100K account; each row's own chosen setting on sixteen fresh paths (121–136), 24,000 attempts, cluster-robust 95% interval. Version 6 reported \$4,578 a month for this programme under its rules and engine.

18.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1,750$; stop $s = m\sigma = 1.03 \times 0.2838\% = 0.2923\%$ of the price; at 4,176.80 that is **12.2 dollars**.
Notional $N = l/s = \$598,598$; **\$143.32 per dollar**; at \$100.00 per dollar per standard lot, **1.43 lots** (round down).
Cost $c = \kappa N = \$64.65$, $\rho = c/l = 3.69\%$; the risk is sized so that $l(1 + \rho)$ fits the room (5.4).
First trade of phase 1: $w = \min(kl, A_1, \text{caps}) = \$3,200$; take-profit 22.8 dollars away; $p = l/(l + w + c) = 0.3490$.
Mean $-c$; variance $l(w + c) = 5,713,135$; duration about 1.98 h of open market (losers 1.67 h, winners 2.6 h), cut at 20:00 UTC.
A full funded win \$8,000: take-profit 56 dollars away, $p = 0.1783$.
Margin at the funded leverage 1:10: \$59,860 = 59.9% of the starting balance (limit 60%); smallest stop $m_{\min} = 1.028$.

18.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$8,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_1 = 0.5013$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 14.53$, $K = \$923$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$9,893$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.5043$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.5556$.
Rules in play: every win at most \$3,200; 3 trading days (filler trades in the engine).

Daily loss limit \$5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Phase 2: $A = \$5,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_2 = 0.6009$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 14.76$, $K = \$942$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$9,889$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.6039$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.6667$.
Rules in play: every win at most \$2,000; 3 trading days (filler trades in the engine).

Daily loss limit \$5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Both phases: $P = 0.5013 \times 0.6009 = 0.3013$ (chain). Engine with every rule, fresh paths: **0.2982 $\pm$ 0.0058**.

18.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$10,000$; payout targets $X_1 = \$20,000$; split 80%; per-trade cap \$8,000.
Cycle success chances: $q_1 = 0.3008$; expected paid cycles 0.4302; expected withdrawn before the split \$8,604.
Identity (7.1): $-\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}] = 9,893 - 1,289 = \$8,604$ (gap +0.00).
Cash (chain): \$6,947 per funded account, of which the refund term \$64.
Engine, fresh paths: **\$7,026** per funded account; 9.0% of attempts reach a payout; median 32 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
0	0.6992	\$0
1	0.2103	\$16,150

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
2	0.0633	\$32,300
3	0.0190	\$48,449
4	0.0057	\$64,599

Chain values.

18.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt: chain $\mathbb{E}[V] = 0.3013 \times 6,947 - 599.00 = \$1,494$; engine \$1,496.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 16.19$ days per attempt, so 1.88 attempts a month per slot and \$1,126 of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (paths 141–144): a failed evaluation lasts 9.4 days on average; a passed one 17.0 days, then 14.7 days funded with 0.43 payouts; 32.2 trades per attempt.

Value per month (8.3): $30.44 \times 1,496 / 16.19 = \$2,813 \pm \$245$ (95%, cluster-robust) per account on sixteen fresh paths.

18.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Fee	Fee per \$100K	EV/month (95%)	EV/month per \$100K
100K	\$599	\$599	\$2,813 $\pm$ \$245	\$2,813

The plan's setting scaled to each size (risk, targets and payout target in proportion; safety margins too), on the same sixteen fresh paths.

Per person: \$500,000. **Copying:** only between your own Hola Prime accounts (funded: one master and one copier); never from other firms. **The plan:** $2 \times 100K$, worth \$5,627 a month (2 accounts); at the firm's full allowance: $2 \times 100K$, worth \$5,627 a month (2 accounts).

18.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Value of an attempt	Days per attempt	Pass rate
$\times 1$	\$2,786 $\pm$ \$740	+\$1,464	16.0	29.5%
$\times 1.5$	\$2,252 $\pm$ \$779	+\$1,117	15.1	25.7%
$\times 2$	\$1,622 $\pm$ \$213	+\$758	14.2	22.9%

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost multiplied (spread, commission, slippage), 12,000 attempts on paths 141–144 with the same random numbers in every row. Higher cost lowers the value of an attempt and can also shorten it (more attempts fail sooner), so the value per month need not fall in proportion.

18.11 How the plan meets the rules

- its own market, traded by no other account (so nothing is copied from another firm)
- two accounts: one master and one copier, the most Hola Prime allows to share trades
- take-profit capped at 40% of the cycle target per day; daily profit target until 3 profitable days
- flat every day by 20:00 UTC (no entry from 19:00 UTC), so the account is flat through every daily reset and pays no overnight financing; flat at weekends
- concentration policy: no trade and no day makes more than 40% of the current phase or payout target, so every phase and every payout takes at least three winning days
- risk per trade sized so that the stop loss plus the round-trip cost fits the room under the floor and under the day's limit; when that room is below a tenth of the normal risk the account is closed (stopped and replaced), never traded in micro size
- minimum and qualifying days completed with trades held at least 2 minutes

Sources: holaprime.com (2-Step Prime FAQ; prohibited trading practices); propfirmmap.com; thetrustedprop.com.

Alpha Capital Alpha Pro 10%

Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100); plan setting; risk 1.75%, $k = 6$, $m = 1$, payout target 20% of the account; **\$3,199 a month per 100K** ($\pm$ \$192); in the plan: $1 \times 200K$, \$6,392 a month.

19.1 The rules

Rule	As published (read 4 October 2026)
Fee	\$497 for 100K; \$997 for 200K; refund policy reported inconsistently (assumed none)
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	10% / 5%
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	5% (balance) / 10% static
Minimum trading days	3 per phase
Funded split and payouts	80%; bi-weekly; or on demand with at least 2% gross profit and no day above 40% of the profit (the 40% rule applies to on-demand payouts only)
Risk	never risk or lose 2% or more on one trade or group of trades closed together
Duration	the average trade must last more than 2 minutes, and at least half of the profit must come from trades longer than 2 minutes
Leverage	1:100 forex; 1:20 indices; 1:30 metals
Per person	\$400,000 per household; \$300,000 per strategy
Copying	from your own external accounts with proof of ownership
Prohibited	gambling, 'all or nothing' trading

19.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	\$497
Phase 1	target \$10,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$5,000; at least 3 trading days; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$4,000)
Phase 2	target \$5,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$5,000; at least 3 trading days; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$2,000)
Funded account	maximum loss \$10,000, static; daily loss \$5,000; split 80%; no fee refund; first payout 14 days after funding, then every 14 days; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the payout target
Trading hours	no entry from 19:00 UTC, flat at 20:00 UTC every day; flat at weekends
Margin	leverage 1:20 (evaluation), 1:20 (funded); margin at most 60% of the current balance at entry

19.3 The search

Searched: 504 grid settings (Nasdaq; 2,000 attempts each) and 16 refined settings (16,000 attempts each, paths 111–114). The eight best refined settings on Nasdaq:

Risk	k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
1.75%	6	1	20%	\$3,307 $\pm$ \$646	29.3%	15.8
1.75%	16	0.75	20%	\$3,252 $\pm$ \$1,154	28.1%	14.7
1.75%	12	0.75	20%	\$3,202 $\pm$ \$1,228	28.1%	14.6
1.75%	10	0.75	20%	\$3,186 $\pm$ \$1,054	28.1%	14.6
1.75%	6	1	15%	\$3,162 $\pm$ \$900	29.2%	16.2
1.50%	8	1	20%	\$3,103 $\pm$ \$911	29.3%	16.9
1.75%	3	1	30%	\$3,082 $\pm$ \$626	29.6%	15.4
1.75%	8	0.54	30%	\$3,074 $\pm$ \$825	25.6%	13.1

Refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below. Many settings sit within each other's intervals: the ranking near the top is not reliable, the region is.

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
1.5	2.14	2.39	2.34	2.18	2.57	2.17
2	2.01	2.66	2.28	2.87	2.78	2.44
3	2.26	2.85	3.40	2.15	3.08	3.37
4	2.32	2.48	2.63	2.97	2.88	3.28
6	2.33	2.78	2.70	3.41	3.40	3.26

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
8	2.18	2.80	2.60	3.45	3.20	2.80
12	2.18	2.75	2.80	3.32	3.12	3.10

Grid value per month (\$ thousands; 2,000 attempts each on paths 101–104, so $\pm \$0.6$ – $1.2K$) at risk \$1,750 and stop $m = 1$, by k (rows) and payout target X (columns). Darker is more. The chosen setting is in the table above it, re-measured on fresh paths.

19.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	Risk / k / m / X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an attempt
Plan	1.75% / 6 / 1 / 20%	\$3,199 $\pm$ \$192	28.9%	\$7,373	15.6	+\$1,638

One 100K account; each row's own chosen setting on sixteen fresh paths (121–136), 24,000 attempts, cluster-robust 95% interval. Version 6 reported \$6,372 a month for this programme under its rules and engine.

19.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1,750$; stop $s = m\sigma = 1 \times 0.2737\% = 0.2737\%$ of the price; at 31,070.00 that is **85.0 points**.
Notional $N = l/s = \$639,413$; **\$20.58 per point**; lots = this divided by the contract's dollars per point per lot, rounded down.
Cost $c = \kappa N = \$40.92$, $\rho = c/l = 2.34\%$; the risk is sized so that $l(1 + \rho)$ fits the room (5.4).
First trade of phase 1: $w = \min(kl, A_1, \text{caps}) = \$4,000$; take-profit 196.4 points away; $p = l/(l + w + c) = 0.3022$.
Mean $-c$; variance $l(w + c) = 7,071,614$; duration about 2.31 h of open market (losers 1.87 h, winners 3.3 h), cut at 20:00 UTC.
A full funded win \$8,000: take-profit 391 points away, $p = 0.1787$.
Margin at the funded leverage 1:20: $\$31,971 = 32.0\%$ of the starting balance (limit 60%); smallest stop $m_{\min} = 0.533$.

19.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$10,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_1 = 0.4681$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 14.52$, $K = \$585$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$9,898$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.4708$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.5000$.
Rules in play: every win at most \$4,000; 3 trading days (filler trades in the engine).

Daily loss limit \$5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Phase 2: $A = \$5,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_2 = 0.6242$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 14.81$, $K = \$598$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$9,897$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.6268$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.6667$.
Rules in play: every win at most \$2,000; 3 trading days (filler trades in the engine).

Daily loss limit \$5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Both phases: $P = 0.4681 \times 0.6242 = 0.2922$ (chain). Engine with every rule, fresh paths: **0.2895 $\pm$ 0.0057**.

19.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$10,000$; payout targets $X_1 = \$20,000$; split 80%; per-trade cap \$8,000.
Cycle success chances: $q_1 = 0.3116$; expected paid cycles 0.4526; expected withdrawn before the split \$9,052.
Identity (7.1): $-\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}] = 9,899 - 847 = \$9,052$ (gap +0.00).
Cash (chain): \$7,242 per funded account.
Engine, fresh paths: **\$7,373** per funded account; 10.8% of attempts reach a payout; median 30 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
0	0.6884	\$0
1	0.2145	\$16,000
2	0.0668	\$32,000
3	0.0208	\$48,000
4	0.0065	\$64,000

19.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt: chain $\mathbb{E}[V] = 0.2922 \times 7,242 - 497.00 = \$1,619$; engine \$1,638.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 15.58$ days per attempt, so 1.95 attempts a month per slot and \$971 of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (paths 141–144): a failed evaluation lasts 8.9 days on average; a passed one 17.2 days, then 14.1 days funded with 0.58 payouts; 30.6 trades per attempt.

Value per month (8.3): $30.44 \times 1,638 / 15.58 = \$3,199 \pm \$192$ (95%, cluster-robust) per account on sixteen fresh paths.

19.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Fee	Fee per \$100K	EV/month (95%)	EV/month per \$100K
100K	\$497	\$497	\$3,199 $\pm$ \$192	\$3,199
200K	\$997	\$498	\$6,392 $\pm$ \$385	\$3,196

The plan's setting scaled to each size (risk, targets and payout target in proportion; safety margins too), on the same sixteen fresh paths.

Per person: \$400,000 per household, \$300,000 per strategy. **Copying:** from your own external accounts with proof. **The plan:** 1 $\times$ 200K, worth \$6,392 a month (1 account); at the firm's full allowance: 1 $\times$ 200K; 1 $\times$ 100K, worth \$9,591 a month (2 accounts).

19.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Value of an attempt	Days per attempt	Pass rate
$\times 1$	\$3,032 $\pm$ \$663	+\$1,531	15.4	28.9%
$\times 1.5$	\$2,704 $\pm$ \$576	+\$1,317	14.8	26.7%
$\times 2$	\$2,314 $\pm$ \$378	+\$1,102	14.5	25.7%

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost multiplied (spread, commission, slippage), 12,000 attempts on paths 141–144 with the same random numbers in every row. Higher cost lowers the value of an attempt and can also shorten it (more attempts fail sooner), so the value per month need not fall in proportion.

19.11 How the plan meets the rules

- Nasdaq, 1.5% risk (well below 2%)
- bi-weekly payouts (no best-day rule)
- one account in the recommended plan
- flat every day by 20:00 UTC (no entry from 19:00 UTC), so the account is flat through every daily reset and pays no overnight financing; flat at weekends
- concentration policy: no trade and no day makes more than 40% of the current phase or payout target, so every phase and every payout takes at least three winning days
- risk per trade sized so that the stop loss plus the round-trip cost fits the room under the floor and under the day's limit; when that room is below a tenth of the normal risk the account is closed (stopped and replaced), never traded in micro size
- minimum and qualifying days completed with trades held at least 2 minutes

Sources: <https://help.alphacapitalgroup.uk/en/articles/10102634-performance-fee-on-demand>; <https://help.alphacapitalgroup.uk/en/articles/8447268-what-is-the-2-minute-average-trade-duration-rule>; alphacapitalgroup.uk.

FunderPro Classic

Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100); plan setting: risk 1.75%, $k = 8$, $m = 1.07$, payout target 20% of the account; **\$3,406 a month per 100K** ($\pm \$255$); in the plan: $1 \times 200K$, \$6,961 a month.

20.1 The rules

Rule	As published (read 4 October 2026)
Fee	\$539 for 100K list (often 20% off); \$989 for 200K; refunded with the first reward
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	10% / 5%
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	5% / 10% static
Minimum days	none
Funded split and payouts	80% bi-weekly
Consistency rule	none on Classic
Risk per trade	at most 2%
Margin (funded)	at most 20% of the starting balance as margin per asset class (FX, metals, energies, US and EU indices, shares, crypto); first breach: the profit of the breaching trades is removed; second: the account fails. No margin rule on challenges.
Leverage	1:100 forex; 1:30 indices (Classic and Pro challenges)
Per person	\$200,000
Copying	no replicating trades across FunderPro accounts; no copying from accounts you do not own

20.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	\$539
Phase 1	target \$10,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$5,000; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$4,000)
Phase 2	target \$5,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$5,000; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$2,000)
Funded account	maximum loss \$10,000, static; daily loss \$5,000; split 80%; \$539.00 of the fee returned with payout number 1; first payout 14 days after funding, then every 14 days; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the payout target
Trading hours	no entry from 19:00 UTC, flat at 20:00 UTC every day; flat at weekends
Margin	leverage 1:30 (evaluation), 1:30 (funded); margin at most 60% of the current balance at entry, and at most 20% of the starting balance on the funded account

20.3 The search

Searched: 840 grid settings (Nasdaq, USDJPY; 2,000 attempts each) and 32 refined settings (16,000 attempts each, paths 111–114). The eight best refined settings on Nasdaq:

Risk	k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
1.75%	8	1.07	20%	\$3,311 $\pm$ \$875	29.5%	16.1
1.75%	12	1.07	20%	\$3,220 $\pm$ \$901	29.0%	16.0
1.75%	16	1.07	20%	\$3,220 $\pm$ \$901	29.0%	16.0
1.75%	10	1.07	20%	\$3,212 $\pm$ \$910	29.1%	16.0
1.75%	4	1.07	20%	\$3,196 $\pm$ \$698	29.3%	16.0
1.75%	6	1.07	20%	\$3,149 $\pm$ \$696	29.2%	15.9
1.50%	8	0.92	20%	\$3,124 $\pm$ \$1,088	28.8%	16.3
1.75%	4	1.07	15%	\$3,111 $\pm$ \$629	28.9%	16.3

Refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below. Many settings sit within each other's intervals: the ranking near the top is not reliable, the region is.

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
1.5	2.19	2.31	2.77	2.65	2.47	1.89
2	2.49	2.48	2.58	2.75	3.00	2.75
3	2.57	2.79	3.17	3.10	2.91	3.00
4	2.32	2.56	2.80	3.23	3.37	2.71
6	2.57	2.55	2.91	3.14	3.57	2.77

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
8	2.29	2.56	2.72	2.92	3.33	3.19
12	2.42	2.44	2.74	3.04	3.74	2.96

Grid value per month (\$ thousands; 2,000 attempts each on paths 101–104, so $\pm \$0.6$ – $1.2K$) at risk \$1,750 and stop $m = 1.07$, by k (rows) and payout target X (columns). Darker is more. The chosen setting is in the table above it, re-measured on fresh paths.

20.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	Risk / k / m / X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an attempt
Plan	1.75% / 8 / 1.07 / 20%	\$3,406 $\pm$ \$255	29.4%	\$7,953	16.1	+\$1,800
FunderPro Classic, USDJPY	1.75% / 6 / 1.25 / 30%	\$2,467 $\pm$ \$240	27.2%	\$6,713	15.9	+\$1,285

One 100K account; each row's own chosen setting on sixteen fresh paths (121–136), 24,000 attempts, cluster-robust 95% interval. Version 6 reported \$7,734 a month for this programme under its rules and engine.

20.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1,750$; stop $s = m\sigma = 1.07 \times 0.2737\% = 0.2928\%$ of the price; at 31,070.00 that is **91.0 points**.
Notional $N = l/s = \$597,582$; **\$19.23 per point**; lots = this divided by the contract's dollars per point per lot, rounded down.
Cost $c = \kappa N = \$38.25$, $\rho = c/l = 2.19\%$; the risk is sized so that $l(1 + \rho)$ fits the room (5.4).
First trade of phase 1: $w = \min(kl, A_1, \text{caps}) = \$4,000$; take-profit 210.0 points away; $p = l/(l + w + c) = 0.3023$.
Mean $-c$; variance $l(w + c) = 7,066,929$; duration about 2.64 h of open market (losers 2.14 h, winners 3.8 h), cut at 20:00 UTC.
A full funded win \$8,000; take-profit 418 points away, $p = 0.1788$.
Margin at the funded leverage 1:30: \$19,919 = 19.9% of the starting balance (limit 20%); smallest stop $m_{\min} = 1.066$.

20.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$10,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_1 = 0.4699$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 14.53$, $K = \$547$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$9,897$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.4727$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.5000$.
Rules in play: every win at most \$4,000.

Daily loss limit \$5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Phase 2: $A = \$5,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_2 = 0.6268$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 14.81$, $K = \$559$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$9,895$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.6294$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.6667$.
Rules in play: every win at most \$2,000.

Daily loss limit \$5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Both phases: $P = 0.4699 \times 0.6268 = 0.2946$ (chain). Engine with every rule, fresh paths: **0.2941 $\pm$ 0.0058**.

20.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$10,000$; payout targets $X_1 = \$20,000$; split 80%; per-trade cap \$8,000.
Cycle success chances: $q_1 = 0.3129$; expected paid cycles 0.4553; expected withdrawn before the split \$9,106.
Identity (7.1): $-\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}] = 9,897 - 791 = \$9,106$ (gap +0.00).
Cash (chain): \$7,453 per funded account, of which the refund term \$169.
Engine, fresh paths: **\$7,953** per funded account; 11.5% of attempts reach a payout; median 31 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
0	0.6871	\$0
1	0.2150	\$16,539
2	0.0673	\$32,539
3	0.0210	\$48,539

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
4	0.0066	\$64,539

Chain values.

20.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt: chain $\mathbb{E}[V] = 0.2946 \times 7,453 - 539.00 = \$1,656$; engine \$1,800.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 16.09$ days per attempt, so 1.89 attempts a month per slot and \$1,020 of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (paths 141–144): a failed evaluation lasts 9.4 days on average; a passed one 17.1 days, then 14.7 days funded with 0.61 payouts; 31.1 trades per attempt.

Value per month (8.3): $30.44 \times 1,800/16.09 = \$3,406 \pm \$255$ (95%, cluster-robust) per account on sixteen fresh paths.

20.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Fee	Fee per \$100K	EV/month (95%)	EV/month per \$100K
100K	\$539	\$539	\$3,406 $\pm$ \$255	\$3,406
200K	\$989	\$494	\$6,961 $\pm$ \$506	\$3,480

The plan's setting scaled to each size (risk, targets and payout target in proportion; safety margins too), on the same sixteen fresh paths.

Per person: \$200,000. **Copying:** no replicating trades across FunderPro accounts. **The plan:** $1 \times 200K$, worth \$6,961 a month (1 account); at the firm's full allowance: $1 \times 200K$, worth \$6,961 a month (1 accounts).

20.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Value of an attempt	Days per attempt	Pass rate
$\times 1$	\$2,967 $\pm$ \$709	+\$1,527	15.7	27.9%
$\times 1.5$	\$2,611 $\pm$ \$850	+\$1,312	15.3	27.2%
$\times 2$	\$2,424 $\pm$ \$423	+\$1,178	14.8	25.0%

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost multiplied (spread, commission, slippage), 12,000 attempts on paths 141–144 with the same random numbers in every row. Higher cost lowers the value of an attempt and can also shorten it (more attempts fail sooner), so the value per month need not fall in proportion.

20.11 How the plan meets the rules

- one account, the larger size if it is worth more
- risk at most 1.75%, below the 2% limit
- stop at least 0.92 hourly standard deviations on the Nasdaq (or USDJPY), so the funded margin stays under 20% of the starting balance
- flat every day by 20:00 UTC (no entry from 19:00 UTC), so the account is flat through every daily reset and pays no overnight financing; flat at weekends
- concentration policy: no trade and no day makes more than 40% of the current phase or payout target, so every phase and every payout takes at least three winning days
- risk per trade sized so that the stop loss plus the round-trip cost fits the room under the floor and under the day's limit; when that room is below a tenth of the normal risk the account is closed (stopped and replaced), never traded in micro size
- minimum and qualifying days completed with trades held at least 2 minutes

Sources: <https://support.funderpro.com/en/articles/421458-is-there-a-margin-rule-on-funded-accounts>; <https://support.funderpro.com/en/articles/422676-leverage-on-funderpro-challenges>; tradelocker.com hub (prices).

Goat Funded Trader 2-Step Standard

Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100); plan setting: risk 1.75%, $k = 3$, $m = 1.07$, payout target 10% of the account; **\$2,534 a month per 100K** ($\pm$ \$118); in the plan: $1 \times 200K$, \$4,035 a month.

21.1 The rules

Rule	As published (read 4 October 2026)
Fee	\$524 for 100K; \$974 for 200K; refundable
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	10% / 5%
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	5% of the higher of balance and equity at 5 pm New York / 10% static
Minimum trading days	3 valid days per phase; a day is valid only with at least 0.5% profit
Funded split and payouts	80% every 14 days; 4 valid days (+0.5%) per payout cycle for accounts bought from 25 July 2026; first payout at least 3% profit (the model asks for 3% at every payout, which slightly understates the value); the first two payouts at most 6% of the account or \$10,000
Daily profit cap (funded)	\$3,000 a day at every account size; profit above it is deducted (not a breach)
Consistency rule	none
Leverage	evaluation 1:20 on indices; funded 1:10 on indices, 1:50 forex
Per person	\$400,000 funded
Copying	no duplicated trades or trade ideas between GFT accounts
Goat Guard (funded)	a combined floating loss of 2%: the first time the split falls to 50%, the second time the account is breached

21.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	\$524
Phase 1	target \$10,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$5,000; 3 profitable days of at least \$500; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$4,000)
Phase 2	target \$5,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$5,000; 3 profitable days of at least \$500; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$2,000)
Funded account	maximum loss \$10,000, static; daily loss \$5,000; split 80%; \$524.00 of the fee returned with payout number 1; first payout 14 days after funding, then every 14 days; minimum payout \$3,000; payout caps \$6,000, \$6,000; profit above \$3,000 a day not counted; 4 profitable days of \$500+ per cycle; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the payout target
Trading hours	no entry from 19:00 UTC, flat at 20:00 UTC every day; flat at weekends
Margin	leverage 1:20 (evaluation), 1:10 (funded); margin at most 60% of the current balance at entry

21.3 The search

Searched: 882 grid settings (Nasdaq, USDJPY; 2,000 attempts each) and 33 refined settings (16,000 attempts each, paths 111–114). The eight best refined settings on Nasdaq:

Risk	k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
1.75%	3	1.07	10%	\$2,639 $\pm$ \$264	29.3%	20.2
1.75%	3.5	1.07	15%	\$2,612 $\pm$ \$450	30.0%	20.1
1.75%	4	1.07	15%	\$2,609 $\pm$ \$384	29.6%	20.2
1.75%	6	1.07	10%	\$2,596 $\pm$ \$225	29.2%	20.3
1.75%	8	1.07	10%	\$2,592 $\pm$ \$263	29.6%	20.4
1.75%	12	1.07	10%	\$2,575 $\pm$ \$202	29.6%	20.3
1.75%	3	1.07	15%	\$2,541 $\pm$ \$526	29.3%	19.9
1.75%	4	1.07	10%	\$2,534 $\pm$ \$233	29.5%	20.1

Refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below. Many settings sit within each other's intervals: the ranking near the top is not reliable, the region is.

k \ X	4%	6%	8%	10%	15%	20%
1.5	1.85	2.39	2.25	2.23	2.28	2.25
2	1.89	2.37	2.35	2.39	2.30	2.12
3	2.07	2.30	2.65	2.64	2.76	2.45
4	1.84	2.20	2.65	2.69	2.74	2.41

k \ X	4%	6%	8%	10%	15%	20%
6	1.94	2.39	2.59	2.75	2.53	2.46
8	1.99	2.40	2.51	2.62	2.37	2.44
12	2.03	2.41	2.43	2.74	2.40	2.60

Grid value per month (\$ thousands; 2,000 attempts each on paths 101–104, so $\pm \$0.6$ – $1.2K$) at risk \$1,750 and stop $m = 1.07$, by k (rows) and payout target X (columns). Darker is more. The chosen setting is in the table above it, re-measured on fresh paths.

21.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	Risk / k / m / X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an attempt
Plan	1.75% / 3 / 1.07 / 10%	\$2,534 $\pm$ \$118	29.1%	\$7,519	20.0	+\$1,667
GFT Standard, USDJPY	1.75% / 3 / 1.25 / 15%	\$2,034 $\pm$ \$124	27.2%	\$6,626	19.1	+\$1,278

One 100K account; each row's own chosen setting on sixteen fresh paths (121–136), 24,000 attempts, cluster-robust 95% interval. Version 6 reported \$3,953 a month for this programme under its rules and engine.

21.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1,750$; stop $s = m\sigma = 1.07 \times 0.2737\% = 0.2928\%$ of the price; at 31,070.00 that is **91.0 points**.
Notional $N = l/s = \$597,582$; **\$19.23 per point**; lots = this divided by the contract's dollars per point per lot, rounded down.
Cost $c = \kappa N = \$38.25$, $\rho = c/l = 2.19\%$; the risk is sized so that $l(1 + \rho)$ fits the room (5.4).
First trade of phase 1: $w = \min(kl, A_1, \text{caps}) = \$3,333$; take-profit 175.3 points away; $p = l/(l + w + c) = 0.3417$.
Mean $-c$; variance $l(w + c) = 5,900,263$; duration about 2.21 h of open market (losers 1.85 h, winners 2.9 h), cut at 20:00 UTC.
A full funded win \$3,000; take-profit 158 points away, $p = 0.3655$.
Margin at the funded leverage 1:10: $\$59,758 = 59.8\%$ of the starting balance (limit 60%); smallest stop $m_{\min} = 1.066$.

21.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$10,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_1 = 0.4698$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 14.60$, $K = \$549$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$9,896$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.4726$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.5000$.
Rules in play: every win at most \$4,000; 3 profitable days needed: the engine aims at a daily target (6.4), which the chain leaves out.

Daily loss limit \$5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Phase 2: $A = \$5,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_2 = 0.6268$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 14.81$, $K = \$559$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$9,895$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.6294$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.6667$.
Rules in play: every win at most \$2,000; 3 profitable days needed: the engine aims at a daily target (6.4), which the chain leaves out.

Daily loss limit \$5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Both phases: $P = 0.4698 \times 0.6268 = 0.2945$ (chain). Engine with every rule, fresh paths: **0.2914 $\pm$ 0.0057**.

21.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$10,000$; payout targets $X_1 = \$6,000$, $X = \$10,000$; split 80%; per-trade cap \$3,000.
The first payouts are capped at \$6,000, \$6,000 (7.2: two special first cycles).
Cycle success chances: $q_1 = 0.5878$; expected paid cycles 1.2290; expected withdrawn before the split \$8,556.
Identity (7.1): $-\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}] = 9,898 - 1,342 = \$8,556$ (gap +0.00).
Cash (chain): \$7,153 per funded account, of which the refund term \$308.
Engine, fresh paths: **\$7,519** per funded account; 17.9% of attempts reach a payout; median 32 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
0	0.4122	\$0
1	0.2423	\$5,324

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
2	0.1862	\$10,124
3	0.0859	\$18,124
4	0.0396	\$26,124

Chain values.

21.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt: chain $\mathbb{E}[V] = 0.2945 \times 7,153 - 524.00 = \$1,582$; engine \$1,667.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 20.03$ days per attempt, so 1.52 attempts a month per slot and \$796 of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (paths 141–144): a failed evaluation lasts 9.6 days on average; a passed one 18.0 days, then 26.1 days funded with 1.25 payouts; 34.3 trades per attempt.

Value per month (8.3): $30.44 \times 1,667 / 20.03 = \$2,534 \pm \$118$ (95%, cluster-robust) per account on sixteen fresh paths.

21.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Fee	Fee per \$100K	EV/month (95%)	EV/month per \$100K
100K	\$524	\$524	\$2,534 $\pm$ \$118	\$2,534
200K	\$974	\$487	\$4,035 $\pm$ \$221	\$2,018

The plan's setting scaled to each size (risk, targets and payout target in proportion; safety margins too), on the same sixteen fresh paths.

Per person: \$400,000 funded. **Copying:** no duplicated trades or trade ideas between GFT accounts. **The plan:** 1 $\times$ 200K, worth \$4,035 a month (1 account); at the firm's full allowance: 1 $\times$ 200K, worth \$4,035 a month (1 accounts).

21.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Value of an attempt	Days per attempt	Pass rate
$\times 1$	\$2,286 $\pm$ \$315	+\$1,453	19.4	28.3%
$\times 1.5$	\$2,094 $\pm$ \$209	+\$1,265	18.4	26.0%
$\times 2$	\$1,733 $\pm$ \$451	+\$1,002	17.6	24.7%

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost multiplied (spread, commission, slippage), 12,000 attempts on paths 141–144 with the same random numbers in every row. Higher cost lowers the value of an attempt and can also shorten it (more attempts fail sooner), so the value per month need not fall in proportion.

21.11 How the plan meets the rules

- one account; Nasdaq with a stop of at least 0.92 sd (funded 1:10) or USDJPY
- take-profit capped at the day's remaining \$3,000
- one open position at a time, risking at most 1.75% plus cost: Goat Guard's 2% cannot trigger without an intraday gap
- flat every day by 20:00 UTC (no entry from 19:00 UTC), so the account is flat through every daily reset and pays no overnight financing; flat at weekends
- concentration policy: no trade and no day makes more than 40% of the current phase or payout target, so every phase and every payout takes at least three winning days
- risk per trade sized so that the stop loss plus the round-trip cost fits the room under the floor and under the day's limit; when that room is below a tenth of the normal risk the account is closed (stopped and replaced), never traded in micro size
- minimum and qualifying days completed with trades held at least 2 minutes

Sources: <https://help.goatfundedtrader.com/en/articles/13575169-2-step-standard>; <https://help.goatfundedtrader.com/en/articles/11472001-funded-account-reward-guidelines>; <https://help.goatfundedtrader.com/en/articles/10742107-what-is-goat-guard>.

BrightFunded 2-Step Classic

Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100); plan setting: risk 1.75%, $k = 6$, $m = 1$, payout target 20% of the account; **\$2,766 a month per 100K** ($\pm$ \$254); in the plan: $1 \times 200K$, \$5,526 a month.

22.1 The rules

Rule	As published (read 4 October 2026)
Fee	€497 for 100K (\$559.42 at 1.1256); €997 for 200K (\$1,122.22); refund only with the paid refund add-on
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	10% / 5%
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	5% / 10% static
Minimum trading days	5 per phase
Funded split and payouts	80%; first payout about 30 days after funding, then every 14 days
Consistency rule	none
Leverage	1:100 forex; 1:20 indices; 1:40 gold
Per person	\$400,000 funded; evaluations unlimited
Copying	allowed between your own accounts at any firm
Trading days	a day counts only if at least one trade stays open 60 seconds or more

22.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	\$559.42
Phase 1	target \$10,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$5,000; at least 5 trading days; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$4,000)
Phase 2	target \$5,000; maximum loss \$10,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$5,000; at least 5 trading days; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$2,000)
Funded account	maximum loss \$10,000, static; daily loss \$5,000; split 80%; no fee refund; first payout 30 days after funding, then every 14 days; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the payout target
Trading hours	no entry from 19:00 UTC, flat at 20:00 UTC every day; flat at weekends
Margin	leverage 1:20 (evaluation), 1:20 (funded); margin at most 60% of the current balance at entry

22.3 The search

Searched: 504 grid settings (Nasdaq; 2,000 attempts each) and 16 refined settings (16,000 attempts each, paths 111–114). The eight best refined settings on Nasdaq:

Risk	k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
1.75%	6	1	20%	\$2,650 $\pm$ \$669	29.0%	17.7
1.50%	8	1	30%	\$2,628 $\pm$ \$1,169	29.6%	18.5
1.75%	10	1	20%	\$2,617 $\pm$ \$686	28.6%	17.6
1.75%	6	1.25	30%	\$2,610 $\pm$ \$643	30.4%	19.1
1.75%	12	1	20%	\$2,604 $\pm$ \$645	28.5%	17.5
1.75%	8	1	20%	\$2,592 $\pm$ \$596	28.6%	17.7
1.50%	6	1	30%	\$2,543 $\pm$ \$1,033	28.3%	18.3
1.75%	4	1.25	20%	\$2,537 $\pm$ \$766	30.3%	19.5

Refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below. Many settings sit within each other's intervals: the ranking near the top is not reliable, the region is.

k \ X	5%	8%	10%	15%	20%	30%
1.5	1.68	1.71	1.98	1.97	1.64	1.61
2	1.61	2.24	1.98	2.30	2.21	1.98
3	1.87	2.29	2.26	2.59	2.64	2.58
4	1.64	2.15	2.39	2.18	2.63	2.74
6	1.68	2.26	2.25	2.42	2.88	2.24
8	1.82	2.35	2.18	2.03	3.19	2.72
12	1.80	2.42	2.18	2.09	2.96	2.47

Grid value per month (\$ thousands; 2,000 attempts each on paths 101–104, so $\pm\$0.6$ –1.2K) at risk \$1,750 and stop $m = 1$, by k (rows) and payout target X (columns). Darker is more. The chosen setting is in the table above it, re-measured on fresh paths.

22.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	Risk / k / m / X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an attempt
Plan	1.75% / 6 / 1 / 20%	\$2,766 $\pm$ \$254	29.6%	\$7,432	18.0	+\$1,638

One 100K account; each row's own chosen setting on sixteen fresh paths (121–136), 24,000 attempts, cluster-robust 95% interval. Version 6 reported \$4,183 a month for this programme under its rules and engine.

22.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1,750$; stop $s = m\sigma = 1 \times 0.2737\% = 0.2737\%$ of the price; at 31,070.00 that is **85.0 points**.
Notional $N = l/s = \$639,413$; **\$20.58 per point**; lots = this divided by the contract's dollars per point per lot, rounded down.
Cost $c = \kappa N = \$40.92$, $\rho = c/l = 2.34\%$; the risk is sized so that $l(1 + \rho)$ fits the room (5.4).
First trade of phase 1: $w = \min(kl, A_1, \text{caps}) = \$4,000$; take-profit 196.4 points away; $p = l/(l + w + c) = 0.3022$.
Mean $-c$; variance $l(w + c) = 7,071,614$; duration about 2.31 h of open market (losers 1.87 h, winners 3.3 h), cut at 20:00 UTC.
A full funded win \$8,000: take-profit 391 points away, $p = 0.1787$.
Margin at the funded leverage 1:20: \$31,971 = 32.0% of the starting balance (limit 60%); smallest stop $m_{\min} = 0.533$.

22.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$10,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_1 = 0.4681$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 14.52$, $K = \$585$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$9,898$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.4708$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.5000$.
Rules in play: every win at most \$4,000; 5 trading days (filler trades in the engine).

Daily loss limit \$5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Phase 2: $A = \$5,000$, $B = \$10,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_2 = 0.6242$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 14.81$, $K = \$598$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$9,897$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.6268$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.6667$.
Rules in play: every win at most \$2,000; 5 trading days (filler trades in the engine).

Daily loss limit \$5,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Both phases: $P = 0.4681 \times 0.6242 = 0.2922$ (chain). Engine with every rule, fresh paths: **0.2957 $\pm$ 0.0058**.

22.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$10,000$; payout targets $X_1 = \$20,000$; split 80%; per-trade cap \$8,000.
Cycle success chances: $q_1 = 0.3116$; expected paid cycles 0.4526; expected withdrawn before the split \$9,052.
Identity (7.1): $-\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}] = 9,899 - 847 = \$9,052$ (gap +0.00).
Cash (chain): **\$7,242** per funded account.
Engine, fresh paths: **\$7,432** per funded account; 9.5% of attempts reach a payout; median 48 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
0	0.6884	\$0
1	0.2145	\$16,000
2	0.0668	\$32,000
3	0.0208	\$48,000
4	0.0065	\$64,000

Chain values.

22.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt: chain $\mathbb{E}[V] = 0.2922 \times 7,242 - 559.42 = \$1,556$; engine \$1,638.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 18.03$ days per attempt, so 1.69 attempts a month per slot and \$945 of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (paths 141–144): a failed evaluation lasts 9.3 days on average; a passed one 19.5 days, then 18.4 days funded with 0.49 payouts; 30.9 trades per attempt.

Value per month (8.3): $30.44 \times 1,638 / 18.03 = \$2,766 \pm \$254$ (95%, cluster-robust) per account on sixteen fresh paths.

22.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Fee	Fee per \$100K	EV/month (95%)	EV/month per \$100K
100K	\$559.42	\$559	\$2,766 $\pm$ \$254	\$2,766
200K	\$1,122.22	\$561	\$5,526 $\pm$ \$509	\$2,763

The plan's setting scaled to each size (risk, targets and payout target in proportion; safety margins too), on the same sixteen fresh paths.

Per person: \$400,000 funded; evaluations unlimited. **Copying:** allowed between your own accounts. **The plan:** 1 $\times$ 200K, worth \$5,526 a month (1 account); at the firm's full allowance: 4 $\times$ 100K, worth \$11,064 a month (4 accounts).

22.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Value of an attempt	Days per attempt	Pass rate
$\times 1$	\$2,524 $\pm$ \$249	+\$1,446	17.4	28.5%
$\times 1.5$	\$2,328 $\pm$ \$521	+\$1,291	16.9	26.5%
$\times 2$	\$2,006 $\pm$ \$723	+\$1,063	16.1	25.0%

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost multiplied (spread, commission, slippage), 12,000 attempts on paths 141–144 with the same random numbers in every row. Higher cost lowers the value of an attempt and can also shorten it (more attempts fail sooner), so the value per month need not fall in proportion.

22.11 How the plan meets the rules

- one account (recommended) or four, Nasdaq
- every counted day includes a trade held at least 2 minutes (the plan's trades last hours on average, but a stop can be hit in seconds, so the day's count never relies on it)
- flat every day by 20:00 UTC (no entry from 19:00 UTC), so the account is flat through every daily reset and pays no overnight financing; flat at weekends
- concentration policy: no trade and no day makes more than 40% of the current phase or payout target, so every phase and every payout takes at least three winning days
- risk per trade sized so that the stop loss plus the round-trip cost fits the room under the floor and under the day's limit; when that room is below a tenth of the normal risk the account is closed (stopped and replaced), never traded in micro size
- minimum and qualifying days completed with trades held at least 2 minutes

Sources: <https://help.brightfunded.com/en/articles/9241611-what-are-the-current-rules-for-the-evaluation-process>; [help.brightfunded.com \(refund add-on\)](https://help.brightfunded.com/en/articles/9241611-refund-add-on).

Blue Guardian 2-Step Standard

Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100); plan setting: risk 1.75%, $k = 4$, $m = 1.07$, payout target 15% of the account; **\$2,328 a month per 100K** ($\pm$ \$191); in the plan: $1 \times 200K$, \$4,648 a month.

23.1 The rules

Rule	As published (read 4 October 2026)
Fee	\$579 for 100K list (often half price with a code); \$1,162 for 200K; refunded after the fourth payout
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	8% / 4%
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	4% (of the higher of balance and equity at 5 pm New York) / 8% static
Minimum days	3 profitable days per phase
Funded split and payouts	85% every 14 days
Guardian Shield (funded)	all trades closed at a 2% open loss; first time the split falls to 50%, second time the account closes
Leverage	1:10 on indices
Per person	\$400,000; evaluations up to \$200,000 each
Copying	your own accounts only
Prohibited	margin use above 80% counts as gambling

23.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	\$579
Phase 1	target \$8,000; maximum loss \$8,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$4,000; 3 profitable days of at least \$500; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$3,200)
Phase 2	target \$4,000; maximum loss \$8,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$4,000; 3 profitable days of at least \$500; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$1,600)
Funded account	maximum loss \$8,000, static; daily loss \$4,000; split 85%; \$579.00 of the fee returned with payout number 4; first payout 14 days after funding, then every 14 days; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the payout target
Trading hours	no entry from 19:00 UTC, flat at 20:00 UTC every day; flat at weekends
Margin	leverage 1:10 (evaluation), 1:10 (funded); margin at most 60% of the current balance at entry

23.3 The search

Searched: 315 grid settings (Nasdaq; 2,000 attempts each) and 17 refined settings (16,000 attempts each, paths 111–114). The eight best refined settings on Nasdaq:

Risk	k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
1.75%	4	1.07	15%	\$2,381 $\pm$ \$240	29.2%	15.8
1.50%	6	1	15%	\$2,325 $\pm$ \$672	28.9%	16.1
1.50%	4	1	15%	\$2,320 $\pm$ \$581	29.0%	16.1
1.75%	4	1.07	10%	\$2,275 $\pm$ \$321	29.7%	17.0
1.50%	8	1.25	15%	\$2,250 $\pm$ \$529	29.2%	17.4
1.50%	4	1	10%	\$2,248 $\pm$ \$384	28.8%	17.1
1.75%	12	1.25	15%	\$2,236 $\pm$ \$385	29.8%	16.4
1.50%	6	1.25	15%	\$2,230 $\pm$ \$538	29.8%	17.5

Refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below. Many settings sit within each other's intervals: the ranking near the top is not reliable, the region is.

k \ X	4%	6%	8%	10%	15%
1.5	1.76	1.91	1.90	2.03	2.11
2	1.71	1.46	1.75	1.62	1.92
3	1.46	2.02	1.81	2.24	2.12
4	1.76	2.03	2.23	2.48	2.46
6	1.66	1.84	2.24	2.27	2.32
8	1.42	1.81	2.14	1.82	2.29
12	1.56	1.96	2.15	1.83	2.32

Grid value per month (\$ thousands; 2,000 attempts each on paths 101–104, so $\pm\$0.6$ – $1.2K$) at risk \$1,750 and stop $m = 1.07$, by k (rows) and payout target X (columns). Darker is more. The chosen setting is in the table above it, re-measured on fresh paths.

23.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	Risk / k / m / X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an attempt
Plan	1.75% / 4 / 1.07 / 15%	\$2,328 $\pm$ \$191	28.9%	\$6,177	15.7	+\$1,203

One 100K account; each row's own chosen setting on sixteen fresh paths (121–136), 24,000 attempts, cluster-robust 95% interval. Version 6 reported \$2,810 a month for this programme under its rules and engine.

23.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1,750$; stop $s = m\sigma = 1.07 \times 0.2737\% = 0.2928\%$ of the price; at 31,070.00 that is **91.0 points**.
Notional $N = l/s = \$597,582$; **\$19.23 per point**; lots = this divided by the contract's dollars per point per lot, rounded down.
Cost $c = \kappa N = \$38.25$, $\rho = c/l = 2.19\%$; the risk is sized so that $l(1 + \rho)$ fits the room (5.4).
First trade of phase 1: $w = \min(kl, A_1, \text{caps}) = \$2,667$; take-profit 140.6 points away; $p = l/(l + w + c) = 0.3928$.
Mean $-c$; variance $l(w + c) = 4,733,596$; duration about 1.77 h of open market (losers 1.56 h, winners 2.1 h), cut at 20:00 UTC.
A full funded win \$6,000: take-profit 314 points away, $p = 0.2247$.
Margin at the funded leverage 1:10: $\$59,758 = 59.8\%$ of the starting balance (limit 60%); smallest stop $m_{\min} = 1.066$.

23.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$8,000$, $B = \$8,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_1 = 0.4690$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 11.82$, $K = \$441$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$7,896$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.4725$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.5000$.
Rules in play: every win at most \$3,200; 3 profitable days needed: the engine aims at a daily target (6.4), which the chain leaves out.

Daily loss limit \$4,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Phase 2: $A = \$4,000$, $B = \$8,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_2 = 0.6264$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 11.88$, $K = \$445$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$7,896$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.6296$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.6667$.
Rules in play: every win at most \$1,600; 3 profitable days needed: the engine aims at a daily target (6.4), which the chain leaves out.

Daily loss limit \$4,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Both phases: $P = 0.4690 \times 0.6264 = 0.2938$ (chain). Engine with every rule, fresh paths: **0.2885 $\pm$ 0.0057**.

23.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$8,000$; payout targets $X_1 = \$15,000$; split 85%; per-trade cap \$6,000.
Cycle success chances: $q_1 = 0.3257$; expected paid cycles 0.4829; expected withdrawn before the split \$7,244.
Identity (7.1): $-\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}] = 7,893 - 650 = \$7,244$ (gap +0.00).
Cash (chain): \$6,164 per funded account, of which the refund term \$7.
Engine, fresh paths: **\$6,177** per funded account; 10.6% of attempts reach a payout; median 31 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
0	0.6743	\$0
1	0.2196	\$12,750
2	0.0715	\$25,500
3	0.0233	\$38,250
4	0.0076	\$51,579

Chain values.

23.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt: chain $\mathbb{E}[V] = 0.2938 \times 6,164 - 579.00 = \$1,232$; engine \$1,203.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 15.73$ days per attempt, so 1.93 attempts a month per slot and \$1,120 of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (paths 141–144): a failed evaluation lasts 9.1 days on average; a passed one 17.6 days, then 13.7 days funded with 0.57 payouts; 28.1 trades per attempt.

Value per month (8.3): $30.44 \times 1,203 / 15.73 = \$2,328 \pm \$191$ (95%, cluster-robust) per account on sixteen fresh paths.

23.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Fee	Fee per \$100K	EV/month (95%)	EV/month per \$100K
100K	\$579	\$579	\$2,328 $\pm$ \$191	\$2,328
200K	\$1,162	\$581	\$4,648 $\pm$ \$382	\$2,324

The plan's setting scaled to each size (risk, targets and payout target in proportion; safety margins too), on the same sixteen fresh paths.

Per person: \$400,000; evaluations up to \$200,000 each. **Copying:** your own accounts only. **The plan:** $1 \times 200K$, worth \$4,648 a month (1 account); at the firm's full allowance: $4 \times 100K$, worth \$9,312 a month (4 accounts).

23.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Value of an attempt	Days per attempt	Pass rate
$\times 1$	\$2,271 $\pm$ \$349	+\$1,148	15.4	28.1%
$\times 1.5$	\$1,741 $\pm$ \$462	+\$850	14.9	26.5%
$\times 2$	\$1,716 $\pm$ \$201	+\$824	14.6	25.4%

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost multiplied (spread, commission, slippage), 12,000 attempts on paths 141–144 with the same random numbers in every row. Higher cost lowers the value of an attempt and can also shorten it (more attempts fail sooner), so the value per month need not fall in proportion.

23.11 How the plan meets the rules

- one account, Nasdaq with the stop widened to fit 1:10
- risk at most 1.75%: a stop-out stays below the 2% shield unless the price gaps
- flat every day by 20:00 UTC (no entry from 19:00 UTC), so the account is flat through every daily reset and pays no overnight financing; flat at weekends
- concentration policy: no trade and no day makes more than 40% of the current phase or payout target, so every phase and every payout takes at least three winning days
- risk per trade sized so that the stop loss plus the round-trip cost fits the room under the floor and under the day's limit; when that room is below a tenth of the normal risk the account is closed (stopped and replaced), never traded in micro size
- minimum and qualifying days completed with trades held at least 2 minutes

Sources: help.blueguardian.com (2 Step Standard rules); propfirmbridge.com; trustpilot.com (rating withheld).

Maven 2-Step

Nasdaq 100 CFD (US100); plan setting: risk 1.75%, $k = 4$, $m = 1.25$, payout target 10% of the account; **\$1,627 a month per 100K** ($\pm$ \$88); in the plan: 1 $\times$ 100K, \$1,627 a month.

24.1 The rules

Rule	As published (read 4 October 2026)
Fee	\$440 for 100K (largest 2-Step size); refunded with the third payout
Phase 1 / phase 2 target	8% / 5%
Maximum daily loss / maximum loss	4% (from the higher of balance or equity) / 8% static
Profitable days	3 per phase, each at least +0.5%
Funded split and payouts	80%; a withdrawal every 10 business days; at most \$10,000 per rolling 30 days per trader across all accounts (the excess is voided)
Leverage	1:75 forex; 1:20 indices and commodities
Per person	\$200,000
Consistency (funded)	the largest winning trade at most 20% of the profit withdrawn
Risk interview	after \$5,000 of total profit; a payout is not processed without it
News	no opening or closing within 2 minutes of a red-folder release, in evaluations and funded accounts
Gambling	large bets at a reward:risk of 1:1.25 or lower ('random odds')
Refund	with the third withdrawal

24.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	\$440
Phase 1	target \$8,000; maximum loss \$8,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$4,000; 3 profitable days of at least \$500; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$3,200); every trade at least 1:1.5
Phase 2	target \$5,000; maximum loss \$8,000 below the start, static; daily loss \$4,000; 3 profitable days of at least \$500; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$2,000); every trade at least 1:1.5
Funded account	maximum loss \$8,000, static; daily loss \$4,000; split 80%; \$440.00 of the fee returned with payout number 3; first payout 14 days after funding, then every 14 days; largest winning trade at most 20% of a payout's profit; every trade at least 1:1.5; at most \$10,000 paid per rolling 30 days (the plan waits for room); plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the payout target
Trading hours	no entry from 19:00 UTC, flat at 20:00 UTC every day; flat at weekends
Margin	leverage 1:20 (evaluation), 1:20 (funded); margin at most 60% of the current balance at entry

24.3 The search

Searched: 420 grid settings (Nasdaq; 2,000 attempts each) and 16 refined settings (16,000 attempts each, paths 111–114). The eight best refined settings on Nasdaq:

Risk	k	m	X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Days per attempt
1.75%	4	1.25	10%	\$1,649 $\pm$ \$231	27.2%	18.8
1.50%	6	1	10%	\$1,647 $\pm$ \$262	27.1%	17.8
1.50%	4	1.25	10%	\$1,643 $\pm$ \$434	27.3%	19.3
1.50%	7	1.25	10%	\$1,630 $\pm$ \$272	27.5%	19.3
1.75%	6	1.25	12%	\$1,626 $\pm$ \$267	27.1%	17.6
1.50%	12	1.25	10%	\$1,624 $\pm$ \$276	26.8%	19.2
1.50%	8	1.25	10%	\$1,622 $\pm$ \$306	27.0%	19.3
1.50%	4	1	10%	\$1,617 $\pm$ \$208	26.8%	17.6

Refine-path values, chosen as the best of many, so biased upward; the plan reports the fresh-path run below. Many settings sit within each other's intervals: the ranking near the top is not reliable, the region is.

k \ X	4%	6%	8%	10%	12.5%
1.5	1.22	1.43	1.46	1.40	1.68
2	1.13	1.47	1.22	1.62	1.64
3	0.86	1.33	1.40	1.70	1.51

k \ X	4%	6%	8%	10%	12.5%
4	0.97	1.39	1.52	1.91	1.54
6	1.14	1.59	1.65	1.49	1.80
8	1.13	1.43	1.57	1.47	1.78
12	1.07	1.40	1.73	1.53	1.67

Grid value per month (\$ thousands; 2,000 attempts each on paths 101–104, so $\pm \$0.6$ – $1.2K$) at risk \$1,750 and stop $m = 1.25$, by k (rows) and payout target X (columns). Darker is more. The chosen setting is in the table above it, re-measured on fresh paths.

24.4 The chosen setting, on fresh paths

Setting	Risk / k / m / X	EV/month (95%)	Pass rate	Cash per funded account	Days per attempt	Value of an attempt
Plan	1.75% / 4 / 1.25 / 10%	\$1,627 $\pm$ \$88	27.1%	\$5,302	18.7	+\$997

One 100K account; each row's own chosen setting on sixteen fresh paths (121–136), 24,000 attempts, cluster-robust 95% interval. Version 6 reported \$2,341 a month for this programme under its rules and engine.

24.5 One trade

Risk $l = \$1,750$; stop $s = m\sigma = 1.25 \times 0.2737\% = 0.3421\%$ of the price; at 31,070.00 that is **106.3 points**.
Notional $N = l/s = \$511,530$; **\$16.46 per point**; lots = this divided by the contract's dollars per point per lot, rounded down.
Cost $c = \kappa N = \$32.74$, $\rho = c/l = 1.87\%$; the risk is sized so that $l(1 + \rho)$ fits the room (5.4).
First trade of phase 1: $w = \min(kl, A_1, \text{caps}) = \$2,667$; take-profit 164.0 points away; $p = l/(l + w + c) = 0.3933$.
Mean $-c$; variance $l(w + c) = 4,723,958$; duration about 2.41 h of open market (losers 2.13 h, winners 2.8 h), cut at 20:00 UTC.
A full funded win \$2,000; take-profit 123 points away, $p = 0.4626$.
Margin at the funded leverage 1:20: $\$25,577 = 25.6\%$ of the starting balance (limit 60%); smallest stop $m_{\min} = 0.533$.

24.6 The evaluation

Phase 1: $A = \$8,000$, $B = \$8,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_1 = 0.4729$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 12.17$, $K = \$373$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$7,887$; identity gap -0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.4767$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.5000$.
Rules in play: every win at most \$3,200; 3 profitable days needed: the engine aims at a daily target (6.4), which the chain leaves out.

Daily loss limit \$4,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Phase 2: $A = \$5,000$, $B = \$8,000$

Chain (5.5): $P_2 = 0.5829$, $\mathbb{E}[\text{trades}] = 15.83$, $K = \$374$, $\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \mid \text{fail}] = -\$7,883$; identity gap +0.0000; textbook $(B - K)/(A + B) = 0.5867$; zero cost, exact landing $B/(A + B) = 0.6154$.
Rules in play: every win at most \$2,000; 3 profitable days needed: the engine aims at a daily target (6.4), which the chain leaves out.

Daily loss limit \$4,000: each trade's risk plus cost fits today's room less \$200; after 2 full losses in one day the remaining room is smaller than a full trade, so the plan trades smaller or waits until tomorrow.

Both phases: $P = 0.4729 \times 0.5829 = 0.2757$ (chain). Engine with every rule, fresh paths: **0.2710 $\pm$ 0.0056**.

24.7 The funded account

Allowance $D = \$8,000$; payout targets $X_1 = \$10,000$; split 80%; per-trade cap \$2,000.
Cycle success chances: $q_1 = 0.4001$; expected paid cycles 0.6669; expected withdrawn before the split \$6,669.
Identity (7.1): $-\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{cost}] = 7,878 - 1,209 = \$6,669$ (gap +0.00).
Cash (chain): \$5,363 per funded account, of which the refund term \$28.
Engine, fresh paths: **\$5,302** per funded account; 10.7% of attempts reach a payout; median 34 days from purchase to the first payout of those that do.

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
0	0.5999	\$0
1	0.2400	\$8,000
2	0.0960	\$16,000

Paid cycles	Probability	Cash (split + refund)
3	0.0384	\$24,440
4	0.0154	\$32,440

Chain values.

24.8 Value per attempt and per month

Value of an attempt: chain $\mathbb{E}[V] = 0.2757 \times 5,363 - 440.00 = \$1,039$; engine \$997.

Time (engine): $\mathbb{E}[T] = 18.65$ days per attempt, so 1.63 attempts a month per slot and \$718 of fees a month before refunds.

Where the time goes (paths 141–144): a failed evaluation lasts 9.9 days on average; a passed one 19.1 days, then 23.3 days funded with 0.66 payouts; 40.2 trades per attempt.

Value per month (8.3): $30.44 \times 997 / 18.65 = \$1,627 \pm \$88$ (95%, cluster-robust) per account on sixteen fresh paths.

24.9 Account size and number of accounts

Size	Fee	Fee per \$100K	EV/month (95%)	EV/month per \$100K
100K	\$440	\$440	\$1,627 $\pm$ \$88	\$1,627

The plan's setting scaled to each size (risk, targets and payout target in proportion; safety margins too), on the same sixteen fresh paths.

Per person: \$200,000; payouts at most \$10,000 per 30 days per person. **Copying:** –. **The plan:** $1 \times 100K$, worth \$1,627 a month (1 account); at the firm's full allowance: $1 \times 100K$, worth \$1,627 a month (1 accounts).

24.10 If costs are higher

Trading cost	EV/month (95%)	Value of an attempt	Days per attempt	Pass rate
$\times 1$	\$1,632 $\pm$ \$450	+\$1,000	18.7	27.0%
$\times 1.5$	\$1,470 $\pm$ \$382	+\$867	17.9	25.8%
$\times 2$	\$1,188 $\pm$ \$265	+\$667	17.1	24.4%

The plan's setting with every round-trip cost multiplied (spread, commission, slippage), 12,000 attempts on paths 141–144 with the same random numbers in every row. Higher cost lowers the value of an attempt and can also shorten it (more attempts fail sooner), so the value per month need not fall in proportion.

24.11 How the plan meets the rules

- one 100K account, Nasdaq
- every trade at a reward:risk of at least 1:1.5
- each winning trade capped at 20% of the cycle target
- a payout request only when the 30-day window has room for all of it
- the risk interview booked as soon as it is offered
- flat every day by 20:00 UTC (no entry from 19:00 UTC), so the account is flat through every daily reset and pays no overnight financing; flat at weekends
- concentration policy: no trade and no day makes more than 40% of the current phase or payout target, so every phase and every payout takes at least three winning days
- risk per trade sized so that the stop loss plus the round-trip cost fits the room under the floor and under the day's limit; when that room is below a tenth of the normal risk the account is closed (stopped and replaced), never traded in micro size
- minimum and qualifying days completed with trades held at least 2 minutes

Sources: <https://maventrading.com/faqs> (read 4 Oct 2026).

Topstep 50K Trading Combine (futures, optional)

Micro Nasdaq futures in whole contracts, shared direction with the Nasdaq CFD accounts. Futures firms set no percentage risk rule, so the risk per trade is searched as well.

25.1 The rules

Rule	As published (read 4 October 2026)
Fee	\$49 a month (Standard path); a reset after a breach \$49; \$149 activation per Express Funded Account
Target / maximum loss	\$3,000 / \$2,000 trailing at the end of each day, locking at the start balance
Consistency (Combine)	best day at most 55% of the profit target (the model uses 50%)
Funded payouts	after 5 winning days of \$150+; at most 50% of the balance and \$2,000 a request; 90%; every payout after the first needs net profit since the last; after the first payout the maximum loss level moves to the starting balance
Per person	up to 5 Express Funded Accounts at once
Trading hours	flat by the daily close (the plan: by 20:00 UTC)

25.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	\$49 a month (renewed while the evaluation lasts); activation \$149 on passing
Evaluation	target \$3,000; maximum loss \$2,000 below the start, trailing the best end-of-day balance; no daily loss limit; at least 2 trading days; best day at most 50% of the profit; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$1,200)
Funded account	maximum loss \$2,000, trailing the best end-of-day balance; no daily loss limit; split 90%; no fee refund; a payout needs 5 qualifying days of at least \$150; payout caps \$2,000, \$2,000, \$2,000, \$2,000, \$2,000, \$2,000; a payout at most 50% of the balance; each later payout needs net profit since the last
Trading hours	no entry from 19:00 UTC, flat at 20:00 UTC every day; flat at weekends

25.3 The search

k	m	Risk	Refined EV/month	Pass rate	Days
1.5	1	\$1,100	\$679 ± \$399	20.3%	3.1
2	1	\$800	\$670 ± \$163	22.2%	3.7
3	1	\$800	\$623 ± \$419	21.7%	4.0
5	1	\$600	\$571 ± \$467	22.1%	5.4
6	1	\$800	\$517 ± \$328	21.8%	6.4
1.5	1	\$950	\$509 ± \$137	20.9%	3.1
1.5	0.75	\$800	\$484 ± \$172	20.9%	3.0
4	0.75	\$800	\$408 ± \$292	20.9%	5.6

The ten best grid settings (4,000 attempts each), re-run for 16,000 attempts on paths 111–114.

25.4 The chosen setting

Plan: $k = 1.5$, $m = 1$, risk \$1,100: stop 85.0 points; one MNQ contract loses \$170 at the stop, so 6 contracts (rounded down), a risk of \$1,020.

Fresh paths: **\$602 ± \$147** a month per account (pass rate 20.9%, 3.1 days per attempt).

Why so little: the funded account's maximum loss trails the balance, payouts are capped per request and (Apex) in number, the evaluation fee recurs monthly (Topstep) or is worth paying only at a deep discount (Apex), and whole contracts make the smallest trade large next to a \$2,000 allowance. The static withdrawal identity does not apply to these accounts (7.1); the values are the engine's.

25.5 How many

5 Express Funded Accounts at once: 5 accounts, worth \$3,009 a month together. This layer is optional and is not in the recommended plan's headline figure.

25.6 How the plan meets the rules

- micro Nasdaq futures, shared direction with the Nasdaq CFD accounts
- risk and k searched (no percentage rule applies)
- whole micro contracts, risk rounded down

- no trade and no day above 40% of the evaluation target

Sources: <https://help.topstep.com/en/articles/8284233-topstep-payout-policy>; [help.topstep.com \(pricing\)](https://help.topstep.com/en/articles/8284233-topstep-payout-policy).

Apex 4.0 50K EOD (futures, optional)

Micro Nasdaq futures in whole contracts, shared direction with the Nasdaq CFD accounts. Futures firms set no percentage risk rule, so the risk per trade is searched as well.

26.1 The rules

Rule	As published (read 4 October 2026)
Fee	\$550 list; public 80–90% codes most of 2026 (about \$55); \$99 activation when passed
Target / maximum loss	\$3,000 / \$2,000 trailing end of day; \$1,000 daily loss limit; evaluations expire after 30 days
Funded payouts	100% split; 5 qualifying days per request; no day may make 50% or more of the request's profit; \$500 minimum; caps \$1,500, \$1,500, \$2,000, \$2,500, \$2,500, \$3,000; at most 6 payouts, then the account closes; safety net of drawdown + \$100
Per person	up to 20 funded accounts; copying between your own accounts allowed
Trading hours	flat by 4:59 pm ET every session

26.2 What the engine simulates

Part	What the engine simulates
Fee per attempt	\$55; activation \$99 on passing
Evaluation	target \$3,000; maximum loss \$2,000 below the start, trailing the best end-of-day balance; daily loss \$1,000; at least 1 trading days; plan: no trade and no day above 40% of the target (\$1,200); expires after 30 days
Funded account	maximum loss \$2,000, trailing the best end-of-day balance; daily loss \$1,000; split 100%; no fee refund; a payout needs 5 qualifying days of at least \$250; minimum payout \$500; payout caps \$1,500, \$1,500, \$2,000, \$2,500, \$2,500, \$3,000; best day at most 50% of a payout's profit; at most 6 payouts; buffer \$2,100 kept in the account
Trading hours	no entry from 19:00 UTC, flat at 20:00 UTC every day; flat at weekends

26.3 The search

k	m	Risk	Refined EV/month	Pass rate	Days
1.5	1	\$800	\$322 ± \$162	24.7%	8.6
1.5	1	\$600	\$315 ± \$134	24.8%	8.8
1.5	0.75	\$950	\$298 ± \$135	24.2%	7.6
1.5	1	\$1,100	\$298 ± \$48	25.1%	8.7
2	1	\$950	\$297 ± \$51	25.1%	9.0
1.5	1	\$950	\$295 ± \$110	25.8%	8.6
1.5	0.75	\$1,100	\$281 ± \$131	24.0%	7.5
2	1	\$600	\$260 ± \$62	25.5%	8.7

The ten best grid settings (4,000 attempts each), re-run for 16,000 attempts on paths 111–114.

26.4 The chosen setting

Plan: $k = 1.5$, $m = 1$, risk \$800: stop 85.0 points; one MNQ contract loses \$170 at the stop, so 4 contracts (rounded down), a risk of \$680.

Fresh paths: **\$279 ± \$55** a month per account (pass rate 24.4%, 8.5 days per attempt).

Why so little: the funded account's maximum loss trails the balance, payouts are capped per request and (Apex) in number, the evaluation fee recurs monthly (Topstep) or is worth paying only at a deep discount (Apex), and whole contracts make the smallest trade large next to a \$2,000 allowance. The static withdrawal identity does not apply to these accounts (7.1); the values are the engine's.

26.5 How many

20 funded accounts: 20 accounts, worth \$5,573 a month together. This layer is optional and is not in the recommended plan's headline figure.

26.6 How the plan meets the rules

- micro Nasdaq futures, shared direction
- only at 80–90% off: at the list price the value is negative
- whole micro contracts, risk rounded down
- no trade and no day above 40% of the evaluation target

Sources: <https://apextraderfunding.com/help-center/eod-trailing-drawdown-accounts/eod-payouts/>; apextraderfunding.com help centre.

One person, many accounts

Part II valued one account at a time, as a long-run rate. This part runs them together for one person: how much each firm allows, how to fill it, what a first year looks like, what the long run is, how much cash it takes, and what happens if costs are higher, markets move together, news must be avoided, or payouts are refused.

The maximum allocation per person

27.1 Firm by firm

Firm (tier)	Per-person limit	Copying between accounts	Market	Recommended	EV/month	Full allowance	EV/month
FTMO (A)	\$400,000 per trader across all accounts, evaluations included	your own accounts, within the cap	Nasdaq	4×100K	\$11,722	4×100K	\$11,722
FundingPips (A)	\$400,000 across evaluation, funded and Prime accounts	your own FundingPips accounts; no copier services	USDJPY	4×100K	\$11,315	4×100K	\$11,315
The5ers (A)	one 100K (or 50K) High Stakes account, plus 1 × 25K, 3 × 10K, 3 × 5K, 3 × 2.5K	your own accounts	Nasdaq	1×100K	\$3,592	1×100K, 1×25K, 3×10K, 3×5K, 3×2.5K	\$5,869
FXIFY (A)	one active account of each size	between your own FXIFY accounts	Nasdaq	1×100K, 1×50K, 1×25K, 1×10K, 1×5K	\$5,181	1×100K, 1×50K, 1×25K, 1×10K, 1×5K	\$5,181
FundedNext (A)	\$300,000 funded; evaluations unlimited	between your own challenge accounts, never into a funded account	EURUSD	1×200K	\$3,265	1×200K	\$3,265
Fintokei (B)	€500,000 of accounts	your own trades across your own accounts	Nasdaq	5×100K	\$16,043	5×100K	\$16,043
Hola Prime (B)	\$500,000	only between your own Hola Prime accounts (funded: one master and one copier); never from other firms	gold	2×100K	\$5,627	2×100K	\$5,627
Alpha Capital (D)	\$400,000 per household, \$300,000 per strategy	from your own external accounts with proof	Nasdaq	1×200K	\$6,392	1×200K, 1×100K	\$9,591
FunderPro (D)	\$200,000	no replicating trades across FunderPro accounts	Nasdaq	1×200K	\$6,961	1×200K	\$6,961
GFT (D)	\$400,000 funded	no duplicated trades or trade ideas between GFT accounts	Nasdaq	1×200K	\$4,035	1×200K	\$4,035
BrightFunded (D)	\$400,000 funded; evaluations unlimited	allowed between your own accounts	Nasdaq	1×200K	\$5,526	4×100K	\$11,064
Blue Guardian (D)	\$400,000; evaluations up to \$200,000 each	your own accounts only	Nasdaq	1×200K	\$4,648	4×100K	\$9,312
Maven (D)	\$200,000; payouts at most \$10,000 per 30 days per person	–	Nasdaq	1×100K	\$1,627	1×100K	\$1,627
Topstep (A)	5 Express Funded Accounts at once	your own accounts	MNQ	–	–	5×50K	\$3,009
Apex (B)	20 funded accounts	your own accounts	MNQ	–	–	20×50K	\$5,573
Total, CFD firms					\$85,934		\$101,611

EV per month: each account's long-run renewal–reward value from its programme chapter (fresh paths), summed. A firm whose programme is not worth it under the plan's policies has no accounts. The full-allowance column includes The5ers' optional small accounts. Futures (Topstep, Apex) are an optional layer, not in either total.

27.2 Four 100K accounts or two 200K?

Scale every dollar amount of a programme by λ (account, targets, limits, risk, payout target, safety margins). The engine's rules then scale exactly: every trade's win, loss and cost scale by λ , the pass probabilities and the time are unchanged, and the funded account's trading cash scales by λ . The fee need not scale, and the refund follows the fee actually paid. Writing $G(S)$ for the funded cash *excluding* the refund, $R(S)$ for the refund and q_R for the chance of reaching the payout that carries it (given a pass):

SCALING AN ACCOUNT (RULES THAT SCALE)

$$\mathbb{E}[V(\lambda S)] = P[\lambda G(S) + q_R R(\lambda S)] - F(\lambda S), \quad \mathbb{E}[T](\lambda S) = \mathbb{E}[T](S).$$

With $R = F$, one account of size λS is worth more than λ accounts of size S by $[\lambda F(S) - F(\lambda S)](1 - P q_R)$ per attempt: the fee saving, less the part of it that would have come back as a refund. (Version 6's formula scaled the refund with the account; it does not.) The formula does not apply where a rule is a fixed dollar amount: GFT's \$3,000 day cap and \$10,000 payout cap, Maven's \$10,000 rolling cap, The5ers' \$150 minimum payout, and whole futures contracts. Chapter 11 checks the scaling path by path on the same seeds.

Programme	100K fee	200K fee	200K – 2 × 100K fee	2 × 100K: EV/month	1 × 200K: EV/month	Difference
FTMO 2-Step	\$607.82	\$1,215.65	\$0.00	\$5,861	\$5,861	+\$0
FundedNext Stellar	\$549.99	\$1,049.99	−\$49.99	\$3,179	\$3,265	+\$86
Fintokei ProTrader	\$549.00	\$1,249.00	\$151.00	\$6,417	\$6,163	−\$254
Alpha Capital Pro 10%	\$497.00	\$997.00	\$3.00	\$6,398	\$6,392	−\$6
FunderPro Classic	\$539.00	\$989.00	−\$89.00	\$6,812	\$6,961	+\$149
GFT Standard	\$524.00	\$974.00	−\$74.00	\$5,068	\$4,035	−\$1,033

Programme	100K fee	200K fee	200K – 2 × 100K fee	2 × 100K: EV/month	1 × 200K: EV/month	Difference
BrightFunded Classic	\$559.42	\$1,122.22	\$3.38	\$5,532	\$5,526	–\$6
Blue Guardian 2-Step	\$579.00	\$1,162.00	\$4.00	\$4,656	\$4,648	–\$8

Same setting scaled, same sixteen paths and random numbers. Where every rule scales with the account, the only differences are the fee and the refund that follows it (11.1 checks the scaling path by path); GFT's flat \$3,000 day cap and \$10,000 payout cap do not scale.

The answer, firm by firm. With the corrected formula of 27.2, 200K beats 2 × 100K exactly when $F(2S) < 2F(S)$, by $(2F(S) - F(2S))(1 - Pq_R)$ per attempt, unless a rule fails to scale. Where only one account is allowed (FunderPro, GFT, FundedNext on its own market), the larger size is used if it is worth more than one smaller account. GFT is the case where the formula fails: its \$3,000 day cap and \$10,000 payout cap bind harder at 200K, so one 200K account is worth less than two 100K accounts would be, but GFT allows only one, and one 200K account is still worth more than one 100K account.

FTMO, 4 × 100K or 2 × 200K. Same fee per dollar, same rules: the paired difference on the same 1,200 seeds is $+\$3 \pm \6 a month for the whole portfolio, i.e. no difference. Two accounts make half as many payout requests; four give a smoother cash path. The plan uses four 100K accounts for the headline.

Running every account at once

28.1 What adds up and what does not

By linearity (2.1), the expected cash of a set of slots over a horizon is the sum of their expected cash over that horizon, under the policy actually run, however correlated the accounts are. Correlation changes the spread: in a bad week every Nasdaq account loses together, fees fall due together, and a finite budget can run short together.

28.2 One direction per market

No two of your accounts ever hold opposite positions on one market at the same time. When a new trade opens and another of your accounts already holds that market, the new trade takes the same direction; when none does, the plan's rule decides (the sign of the last five hourly closes). The rule has no edge (Chapter 11); its job is to keep every account on one side.

28.3 The lockstep simulation

The portfolio results come from an engine that runs every account of one person on shared price paths and one calendar (lockstep.py), processing trades in the order of their entry time so the shared-direction rule is exact, applying every firm's rules (with the plan's policies) to its own accounts, and writing every fee, credit, phase result and payout to a dated ledger. The settings were frozen before any portfolio run, and each simulated life runs on its own new paths (seeds 100,000 and up), used by nothing else; version 6 re-used the paths that had chosen its settings. Lives are therefore independent and their average is an unbiased estimate with an ordinary interval. In 8,400 simulated years, no two accounts held opposite positions.

28.4 The portfolios: the first year

Portfolio	Accounts	Firms	First year, EV/month (95%)	Months 2–12	Sum of long-run rates	First-year cash p5	median	p95	Lowest cumulative cash: median
Tier A only	15	5	\$27,659 ± \$1,033	\$31,427	\$35,075	−\$5,139	\$307,690	\$707,521	−\$30,127
Tiers A and B	22	7	\$45,827 ± \$1,620	\$51,762	\$56,744	\$47,391	\$505,742	\$1,186,636	−\$42,982
Recommended (A + B + one account per tier-D firm)	28	13	\$70,128 ± \$2,427	\$79,208	\$85,934	\$92,691	\$777,284	\$1,781,617	−\$56,885
Recommended, FTMO as 2 × 200K	26	13	\$70,131 ± \$2,428	\$79,211	\$85,934	\$92,691	\$777,284	\$1,781,617	−\$56,885
All firms at full allowance	35	13	\$81,260 ± \$2,875	\$91,867	\$99,334	\$112,929	\$903,956	\$2,064,941	−\$67,740
Full allowance + The5ers small accounts	45	13	\$83,183 ± \$2,939	\$94,064	\$101,611	\$109,848	\$929,571	\$2,140,249	−\$69,939
Recommended + futures layer	53	15	\$76,950 ± \$2,760	\$87,049	\$94,515	\$55,776	\$853,180	\$1,970,672	−\$69,159

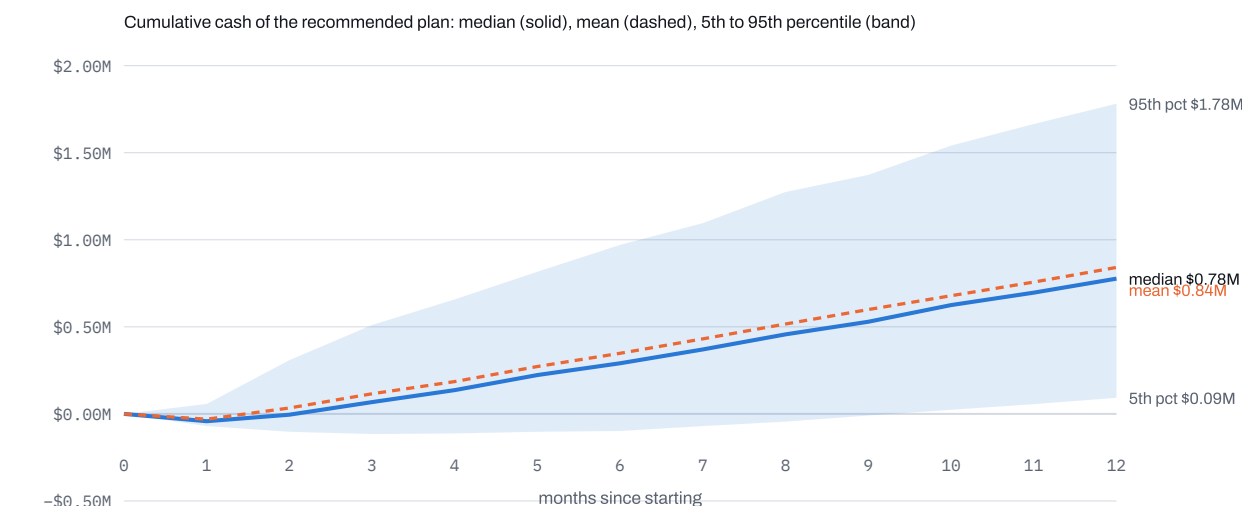
1,200 simulated first years per portfolio, each on its own new price paths (seeds from 100,000; the same seeds for every portfolio, so differences are paired). First year: total cash over 12 months ÷ 12, after every fee modelled. Sum of long-run rates: the accounts' renewal–reward values from Part II, a different quantity (8.5). Lowest cumulative cash: the deepest point of fees paid minus cash received.

Three quantities. The recommended portfolio's first year averages \$70,128 a month (±\$2,427); months 2–12 average \$79,208; the sum of its accounts' long-run rates is \$85,934. They answer different questions (8.5), and Section 28.6 measures the long-run rate of the portfolio itself. 97.8% of simulated first years ended ahead; the 5th percentile of first-year cash is \$92,691.

No account ever opposed another. In 8,400 simulated years the engine recorded 0 moments when two accounts held opposite positions on one market. The recommended plan places about 71 orders a trading day across all accounts.

Paired differences (same seeds, 95%): All firms at full allowance minus Recommended (A + B + one account per tier-D firm): +\$11,131 ± \$529; Full allowance + The5ers small accounts minus All firms at full allowance: +\$1,924 ± \$473; Recommended + futures layer minus Recommended (A + B + one account per tier-D firm): +\$6,822 ± \$845; Tiers A and B minus Tier A only: +\$18,168 ± \$965; Recommended (A + B + one account per tier-D firm) minus Tiers A and B: +\$24,301 ± \$1,538.

28.5 Month by month



1,200 simulated first years of the recommended plan (28 accounts), each on its own paths. Cash = payouts received minus fees paid.

Month	Mean cash	p10	median	p90	Cumulative mean	Ahead
1	-\$29,749	-\$62,798	-\$41,479	\$7,997	-\$29,749	12%
2	\$64,389	-\$37,169	\$27,446	\$221,290	\$34,640	48%
3	\$81,149	-\$35,265	\$44,750	\$252,049	\$115,788	67%
4	\$70,609	-\$34,607	\$38,043	\$222,078	\$186,397	77%
5	\$85,569	-\$33,381	\$38,356	\$286,793	\$271,966	83%
6	\$76,835	-\$35,034	\$33,703	\$255,568	\$348,801	86%
7	\$81,802	-\$32,148	\$39,290	\$257,502	\$430,603	90%
8	\$86,282	-\$32,101	\$45,197	\$268,139	\$516,884	93%
9	\$82,413	-\$31,492	\$40,415	\$262,671	\$599,297	94%
10	\$79,772	-\$34,508	\$37,166	\$269,753	\$679,070	96%
11	\$78,252	-\$32,644	\$36,446	\$255,926	\$757,321	97%
12	\$84,217	-\$32,849	\$41,991	\$259,639	\$841,538	98%

28.6 The long run, and what is left at month 12

Period (36-month lives)	Average cash per month (95%)
months 1–12	\$70,292 ± \$2,818
months 13–24	\$84,651 ± \$2,932
months 25–36	\$79,473 ± \$2,924
month 12 alone	\$83,196 ± \$8,567
months 11 and 13	\$84,808 and \$83,643

800 simulated 36-month lives of the recommended plan, each on its own new paths (seeds 300,000 and up).

Long-run rate. Months 13–36 average \$82,062 ± \$2,038 a month: the portfolio's own long-run rate. The sum of its accounts' long-run rates from Part II is \$85,934 ± \$2,581; the portfolio is \$3,872 lower, 2.3 standard errors, and the paired check below finds no effect of running the accounts together, so the plan quotes the portfolio's own figure. The first year is lower (\$70,292) because it carries the start-up: fees at once, payouts later. **Value of the accounts open at month 12:** the cash those accounts (evaluations in progress and funded accounts) go on to pay after month 12 averages \$169,478 (± \$12,688); it belongs to the first year's purchases but arrives later. Version 6's month-12 dip is checked by the month table above: in 36-month lives month 12 is \$83,196 against \$84,808 and \$83,643 on either side, so a dip there would be a horizon effect of the 12-month runs, not a property of month 12.

Does the portfolio add up? On the first 200 of these lives, every firm's accounts were also run alone, on the same paths and calendar. Full portfolio minus the sum of the firms alone: -\$1,507 ± \$2,854 a month over months 13–36 and +\$1,373 ± \$3,632 in the first year (paired, 95%). Running the accounts together (one calendar, one direction per market) changes nothing measurable, as linearity says it should for an unchanged policy. On those same paths the firms alone average \$80,340 a month, below the sum of their long-run rates in Part II (\$85,934): every account on the Nasdaq trades the same path, largely in the same direction, so their sampling errors move together and a sample of a few hundred lives can sit some thousands of dollars from the expectation. That is why the interval of the portfolio's rate is much wider than a sum of independent per-account intervals would suggest.

28.7 Finite cash, higher costs, correlation, news and behaviour

A finite budget. The first-year figures assume every slot is refilled the moment its attempt ends, which needs cash for fees before payouts arrive. Version 6 quoted the median of the deepest cash shortfall as if it kept every slot filled; half of all years need more. Here the plan is run with a fixed starting budget instead: a purchase waits until the cash is there.

Starting cash	First year, EV/month	of unlimited	Evaluations bought in the year	Ahead at 12 months	First-year cash p5	Lowest cash left (mean)
\$5,000	\$9,033 ± \$4,171	14%	79	14%	−\$4,985	\$14
\$10,000	\$19,888 ± \$5,593	31%	182	31%	−\$9,991	\$9
\$20,000	\$28,754 ± \$5,945	44%	280	47%	−\$19,997	\$48
\$30,000	\$36,411 ± \$6,407	56%	354	57%	−\$29,990	\$278
\$50,000	\$50,158 ± \$6,727	77%	458	72%	−\$49,989	\$3,247
\$75,000	\$55,472 ± \$6,728	85%	516	81%	−\$74,988	\$13,867
\$100,000	\$59,471 ± \$6,538	91%	555	86%	−\$99,985	\$30,180
unlimited	\$65,125 ± \$5,894	100%	614	96%	\$50,865	–

The recommended plan with a finite budget: a purchase waits (checked daily) until the cash for it is there; payouts become spendable when they arrive. Slots are filled in order of value per fee dollar. 200 lives per row, same seeds in every row.

Other scenarios, each a full portfolio run on the baseline's seeds:

Scenario (recommended plan)	First year, EV/month	Paired difference to baseline	First-year cash p5	Lowest cumulative cash p5
Baseline (same 200 seeds)	\$65,125 ± \$5,894		\$50,865	−\$173,175
All trading costs × 1.5	\$53,418 ± \$5,520	−\$11,707 ± \$2,725	\$31,421	−\$187,204
All trading costs × 2	\$43,877 ± \$5,284	−\$21,247 ± \$3,234	−\$102,434	−\$214,416
Markets correlated 0.3 (one joint path)	\$72,340 ± \$6,483	+\$7,216 ± \$9,322	\$125,898	−\$150,463
News proxy: flat 12:00–14:00 UTC every weekday	\$61,637 ± \$5,492	−\$3,488 ± \$4,368	\$118,656	−\$159,232
FundedNext 1% risk (behavioural remedy)	\$63,629 ± \$5,905	−\$1,496 ± \$512	\$39,216	−\$171,304
FundedNext 7-day pause (behavioural remedy)	\$64,142 ± \$5,900	−\$982 ± \$481	\$72,651	−\$171,276

Full portfolio runs, 200 lives each on the baseline's seeds (paired). The correlated run uses joint paths, so its pairing is by seed only.

If payouts can be refused

Every firm keeps the right to refuse a payout it judges to break its rules. Nobody publishes how often it happens. This chapter turns that uncertainty into scenarios; it does not cover payouts lost because a firm judges the strategy itself to break a behavioural rule (Chapter 31.2), which would not be random.

29.1 A model

Suppose each payout request at a firm is refused with probability ρ , independently, and a refusal ends your use of that firm. The number of paid requests before the first refusal is geometric, with mean $(1 - \rho)/\rho$. If the firm's accounts make requests at rate r a month, each of gross size a , the expected cash actually paid over H months is

PAID CASH UNDER REFUSALS

$$a r (1 - \rho) \frac{1 - e^{-\rho r H}}{\rho r} = a r H \times (1 - \rho) \frac{1 - e^{-\rho r H}}{\rho r H},$$

the all-paid cash arH times the average survival fraction *and* the factor $(1 - \rho)$: the refused request itself is not paid (version 6's formula left that factor out; its simulation did not). Fees paid while the firm is still used count against this. In the recommended plan the FTMO accounts together make about 1.09 requests a month: at $\rho = 2\%$, FTMO is expected to last $1/(0.02 \times 1.09) = 46$ months.

29.2 Tiers and scenarios

Tier	Evidence (4 October 2026)	Firms	Refusal chance per request: tiered harsh	
A	PropFirmMap A/A+, TrustPilot profile active	FTMO, FundingPips, The5ers, FXIFY, FundedNext, Topstep	2%	5%
B	PropFirmMap B+, TrustPilot active	Fintokei, Hola Prime, Apex	5%	10%
D	TrustPilot rating withheld for fake reviews; PropFirmMap D	Alpha Capital, FunderPro, GFT, BrightFunded, Blue Guardian, Maven	15%	30%

Chosen scenarios, not measurements: public ratings do not calibrate refusal rates.

29.3 What it does to each portfolio

Portfolio	All payouts honoured	Tiered	kept	Harsh	kept
Tier A only	\$27,659	\$23,145	84%	\$18,081	65%
Tiers A and B	\$45,827	\$34,083	74%	\$25,119	55%
Recommended (A + B + one account per tier-D firm)	\$70,128	\$47,758	68%	\$32,157	46%
Recommended, FTMO as 2 × 200K	\$70,131	\$48,533	69%	\$33,803	48%
All firms at full allowance	\$81,260	\$46,947	58%	\$29,385	36%
Full allowance + The5ers small accounts	\$83,183	\$47,119	57%	\$28,695	34%
Recommended + futures layer	\$76,950	\$47,495	62%	\$30,671	40%

First-year average per month. Each payout request is refused with its firm's probability; the refused payout is not paid, and the person stops using that firm (no more fees or payouts there). Ten draws of refusals per simulated year.

Firm	Tier	Payout requests a month	Average request	Net cash a month	Expected months until a refusal (tiered)
FTMO	A	1.09	\$13,155	\$9,336	46
FundingPips	A	1.12	\$10,747	\$9,125	45
The5ers	A	0.27	\$14,368	\$2,957	184
FXIFY	A	0.47	\$11,610	\$3,672	106
FundedNext	A	0.18	\$25,623	\$2,671	271
Fintokei	B	1.20	\$15,707	\$13,386	17
Hola Prime	B	0.43	\$16,149	\$4,565	47
Alpha Capital	D	0.30	\$24,755	\$5,412	22
FunderPro	D	0.31	\$24,760	\$5,633	22
GFT	D	0.56	\$9,134	\$3,629	12
BrightFunded	D	0.22	\$29,005	\$4,294	30
Blue Guardian	D	0.31	\$21,113	\$4,100	22
Maven	D	0.26	\$8,042	\$1,349	25

Recommended plan, first-year averages from the portfolio simulation.

The recommended plan's accounts make about 6.7 payout requests a month. In the tiered scenario it keeps 68% of its first-year value, in the harsh one 46%. Under the 40% policy requests are smaller and more frequent than in version 6, so each firm is exposed to more requests; the scenarios price that.

PART IV

Running it

The settings of every account in one place, the routine that runs them, and everything that could make the numbers wrong.

The routine

30.1 Every account's settings

Programme	Accounts	Market	Risk per trade	Stop	Size	k	Payout target	EV/month
FTMO 2-Step	4 × 100K	Nasdaq	\$1,500	0.75 σ = 63.8 points	\$23.52/pt	8	\$20,000	\$11,722
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (95%)	4 × 100K	USDJPY	\$1,750	1 σ = 18.8 pips	14.67 lots	8	\$15,000	\$11,315
The5ers HS Classic	1 × 100K	Nasdaq	\$1,750	1 σ = 85.0 points	\$20.58/pt	7	\$30,000	\$3,592
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	1 × 100K	Nasdaq	\$1,750	1.07 σ = 91.0 points	\$19.23/pt	6	\$30,000	\$2,877
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	1 × 50K	Nasdaq	\$875	1.07 σ = 91.0 points	\$9.62/pt	6	\$15,000	\$1,310
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	1 × 25K	Nasdaq	\$438	1.07 σ = 91.0 points	\$4.81/pt	6	\$7,500	\$643
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	1 × 10K	Nasdaq	\$175	1.07 σ = 91.0 points	\$1.92/pt	6	\$3,000	\$246
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	1 × 5K	Nasdaq	\$88	1.07 σ = 91.0 points	\$0.96/pt	6	\$1,500	\$105
FundedNext Stellar	1 × 200K	EURUSD	\$3,500	1 σ = 9.6 pips	36.47 lots	6	\$40,000	\$3,265
Fintokei ProTrader	5 × 100K	Nasdaq	\$1,750	1 σ = 85.0 points	\$20.58/pt	10	\$30,000	\$16,043
Hola Prime 2-Step Prime	2 × 100K	gold	\$1,750	1.03 σ = 12.2 dollars	1.43 lots	10	\$20,000	\$5,627
Alpha Capital Pro 10%	1 × 200K	Nasdaq	\$3,500	1 σ = 85.0 points	\$41.16/pt	6	\$40,000	\$6,392
FunderPro Classic	1 × 200K	Nasdaq	\$3,500	1.07 σ = 91.0 points	\$38.47/pt	8	\$40,000	\$6,961
GFT Standard	1 × 200K	Nasdaq	\$3,500	1.07 σ = 91.0 points	\$38.47/pt	3	\$20,000	\$4,035
BrightFunded Classic	1 × 200K	Nasdaq	\$3,500	1 σ = 85.0 points	\$41.16/pt	6	\$40,000	\$5,526
Blue Guardian 2-Step	1 × 200K	Nasdaq	\$3,500	1.07 σ = 91.0 points	\$38.47/pt	4	\$30,000	\$4,648
Maven 2-Step	1 × 100K	Nasdaq	\$1,750	1.25 σ = 106.3 points	\$16.46/pt	4	\$10,000	\$1,627

Stops in points (Nasdaq), pips (USDJPY, EURUSD) or dollars (gold) at the prices of 2 October 2026; recompute $m\sigma \times \text{price}$ weekly and re-measure σ monthly. The take-profit is the smallest of k times the risk, the distance to the current target, 40% of the current target less today's profit, and any firm cap, plus the cost (4.1).

30.2 Placing a trade, step by step

1. **Is a trade allowed now?** Weekdays, inside the market's entry hours and not from 19:00 UTC onward; not before 00:05 UTC (after the midnight resets); no restricted news window for this firm, stage and market coming up before the trade could reasonably end; at least 10 minutes since this account's last losing trade in the same direction.
2. **Direction.** If any of your accounts holds this market, the same direction. Otherwise the plan's rule: long if the last hourly close is above the close five hours earlier, short if below. The rule has no edge (Chapter 11); its job is that no two of your accounts are ever opposite.
3. **Room.** Floor room = $(\text{balance} - \text{floor} - \$100 \text{ per } \$100\text{K}) / (1 + \rho)$; day room = $(\text{daily limit} - \text{today's loss} - \$200 \text{ per } \$100\text{K}) / (1 + \rho)$; margin room = $0.6 \lambda m\sigma \times \text{balance}$. If the floor room is under a tenth of the normal risk, **stop using this account** and buy its replacement. If only the day room is, wait until tomorrow.
4. **Risk.** l = the smallest of the plan's risk and the three rooms. **Stop:** $m\sigma \times \text{price}$; size = $l / (\text{stop in points} \times \text{dollars per point per lot})$, rounded down (whole contracts on futures).
5. **Take-profit.** w = the smallest of $k l$, the distance to the current target, 40% of the current target less today's profit, and any firm cap (FXIFY 25% of the payout per day, Maven 20% per trade, GFT's \$3,000 a day less today's profit). At Maven, if $w < 1.5 l$, lower l to $w / 1.5$. Distance = stop distance $\times (w + c) / l$.
6. **Place one bracket order;** never move it. **At 20:00 UTC close everything still open.**
7. **Log it:** time, account, market, direction, size, stop, target, fill, and the closing reason. The log is the evidence for any review.

30.3 Phases, payouts and refills

- When a phase target (plus \$20 per \$100K) is reached: stop. Where the firm counts trading days, place one minimal trade, held at least 2 minutes, on each remaining weekday; where it counts profitable days, the daily target of 6.4 has met it.
- When a funded account reaches its payout target: stop, request the payout on the first allowed day (at Maven, only when the 30-day window has room for all of it, and only with the largest winning trade at most 20% of the payout), withdraw everything above the start, and start the next cycle.
- When a payout date arrives before the target is reached, request whatever profit the account holds, if the firm's minimum and its consistency rules allow it (FXIFY: no day above 25% of it; Hola Prime: 40%; Maven: no trade above 20%), and start the next cycle; if a rule does not allow it, keep trading toward a target large enough for the rule to hold.
- When an account fails or is closed under the floor rule: buy the next evaluation of the same programme (at FundedNext, after a pause if its gambling indicators are a concern: 28.7). Never trade an account to lose it, never let one lapse deliberately while it can still be traded under the rules.
- Credits (The5ers) are spent on the next evaluation at that firm.

30.4 Cash needed

Fees are paid before payouts arrive. In the simulation the running total of the recommended plan falls to $-\$56,885$ at its lowest in a typical first year, $-\$156,132$ in the worst 5% and $-\$224,474$ in the worst 1%. These are not amounts that keep every slot filled in every year: Section 28.7 runs the plan with fixed budgets, purchases waiting for cash, and shows what each budget gives.

30.5 Workload

About 71 bracket orders a trading day across 28 accounts, a daily close-out at 20:00 UTC, payout requests and evaluation purchases.

What could make the numbers wrong

31.1 Higher trading costs

Programme	Market	EV/month: cost × 1	× 1.5	× 2	Days per attempt × 1	× 2
FTMO 2-Step	Nasdaq	\$2,630	\$2,410	\$2,075	15.1	14.2
FundingPips 2-Step Flex (95%)	USDJPY	\$2,671	\$2,108	\$1,605	22.4	19.2
The5ers HS Classic	Nasdaq	\$3,360	\$3,122	\$2,662	16.3	15.6
FXIFY Classic (100%, 30 days)	Nasdaq	\$2,548	\$2,162	\$2,127	22.3	21.0
FundedNext Stellar	EURUSD	\$1,630	\$1,012	\$405	16.2	13.4
Fintokei ProTrader	Nasdaq	\$3,132	\$2,756	\$2,356	16.1	15.2
Hola Prime 2-Step Prime	gold	\$2,786	\$2,252	\$1,622	16.0	14.2
Alpha Capital Pro 10%	Nasdaq	\$3,032	\$2,704	\$2,314	15.4	14.5
FunderPro Classic	Nasdaq	\$2,967	\$2,611	\$2,424	15.7	14.8
GFT Standard	Nasdaq	\$2,286	\$2,094	\$1,733	19.4	17.6
BrightFunded Classic	Nasdaq	\$2,524	\$2,328	\$2,006	17.4	16.1
Blue Guardian 2-Step	Nasdaq	\$2,271	\$1,741	\$1,716	15.4	14.6
Maven 2-Step	Nasdaq	\$1,632	\$1,470	\$1,188	18.7	17.1

One 100K account at the plan's setting, paths 141–144, 12,000 attempts per cell, the same random numbers in each row. Higher costs lower the value of an attempt and also shorten attempts (more fail, sooner), which is why a value per month can fall less than proportionally.

For the whole recommended portfolio, full portfolio runs (not ratios) give \$53,418 a month at 1.5 times the costs and \$43,877 at twice, against \$70,128 (Section 28.7). **Measure your real costs in the first week** and redo the settings if they differ from 3.1 by more than a quarter.

31.2 Behavioural rules the model cannot state

These rules are applied at the firm's discretion. The figures in this document assume the plan's trading is not judged to break them; if it is, the affected payouts are lost, which is not the same as the random refusals of Chapter 29:

- **FTMO**: gambling, "all-in" trading, account rolling; no gap trading within 2 hours of a close.
- **Fintokei**: reaching a target in one or a few identical trades; token trades. The plan's three-winning-day minimum and minimal filler trades held 2 minutes are its answer.
- **The5ers**: one-trade target attainment (permanent ban). No trade makes more than 40% of a target.
- **FundedNext**: one-sided betting (remedy: a 1% risk limit), account rolling, several breached accounts in a short span (remedies: 40% consistency on on-demand rewards or a lower split). Section 28.7 measures the remedies.
- **Hola Prime**: profitability "materially dependent on concentrated outcomes". **Alpha**: "all or nothing", risk or loss of 2% or more, trades under 2 minutes on average. **FXIFY**: gambling. **Blue Guardian**: margin above 80%. **Maven**: large bets at 1:1.25 or worse.

31.3 Payouts refused, accounts closed

Chapter 29: \$47,758 a month if payouts are refused at 2/5/15% per request by tier, \$32,157 at 5/10/30%.

31.4 Spreads, gaps and news

The engine's cost is an average. Spreads widen at the daily break (now outside the plan's hours), at the open and around news. The news proxy of Section 28.7 bounds the effect of staying flat around releases.

31.5 Rules change

Every rule in Part II was read on 4 October 2026, from the pages listed in Appendix E. Leverage, consistency rules, payout schedules, prices and per-person limits change often. Recheck before buying and rerun the programme's optimisation (optimize_v7.py) when a rule that enters the model changes.

31.6 The model itself

- **Zero skill**. If entries are systematically late or fills worse, the edge is negative; the cost stress is the guide.
- **Markets move together**. The baseline gives gold, euro and yen independent paths; Section 28.7 measures a correlation of 0.3. Real correlations change and rise in crises.
- **Taxes and payment costs** are not modelled.

31.7 What is not allowed, and is not in the plan

No hedging across accounts or firms; no accounts in anyone else's name; no copy-trading services or other people's signals; no trading of restricted news windows; no tick scalping, latency or gap arbitrage; no grid or martingale sizing; no deliberately failed accounts. Do not share or sell the plan: several firms treat traders who run the same marketed strategy as a group.

Corrections: the version 6 review, point by point

A detailed review of version 6 (4 October 2026) raised 35 points. Every point was checked against the code, the data and the firms' pages; all 35 are accepted (one in part), and fixing them uncovered the further errors in the second table. Because several fixes change the strategy itself (the concentration policy, the daily flat, the floor rule), version 7's figures are a new measurement, not version 6's minus a list of corrections.

#	Review point	What was wrong in version 6	What version 7 does
1	The written near-floor policy strands accounts AGREED	The document's rule ($\text{risk} = \min(L, \text{room} - \$100)$), wait for tomorrow when $\text{risk} < \$150$) can leave an account a few dollars above its static floor with no trade allowed, for ever. The version 6 engine did not follow the written rule either: when the room fell below \$1 it traded a micro position of the whole remaining room.	One terminal rule, the same in the text, the engine (<code>acct_mc.py run_stage / run_funded</code>) and the chain (<code>analytic_v7.chain</code>): $\text{risk } l(x) = \min(L, (x + B - \text{buffer}) / (1 + \rho))$; when that room is below $L_{\min} = \max(0.1 L, \text{one futures contract})$ the attempt or funded account ends there and is recorded as a failure. The plan stops trading the account and buys the replacement; nothing in any firm's rules requires trading an account to its floor.
2	The pass-probability identity assumes exact terminal values AGREED	$P = (B - E[\text{cost}]) / (A + B)$ was presented as exact for the plan; it needs every failure to end exactly at $-B$.	The chain now computes $E[X_{\text{end}} \text{failure}]$ and checks the general accounting equation $PA + (1 - P) E[X_{\text{end}} \text{fail}] = -E[\text{total cost}]$ numerically (\$0.0000 largest gap over every chosen programme). Under the version 7 rule every failure ends between $-B + \text{buffer}$ and $-B + \text{buffer} + L_{\min}(1 + \rho)$, so the textbook form differs from the exact P by 0.25% to 0.37% (percentage points).
3	The opening zero-cost example over-counts the refund AGREED	$-632 + (1/3)(8,000 + 632) = \$2,245$ counts the refund on every pass; it comes only with a first payout.	With the first payout reached with chance $q = D / (D + X)$: $E[V] = -F + P(\alpha D + q R) = \$2,087.33$ at $X = \$30,000$ (the version 6 setting) and \$2,140.00 at $X = \$10,000$; \$2,245 is the limit $X \rightarrow 0$. Chapter 1 now uses this form.
4	Bold-play tables violate the reward:risk cap AGREED	Several tables used $w = A - x$ when $k l(x) < A - x$, so the displayed probabilities belonged to trades the plan never places; 'k ~ 27 reaches every target' ignored the shrinking risk near the floor; changing k does not change the order size.	Every table is generated by <code>analytic_v7.bold_path</code> from the same state-wise transition as the solver, $w(x) = \min(k l(x), A - x, \text{cap})$; rows where a win does not end the phase are marked and no product formula is printed for them; the chain value is the one quoted. Under the 40% concentration policy no single win can end a phase, so the one-trade 'bold' tables are gone.
5	Entry-time stops do not protect equity-based daily resets AGREED	With daily limits measured on midnight equity (Fintokei) or the higher of balance and equity (FundingPips, GFT, The5ers, FXIFY, Blue Guardian, Maven), an open profit at the reset raises the day's floor; a smooth reversal can breach it with no gap.	Plan policy: no entry from 19:00 UTC, every position closed at the 20:00 UTC open, so the account is flat at every firm's reset (all between 20:00 and 00:00 UTC). Balance then equals equity at the reset and the engine's limit is the firm's. Fintokei's limit is also modelled as 5% of start-of-day equity (<code>dill_rel</code>).
6	The risk cap left out costs AGREED	A stopped trade loses $l + c$; subtracting \$100/\$200 reserves does not guarantee $l + c$ fits the room.	$l = \min(L, \text{room} / (1 + \rho))$ for both the floor and the daily limit (ρ = round-trip cost per dollar of risk, scaled with every cost stress). With the daily flat there is no financing to add.
7	Bracket formulas do not include random financing AGREED	$p = l / (l + w + c)$, mean $-c$ and variance $l(w + c)$ hold for a fixed known cost and binary outcomes only.	The formulas are stated for that model only. Under the daily flat no position is held through a rollover, so financing is zero; the flat-time close makes some outcomes intermediate, which the engine simulates and the chain does not (the difference is reported).
8	The withdrawal identity was overstated AGREED	$E[W] = D - E[\text{costs}]$ was asserted for every policy and repeated for the trailing futures accounts.	General form $E[W] = -E[X_{\text{end}}] - E[\text{total cost}]$ (cycle-by-cycle optional stopping, each cycle a bounded stopped sum); $D - E[\text{cost}]$ only when the account always ends at $-D$. The chain reports $E[X_{\text{end}}]$ and the identity gap (\$0.0000). The futures text no longer claims the identity.
9	GFT's expected-cycle formula AGREED	$q / (1 - q)$ was printed for two special first cycles.	$E[\text{paid cycles}] = q_a + q_a^2 / (1 - q_b)$, with gross withdrawals $X_a(q_a + q_a^2) + X_b q_a^2 q_b / (1 - q_b)$.
10	Account-size scaling scaled the refund AGREED, EXTENDED	$\lambda P E[C](S) - F(\lambda S)$ scales a refund that follows the fee actually paid.	$E[V(\lambda S)] = P[\lambda G(S) + q_R R(\lambda S)] - F(\lambda S)$. Version 7 also makes every dollar tolerance in the engine scale with the account, and checks pathwise on the same seeds that a 200K account is exactly twice a 100K account where the rules scale (FTMO and Fintokei, whose every rule is a share of the account: the largest difference between a 200K attempt and twice the matching 100K attempt is \$0.00 over 3,000 pairs, i.e. the scaling is exact path by path. The5ers is not exact, because its \$150 minimum payout is a flat amount: \$1,981 per 100K at 200K against \$2,009 at 100K. GFT is not exact, because its \$3,000 day cap and \$10,000 payout cap are flat amounts: \$1,512 per 100K at 200K against \$1,802 at 100K.). Where a rule is a flat dollar amount (GFT's caps, The5ers' \$150 minimum payout) the scaling is not exact, and the size chapters use each size's own simulation. Version 6's FTMO 200K was not exactly 2x because one \$0.50 tolerance did not scale.
11	Larger-target-first does not reduce total trades AGREED	The claim inferred lower total cost from the lower chance of entering phase 2.	Removed. The reviewer's count (11.11 trades vs 10.37 reversed) is reproduced in the text.
12	A larger funded target does not reduce lifetime trades AGREED	Section 9.3 contradicted section 7.3.	Section 9.3's claim is removed; the measured effect of X is reported.
13	Arithmetic vs geometric Brownian motion AGREED	Duration formulas derived for driftless arithmetic motion were called exact for the geometric synthetic paths.	Labelled as approximations ($\log$ barriers $-\log(1 - s)$, $\log(1 + u)$; $\log$ drift $-\sigma^2/2$); the price level, not the log price, is the martingale. Durations in the document are measured by the engine.
14	'One trade' examples ignored caps AGREED	Examples showed wins beyond daily targets, best-day caps and the GFT day cap.	Examples are generated from the engine's sizing function with every cap (concentration policy, profitable-day daily targets, best-day and day caps).

#	Review point	What was wrong in version 6	What version 7 does
15	Minimum and profitable days do not change only time AGREED	'Time, not value' was asserted; filler trades can take an account back under its target.	Joint success condition: the target plus a \$20 per \$100K buffer is reached and the required days are complete (filler days counted as weekdays, 5 in 7); profitable-day rules use daily targets. The claim is removed.
16	FundingPips 2 Step Flex inputs AGREED	85% split and 10%/6% targets.	Official page: 10%/8%; 80% with 1 minimum trading day, or 95% with 3 profitable days ($\geq 0.5\%$) in each phase and cycle; 4% daily; 12% maximum; no fee refund on Flex. Both options are optimised.
17	GFT rule discrepancies AGREED, EXTENDED	8% phase 1, no valid-day rule, 1:15 index leverage; Goat Guard missing.	10%/5%; days count only with $\geq 0.5\%$ profit (3 per phase, 4 per funded cycle); funded indices 1:10, so the stop is at least 0.92 sd on the Nasdaq (USDJPY at 1:50 is searched too); daily limit flat at the reset. The \$3,000 day cap is flat at every size (version 6 doubled it at 200K - a further error). Goat Guard triggers at a 2% combined floating loss; one open position never risks more than 1.75% plus cost, so it cannot trigger without an intraday gap.
18	FundedNext payout interval AGREED	Every 21 days.	First reward 21 days after funding, then every 14.
19	Maven's rolling payout cap AGREED, EXTENDED	The cap was not enforced; a 50% best-day rule was assumed.	\$10,000 per rolling 30 days across all Maven accounts; the plan never requests a payout the cap would cut (it waits until the window has room; excess is voided otherwise). Official FAQ also: largest winning trade $\leq 20\%$ of the profit withdrawn (now modelled), no trade at 1:1.25 or lower (the plan's Maven trades are $\geq 1:1.5$), risk interview after \$5,000 (operational step), no opening or closing within 2 minutes of red-folder news.
20	Anti-gambling rules AGREED	Compliance was inferred from 1.5% risk and a stop.	Concentration policy: no trade and no day may make more than 40% of the current target, so every phase and payout takes at least three winning days. Behavioural rules are listed per firm as applicability conditions (chapter 'What could make the numbers wrong', section 2), not as refusal probabilities; the document no longer claims every rule is met, only every rule that the engine models.
21	News procedure AGREED	Only US releases; only funded accounts flat before news.	Firm-by-firm news rules (Maven applies to evaluations too); a bounding sensitivity in which every account is flat 12:00-14:00 UTC every weekday (also 08:00-09:00 UTC on EURUSD): \$61,637 a month against \$65,125 on the same seeds.
22	Futures rule implementation AGREED	Only two Apex caps printed; 'at most 50%'; no expiry; fractional contracts; Topstep transitions not stated.	All six Apex caps (in the engine since version 5, now printed); strict $< 50\%$; 30-day evaluation expiry; whole micro contracts (risk rounded down); Topstep's floor moves to the start balance after the first payout and every later payout needs net profit since the last one.
23	BrightFunded's 60-second rule AGREED	Misdescribed; a mean duration is not a minimum.	A day counts if at least one trade stays open 60 s; filler trades are held at least 2 minutes (also Alpha's average-duration rule).
24	The5ers credit treated as cash AGREED	All of the fee was modelled as cash with the first payout.	10% and 20% of the fee are non-cash hub credit at the phase passes, spent on the slot's next The5ers purchase (ledger rows credit_earned / credit_used; cash fees paid net of credit); 70% is paid with the first payout.
25	Margin check at the current balance AGREED	The 60% margin limit was checked on the starting balance only.	At every entry: margin = (l/s)/leverage $\leq 60\%$ of the current balance (and FunderPro's funded limit, 20% of the starting balance per asset class - a rule version 6 broke at its chosen stop of 0.35 sd).
26	Portfolio run reused optimisation paths AGREED	The headline used paths 21-28, which selected the settings.	Settings frozen first; every portfolio life runs on its own new paths (seeds from 100,000 up), used by no earlier stage.
27	First-year average vs long-run rate AGREED	'Linearity says they must agree.'	Separate estimands: first-year cash (months 1-12), the long-run rate from 36-month lives (months 13-36), and the value of the accounts still open at month 12. Linearity is stated for a common horizon only, and checked directly: on the same paths, the full portfolio minus the sum of its firms run alone is zero within its interval.
28	Dependence-aware confidence intervals AGREED	Attempts on four reused histories treated as independent.	Final programme values: 16 independent paths x 1,500 attempts, cluster-robust ratio CI with the path as the cluster and Student's t with 15 degrees of freedom (reported next to the attempt-level CI). The engine-against-chain checks use 24 independent two-year paths with cluster-robust intervals. Portfolio lives are independent (one path per life). All are Monte Carlo intervals under the model, not predictions.
29	Tie resolution inside a bar AGREED IN PART	Exactness was implied for the bridge construction.	Each sub-step's extremes are drawn from the Brownian bridge given that sub-step's end points, and sub-steps are replayed in time order, so the order of the two barriers is exact up to ties inside one sub-step, which fall back to the fair chance. Convergence test at 12 and 60 sub-steps: win rates at 12 sub-steps 49.85% / 24.85% / 14.18% and at 60 sub-steps 49.83% / 25.77% / 14.28% against theory 50.00% / 25.00% / 14.29%.
30	Independence of phases and markets AGREED	Zero edge was said to imply independent phases and independent markets.	Wording fixed (P(pass both) = P1P(2 1)); a sensitivity with all four markets on one joint path at correlation 0.3: \$72,340 a month against \$65,125.
31	Refusal fraction AGREED	The printed survival fraction omitted the refused payment.	$a r (1 - \rho) (1 - e^{\{-\rho r H\}} / (\rho r))$; the simulation already drops the refused payout and every later one.
32	Median cash does not keep every slot filled AGREED	The median shortfall was read as sufficient funding.	Finite-budget runs: purchases wait until the cash is there; results for several budgets: \$10,000: \$19,888; \$20,000: \$28,754; \$50,000: \$50,158; \$100,000: \$59,471.
33	'The engine is always conservative' AGREED	Contradicted by the table; agreement was called proof.	Wording: agreement is supporting evidence.
34	Narrower claims AGREED	'Every programme', 'optimal', the month-12 dip, a non-paired comparison, ratio-based cost stress, FunderPro's non-monotone cost result, reproducibility.	Title and claims limited to the programmes and grids searched; month-12 checked with 36-month lives (month 12 averages \$83,196 against \$84,808 (month 11) and \$83,643 (month 13)); paired differences on common seeds; cost stress run as full portfolios; component decomposition (value and time) for every cost row; the code, seeds and rule snapshots are in the repository.
35	Smaller corrections AGREED	EUR conversions, percentage points, FunderPro/FundedNext daily-room prose, GFT/The5ers qualifying days, FundedNext heatmap label, '1:30', clipped K(x) equation, 'full allowance' labels, 'after every fee', sources.	FTMO EUR 540 = \$607.82 and EUR 1,080 = \$1,215.65, BrightFunded EUR 497 = \$559.42 and EUR 997 = \$1,122.22 (at 1.1256); percentage points written as such; prose regenerated from the sizing function; headline 'after the fees modelled'; exact source URLs (Appendix E).

Further errors found while fixing the review's points

#	Further error	What it was, and the fix
N1	FunderPro's chosen stop broke its funded margin rule	FunderPro funded accounts may use at most 20% of the starting balance as margin per asset class. Version 6's FunderPro setting (stop 0.35 sd, 1:30 on the Nasdaq) needs about 52% - version 6's largest tier-D value (\$7,734 a month) rested on it. Version 7: stop ≥ 0.92 sd on the Nasdaq, or USDJPY.
N2	GFT's day cap doubled at 200K	The \$3,000 daily profit cap is flat at every account size; version 5/6 scaled it to \$6,000 at 200K.
N3	A funded branch overwrote the target and best-day caps	In the funded profitable-days branch the engine reset the win to k l, discarding the cycle-target and best-day caps computed just above (FundingPips 95%, Hola Prime, GFT). Fixed: the branch can only lower the win.
N4	Filler days counted weekend days	Missing minimum days were padded one calendar day each; weekends cannot be trading days (now 7/5 per day).
N5	A win that closes the gap could fail the target test	A win sized to reach the target exactly lands a rounding error (about 1e-12) short; the exact comparison then placed an extra trade risking \$1,500 to make \$1. One cent of tolerance now; this affected every programme in version 6 too (there overnight financing also left wins short of the target).
N6	Maven's consistency rule and gambling definition	The FAQ's largest-trade rule ($\leq 20\%$ of the payout's profit) and its 1:1.25 gambling definition were missing; the 50% best-day rule used instead does not appear in the rules.
N7	Contract rounding on normalised paths	Synthetic paths start at 100, so contract rounding must use the reference Nasdaq level (31,070), not the path price; one MNQ contract then loses \$62,140 x s at the stop.
N8	Apex best-day test	' $\leq$ ' replaced by the rule's strict ' $<$ ' (a day of exactly 50% fails).
N9	Best-day rules were not checked at the payout request	FXIFY (no day above 25% of a payout's profit, measured against the account's best day ever) and Hola Prime (40% per payout) were enforced only as a daily cap toward the full payout target. When the payout date came with less than the full target, the engine paid anyway, which the rule could forbid. The request now waits until the rule holds. (Found after the version 7 grid and refinement had run; the reported values of the chosen settings include the fix, the ranking of nearby settings does not.)
N10	A payout blocked by a consistency rule could wait for ever	If a win filled beyond its target (a gap), the largest win could exceed Maven's 20% of a payout stopped exactly at the target; the request then failed at every date and the account waited instead of trading on. Found by the version 7 verification (Chapter 11). The engine now raises that cycle's target to the profit the rule needs and keeps trading. Under the plan's daily flat this almost never happens: re-running three affected final settings on the same seeds moved their values by less than \$2 a month. Every figure from the final stage on was recomputed with the corrected engine.
N11	Cluster intervals need Student's t, and verification needs them too	Version 7's first pass computed cluster-robust intervals with 1.96 even with 4 clusters (the right multiplier is 3.18) and compared engine and chain with attempt-level intervals, although thousands of attempts on one path reuse the same price history dozens of times. The comparison then showed funded cash 'significantly' different from the chain in both directions on different path sets; single brackets at the same settings were fair. Intervals now use Student's t for G - 1 degrees of freedom, and the verification uses 24 independent paths. The same effect explains why the momentum direction rule's monthly value looked worse than a coin flip: attempts overlapping on one path take the same directions, so its interval is far wider; per trade it has no edge.

Formula sheet

Quantity	Formula	Exact for	Where
Value of one attempt	$\mathbb{E}[V] = \Pr(\text{pass}) \mathbb{E}[C] + \text{credits} - F$	always	1.2
Zero-cost example	$-F + P(\alpha D + qR), q = D/(D + X)$	idealised model	1.3
Notional, target distance	$N = l/(m\sigma), u = m\sigma(w + c)/l$	always	4.1
Win probability, mean, variance	$p = l/(l + w + c); -c; l(w + c)$	fixed cost, binary outcome	4.2–4.3
Cost per unit of risk	$\rho = \kappa/(m\sigma)$	always	4.4
Pass probability, no cost	$B/(A + B)$	exact landing on A or $-B$	5.1
Pass probability with cost	$(e^{\theta B} - 1)/(e^{\theta(A+B)} - 1), \theta = 2c/v$	approximation	5.2
Risk of the next trade; end of an attempt	$l = \min(L, (x + B - b)/(1 + \rho), \dots)$; ends if room $< l_{\min}$	the plan's rule	5.4
Exact chain	$V(x) = pV(x + w) + (1 - p)V(x - l - c)$, and N, K, T	binary trades, per-trade caps	5.5
General accounting identity	$PA + (1 - P)\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}} \text{fail}] = -\mathbb{E}[\text{cost}]$	always (bounded stopped sum)	5.5
Two phases	$P = P_1 \Pr(2 1); = P_1 P_2$ in the model	always / model	6.1
Withdrawal identity	$\mathbb{E}[W] = -\mathbb{E}[X_{\text{end}}] - \mathbb{E}[\text{funded cost}]$	cycle-by-cycle stopping	7.1
Funded cash, cycle form	$\alpha(X_1 q_1 + X q_1 q/(1 - q)) + R q_1 q^{t-1}$	repeated cycles	7.2
Two special first cycles (GFT)	$\mathbb{E}[\text{paid}] = q_a + q_a^2/(1 - q_b)$	repeated cycles	7.2
Trade duration	$m^2(w + c)/l$	approximation (arithmetic motion)	8.1
Value per month	$30.44 \mathbb{E}[V]/\mathbb{E}[T_{\text{days}}]$	long-run rate	8.3
Cluster-robust variance of a ratio	$\frac{G}{G-1} \sum_g (V_g - \hat{r} T_g)^2 / (\sum_g T_g)^2$	independent clusters	8.4
Margin at entry	$l \leq 0.6 \lambda m\sigma(S + x)$	the plan's rule	10.2
Scaling an account	$\mathbb{E}[V(\lambda S)] = P[\lambda G(S) + q_R R(\lambda S)] - F(\lambda S)$	scale-free rules	27.2
Paid cash under refusals	$ar(1 - \rho)(1 - e^{-\rho r H})/(\rho r)$	Poisson requests	29.1

Glossary

Abandonment	Closing an account (no more trades, replacement bought) when its room above the floor is too small for a real trade (5.4).
Allowance D	The funded account's maximum loss: the floor sits D below the starting balance.
Attempt	One evaluation bought, from purchase until a phase fails or the funded account that followed it ends.
Bold play	Staking enough on each bet to reach the goal in one win; not used by the plan (5.6).
Bracket	A position with its stop-loss and take-profit attached at entry and never moved.
Concentration policy	No trade and no day above 40% of the current target (6.7).
Daily flat	No entry from 19:00 UTC, everything closed at 20:00 UTC (6.5).
Engine	The rule-by-rule simulation of an account on hourly price paths (acct_mc.py, pathfirm.py, lockstep.py).
Exact chain	The trade-level Markov chain of 5.5, solved by iteration (analytic_v7.py).
Payout target X	The profit at which a funded account stops and requests a payout.
Renewal-reward	The long-run value per unit time of a repeated process: $\mathbb{E}[V]/\mathbb{E}[T]$.
Slot	One account position at one firm, refilled with a new evaluation whenever an attempt ends.
Tier	A firm's reliability class (A, B, D) from public evidence, used for the refusal scenarios.
Winner's curse	The upward bias of the best of many noisy estimates; removed by reporting every figure from paths not used to choose it.

How every number was computed

File	What it does
<code>calibrate.py</code> , <code>sigma_v32.json</code>	costs and trading hours per market; hourly volatilities
<code>multi.py</code> , <code>pathfirm.py</code>	synthetic price paths (Brownian-bridge sub-steps; independent or jointly correlated) and the bracket trader
<code>acct_mc.py</code>	the rule engine: phases, funded accounts, payouts, the floor rule, cost-aware sizing, concentration, margin
<code>firms_v3.py</code> , <code>firms_v5.py</code> , <code>firms_v7.py</code>	every firm's rules; <code>firms_v7</code> holds the corrected inputs and the plan's policies
<code>optimize_v7.py</code>	grid (paths 101–104), refine (111–114), futures, final (121–136) → <code>opt_v7_*.json(l)</code>
<code>analytic_v7.py</code>	the exact chain with the floor rule, written separately from the engine
<code>verify_v7.py</code> , <code>sens_v7.py</code>	checks against theory, tie convergence, scaling; cost, risk, concentration, flat and direction sensitivities
<code>lockstep.py</code> , <code>lockstep_portfolio_v7.py</code>	one person's accounts on one calendar; portfolios, 36-month lives, budgets, stress, correlation, news, behaviour
<code>progs_v7.py</code> , <code>review_v7.py</code>	the firms' written rules and sources; the review response
<code>build_math_v7.py</code> , <code>doc7_*.py</code> , <code>math_v7_*.html</code>	this document: every number is read from the files above
<code>rerun_v7.sh</code>	the whole pipeline after the grid, in order

To reproduce: `python3 optimize_v7.py grid`, then `sh rerun_v7.sh`, then `python3 build_math_v7.py`. Synthetic paths are rebuilt exactly from their seeds and `sigma_v32.json`; no market data is needed. Every seed is fixed in the code, so every figure is reproducible bit for bit. Version 7 uses no real-history run: one two-year history is one sample, and its attempts are not independent validations.

Sources

Programme	Sources (read 4 October 2026)
FTMO 2-Step Challenge	ftmo.com (trading objectives; FAQ on accounts and the \$400,000 cap; forbidden practices); https://ftmo.com/en/blog/how-much-should-you-risk-on-one-trader/ ; FTMO leverage 1.50 on indices
FundingPips 2-Step Flex	https://help.fundingpips.com/hc/en-us/articles/47835196271249-2-Step-Flex (2 Step Flex, read 4 Oct 2026); https://help.fundingpips.com/hc/en-us/articles/48174287980177-Risk-Per-Trade-Idea (Risk Per Trade Idea; Profit Concentration Policy)
The5ers High Stakes	the5ers.com (High Stakes page; payout policy and hub credit FAQ); propfirmbridge.com (High Stakes review, 15 Sep 2026)
FXIFY Two Phase Classic	cryptoslate.com (FXIFY review, updated 4 Oct 2026: Classic and Pro prices and rules); fxify.com FAQs ("What is the max allocation?"; 2 Phase Pro max allocation; copy trading); search summaries of FXIFY leverage
FundedNext Stellar 2-Step	https://help.fundednext.com/en/articles/9430123-is-there-a-minimum-trading-day-and-profit-target-in-the-fundednext-account-of-the-stellar-2-step-model ; help.fundednext.com (copy trading; prohibited strategies)
Fintokei ProTrader	https://support.fintokei.com/en/articles/6538826-how-are-the-daily-loss-limit-and-maximum-loss-limit-calculated ; https://support.fintokei.com/en/articles/9464503-what-is-all-in-trading-and-why-is-it-forbidden-to-achieve-profit-target-in-one-trade ; fintokei.com (ProTrader page and terms)
Hola Prime 2-Step Prime	holaprime.com (2-Step Prime FAQ; prohibited trading practices); propfirmmap.com; thetrustedprop.com
Alpha Capital Alpha Pro 10%	https://help.alphacapitalgroup.uk/en/articles/10102634-performance-fee-on-demand ; https://help.alphacapitalgroup.uk/en/articles/8447268-what-is-the-2-minute-average-trade-duration-rule ; alphacapitalgroup.uk
FunderPro Classic	https://support.funderpro.com/en/articles/421458-is-there-a-margin-rule-on-funded-accounts ; https://support.funderpro.com/en/articles/422676-leverage-on-funderpro-challenges ; tradelocker.com hub (prices)
Goat Funded Trader 2-Step Standard	https://help.goatfundedtrader.com/en/articles/13575169-2-step-standard ; https://help.goatfundedtrader.com/en/articles/11472001-funded-account-reward-guidelines ; https://help.goatfundedtrader.com/en/articles/10742107-what-is-goat-guard
BrightFunded 2-Step Classic	https://help.brightfunded.com/en/articles/9241611-what-are-the-current-rules-for-the-evaluation-process ; help.brightfunded.com (refund add-on)
Blue Guardian 2-Step Standard	help.blueguardian.com (2 Step Standard rules); propfirmbridge.com; trustpilot.com (rating withheld)
Maven 2-Step	https://maventrading.com/faqs (read 4 Oct 2026)
Topstep 50K Trading Combine (futures, optional)	https://help.topstep.com/en/articles/8284233-topstep-payout-policy ; help.topstep.com (pricing)
Apex 4.0 50K EOD (futures, optional)	https://apextraderfunding.com/help-center/eod-trailing-drawdown-accounts/eod-payouts/ ; apextraderfunding.com help centre

Reliability evidence: TrustPilot company pages (rating-withheld notices, August–September 2026) and PropFirmMap safety grades, both read on 4 October 2026. Rules change; keep dated copies of the pages that apply to each purchase.